Contents

Review preview status

This is a review preview, not a finished grammar. It is an assembled draft of the current Tedim grammar sections. Several domains remain incomplete, and end-of-section caveats remain visible while the draft is still under review.

Abbreviations

Standard Leipzig Glossing Abbreviations

1	first person	IMP	imperative
2	second person	INCL	inclusive
3	third person	INS	instrumental
ABIL	abilitative	INTENS	intensive
ABL	ablative	IRR	irrealis
ALL	allative	ITER	iterative
APPL	applicative	LOC	locative
CAUS	causative	NEG	negative
COM	comitative	NMLZ	nominalizer
COMPL	completive	PFV	perfective
CONT	continuative	PL	plural
CVB	converb	POSS	possessive
DAT	dative	PROSP	prospective
DIMIN	diminutive	PROX	proximal
ERG	ergative	Q	question particle
EXCL	exclusive	RECIP	reciprocal
EXP	experiential	REFL	reflexive
GEN	genitive	REL	relativizer
HAB	habitual	RES	resultative
HORIZ	horizontal	SG	singular
IMM	immediate	TOP	topic

Tedim Chin-Specific Conventions

1SG→3	first singular acting on third person
2→1	second person acting on first person
3→1	third person acting on first person
AG	agent (nominalizer)
AUG	augmentative (big/great)
DIST	distal/anaphoric demonstrative
DOWN	downward directional
HAB.CONT	habitual continuative
I	verb form I (citation form)
II	verb form II (dependent form)
MORE	comparative (more X)
NEG.ABIL	negative abilitative (cannot)
PROX	proximal demonstrative
TOWARD	goal directional
UP	upward directional

Verb Forms: Tedim Chin verbs have two conjugation forms. I (Form I) is the citation/independent form; II (Form II) appears in dependent clauses and certain constructions.

1 Phonology and tone

1.1 Phonology and tone

The current phonology and tone section is deliberately cautious: the literature supports a modest segmental summary, practical spelling is only indirect evidence, and the tone-sensitive *-a* distinction remains blocked.

1.1.1 Overview of phonology and tone in Tedim

Tedim phonology can be printed cautiously from the literature as a modest segmental summary, an orthography note, and a three-tone system that is not marked in ordinary spelling. This section stays narrow: it prints what the literature supports now, keeps orthography in its proper place as indirect evidence, and leaves the tone-sensitive *-a* distinction unresolved (Henderson, 1965, pp. 9-13; Cing, 2017, pp. 25-26, 37, 57-60).

The Bible orthography is useful for locating lexical items in context, but the tone contrast itself is taken from the phonological literature, since tone is not consistently represented in ordinary printed spelling.

Orientation table

Area	Conservative claim	Evidence status	Caveat
Consonants	The literature supports a small, stable consonant inventory with stops, aspirates, fricatives, nasals, a lateral, and glottal material.	literature-backed	Not a full phoneme table.
Vowels	The literature supports a conservative vowel summary with length contrasts and related spelling variation.	literature-backed	Do not treat orthographic doubling as a full phonological transcript.
Syllable shape	Tedim syllables are safely summarized as a mostly simple CV/CVC system with limited codas.	literature-backed	This is an orientation, not a full phonological derivation.
Orthography	Practical spelling is useful for segmental orientation, but it does not mark tone.	orthography-backed	Orthography is indirect evidence, not direct proof.
Tone	Tedim is described as a three-tone language in the literature.	literature-backed	The present section does not solve sandhi or every morpheme-level assignment.
-a	The tone-sensitive *-a* case distinction remains unresolved in the current corpus layer.	blocked	Keep the high/low distinction blocked.

Segmental phonology The segmental literature converges on a conservative summary rather than a maximal phoneme chart. Henderson describes a relatively small initial-consonant system and a limited final set, while ZNC gives a modernized IPA-based account with a conservative vowel inventory and a simple syllable template (Henderson, 1965, pp. 9-13; Cing, 2017, pp. 25-26, 37). That is enough for a grammar-facing orientation, but not enough to pretend the segment inventory is fully settled in the present section.

Orthography and syllable shape Practical Tedim spelling is useful because it reflects familiar segmental contrasts, yet it remains a spelling system. Henderson explicitly notes that tone is not marked in orthography, and vowel length is only occasionally shown by doubling. The safest print claim is therefore that orthography helps orient the reader to segments and syllable shape, but cannot by itself prove a phonological analysis (Henderson, 1965, pp. 9-11, 13; Cing, 2017, pp. 25-26).

Tone status The tone literature supports a three-tone analysis, with tone contrastive in lexical items and with analytical transcription marking tone more explicitly than practical orthography does. The present section can therefore print a short tone-status summary: Tedim has three tones, tone is not marked in ordinary spelling, and tone interacts with morphology in ways that belong partly in other sections (Henderson, 1965, p. 13; Cing, 2017, pp. 57-60).

Bible-attested minimal and near-minimal sets

Form as printed in the Bible	Tone-marked or phonological form from the literature	Meaning	Bible source	Evidence type	Caveat
ta / *-ta* (as in *nungta*)	lexical high-tone *ta* vs grammatical low-tone *-ta* in the literature	child / PFV	Genesis 11:30; Matthew 4:4	supporting_bible_attestation + literature_backed_tone_claim	*nungta* is analyzed as *nung-ta* in the corpus layer; this row is supporting evidence, not a strict minimal pair.
thei / *-thei* (as in *lutthei*)	lexical high-tone *thei* vs grammatical low-tone *-thei* in the literature	know / ABIL	Genesis 4:9; Matthew 7:21	near_minimal_pair + literature_backed_tone_claim	Bible attests both forms, but tonal interpretation remains literature-backed.
hi / *hi* (as in *na hi hi*)	lexical high-tone *hi* vs grammatical low-tone *hi* in the literature	be / DECL	Genesis 16:13	homographic_lexical_grammatical_contrast + literature_backed_tone_claim	Orthography is identical, so role and tone are interpreted from context plus literature.

True orthography-identical tone minimal pairs are limited in the current source-resolved Bible layer, so near-minimal sets are used where needed and labeled explicitly. The `ta / -ta` row is kept as supporting Bible attestation rather than strict minimal-pair evidence.

Short Bible examples

(1.1) *lutthei* *ding* *uh* *hi*
enter-ABIL IRR 2/3PL DECL
'they will be able to enter' (Matthew 7:21)

(1.2) *na* *hi* *hi*
2SG DECL DECL
'you are' (Genesis 16:13)

These examples show Bible attestation of the forms in context. The tone assignment remains literature-backed, because ordinary Bible spelling does not mark tone contrast reliably. Short Bible examples are printed in ordinary Bible spelling, and tone-marked forms are restricted to the literature column in the table above.

The blocked -a issue The main unresolved issue is the tone-sensitive *-a* distinction. The literature distinguishes high-tone and low-tone values, but the current corpus spelling does not preserve tone, so this contrast cannot be recovered safely. For present purposes, the right grammar-facing decision is to keep *-a* blocked and describe the issue explicitly as unresolved rather than flattening it into a single case marker (Cing, 2017, pp. 57-60).

Boundaries with stem alternation, TAM, *-pih*, and verb paradigms Tone interacts with stem alternation, TAM / aspect / modal, *-pih* ‘with / accompanying’, and verb paradigms, but those are better printed in their own sections. This section therefore only marks the boundary: it does not attempt to sort out the full tone-sensitive behavior of suffixes or other unresolved tone-sensitive material that stays outside this section.

Deferred material A full phoneme table, a full tone-sandhi account, and a complete tone analysis remain deferred. The `ta / -ta` contrast remains caveated as supporting evidence rather than as a strict minimal pair.

What can be printed now What can be printed now is a short segmental orientation, an orthography caveat, a three-tone status summary, two or three Bible-attested minimal or near-minimal sets with literature-backed tone interpretation, and a blocked -a warning.

2 Deixis, pronouns, and nominal domain

2.1 Demonstratives / deixis

The current demonstrative evidence is strongest for core *hih* ‘this’ and *tua* ‘that / the aforementioned’, plus plural *hihte* ‘these’ and *tuate* ‘those’, while *hi* and exact *hih ciangin* ‘when this / when doing thus’ remain boundary material.

2.1.1 Overview of demonstratives and deixis in this section

This section treats the demonstrative core *hih* ‘this’ and *tua* ‘that / the aforementioned’, their plural forms, and a small set of constructional extensions. It leaves copular and sentence-final material around *hi* ‘be / DECL / copula-like’, and broader discourse-structure analysis, to other sections.

The basic two-way contrast is stable in both corpus and literature (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). A standing caveat is that Bible usage is dominated by *tua* ‘that / the aforementioned’, while the literature often cites *huā* ‘distal demonstrative’; the relation is plausible but not settled here.

Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts in this section.

Current demonstrative inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hih	proximal demonstrative	identificational and adnominal	stable	overlaps with *hi*-related material only at the boundary
tua	distal/anaphoric demonstrative	adnominal and discourse-linking	stable	broader discourse functions remain outside this section
hihte	proximal plural demonstrative	pronominal and NP-linked	stable	treated as DEM + *-te*
tuate	distal plural demonstrative	pronominal and NP-linked	stable	treated as DEM + *-te*

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hih bangin	manner/deictic construction	instruction or quoted manner	stable with caveat	interface with clause-linkage uses of *bangin*
tua bangin	manner/discourse resumptive construction	anaphoric summary or continuation	stable with caveat	interface with clause-linkage uses of *bangin*
tua ciangin	temporal/discourse linker	event sequencing ('then')	stable	boundary with clause-linkage chapter
tua ahih ciangin	discourse-temporal bridge	inferential/transition frame	stable with caveat	boundary with clause-linkage and discourse domains

Core demonstratives: hih and tua The core contrast is between *hih* 'this' and *tua* 'that / the aforementioned'. In controlled examples, *hih* is robust in proximal or presentational contexts, while *tua* regularly tracks already activated or discourse-linked referents.

(2.3) *Híh pèn Adam' suanlekhakte' laibu àhì hì.*
PROX TOP ADAM.POSS genealogy-PL.POSS book be.3SG DECL
'This is the book of the generations of Adam.' (Genesis 5:1)

Matthew 1:21 provides a Gospel comparandum with adnominal *tua* 'that / the aforementioned'.

(2.4) *túa tá-pà ìn àmà mì-tè à màwh-ná ùh pàn-ìn honkhia dìng àhìh màn-ìn*
DIST child-male ERG 3SG.POSS person-PL 3SG err-NMLZ 2/3PL ABL-ERG deliver IRR be.3SG.REL reason-ERG
'Because that child will save his people from their sins.' (Matthew 1:21)

Plural demonstratives Plural forms are straightforwardly built on demonstrative stems plus *-te* 'plural'. The controlled evidence supports both *hihte* 'these' and *tuate* 'those' as regular plural demonstrative forms.

(2.5) *Híh-tè pèn à ínn-kúan, à kam pau, à léi-tāng, à mì-nām-ìn Ham' suanlekhak-tè àhì hì.*
PROX-PL TOP 3SG house-family 3SG mouth speak 3SG land-earth 3SG person-tribe-ERG HAM.POSS genealogy-PL be.3SG DECL
'These are the descendants of Ham by their families, languages, lands, and nations.' (Genesis 10:20)

Luke 6:14 gives a Gospel comparandum with distal plural *tuate* 'those'.

(2.6) *Túa-tè ìn: Simon peter cí-ìn mīn à phuah pà.*
DIST-PL ERG SIMON PETER say-QUOT name 3SG thunder father
'Those were: Simon (called Peter)...' (Luke 6:14)

Adnominal and pronominal uses The same demonstrative forms can modify nouns or stand independently. Adnominal use is clear in forms such as *hih mite* 'these people', while pronominal use is clear in standalone predicate frames.

(2.7) *Híh mì-tè kà mú zò hì.*
PROX person-PL 1SG see.I south DECL
'I have seen these people.' (Exodus 32:9)

Matthew 12:49 gives a Gospel pronominal comparandum.

(2.8) *Híh-tè pèn kà nù lè kà sanggam-tè àhì ùh hì.*
PROX-PL TOP 1SG female and 1SG brother-PL be.3SG 2/3PL DECL
'These are my mother and my brothers.' (Matthew 12:49)

Discourse and temporal deixis Discourse-temporal uses are centered on *tua ciangin* 'then / at that time' and *tua ahih ciangin* 'when that was so / then'. These constructions are treated here as demonstrative-linked discourse frames, while fuller subordination analysis is left to clause linkage.

(2.9) *túa cìang-ìn khuavak ōm pah hì.*
DIST then-ERG light exist do.so DECL
'Then light appeared at once.' (Genesis 1:3)

Matthew 28:19 gives a Gospel comparandum for *tua ahih ciangin*.

(2.10) *Túa àhìh cìang-ìn nòtè pái ùn-lá.*
DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG 2PL.PRO go PL.IMP-and
'When that is so, you must go...' (Matthew 28:19)

Manner constructions with bangin Manner constructions with *bangin* 'like / as' are productive with demonstrative bases: *hih bangin* 'like this / thus' and *tua bangin* 'like that / thus'. These are kept in this section because the demonstrative base remains constructionally active.

(2.11) *híh bàng-ìn nà ngen ùn*
PROX like-ERG 2SG pray IMP.PL
'Pray like this.' (Matthew 6:9)

Exodus 14:30 gives a controlled Old Testament comparandum with *tua bangin*.

(2.12) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:dem-tua-bangin: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa ìn túa bàng-ìn Egypt mite' khutsung pàn-ìn Israel-té honkhia hì.
Lord ERG DIST like-ERG EGYPT person-PL.POSS palm ABL-ERG ISRAEL-TE deliver DECL

'Thus the Lord saved Israel from the hand of the Egyptians.' (Exodus 14:30)

Deferred forms: *hi* 'be / DECL / copula-like' and *hih ciangin* 'when this / when doing thus' *Hi* is kept as deferred boundary material. In current evidence it overlaps heavily with copular, auxiliary, and sentence-final-particle behavior, so it is not promoted as a stable demonstrative row here.

Hih ciangin 'when this / when doing thus' is also deferred. Current controlled evidence does not support it as a stable temporal demonstrative counterpart to *tua ciangin*, and many apparent hits overlap with non-demonstrative verbal material.

Boundary with interrogatives and quantifiers Forms such as *kua* 'who', *bang* 'what', *kuamah* 'nobody', and *bangmah* 'nothing' belong primarily to interrogative and quantifier/negative-indefinite domains, so they are not expanded in this section.

Deferred material Several issues remain outside the present account. These include the full *hi* system across copular and sentence-final uses, full discourse-structural deixis, and the unresolved scope of Bible *tua* versus literature *huā*.

2.2 Pronouns / clusivity

The current pronoun evidence is strongest for independent forms such as *kei* 'I / me', *nang* 'you.SG', and *amah* 'he / she / it', while first-plural clusivity (*eite* 'we' / *kote* 'we.EXCL') and participant-oriented prefixes (*hong-* 'participant-oriented venitive-like marker', *kong-* 'participant-oriented directive-like marker') remain tightly controlled boundary material.

2.2.1 Overview of pronouns and pronominal marking in this section

This section describes independent personal pronouns and closely related pronominal marking. It keeps demonstratives, interrogatives, quantifiers, and the wider verbal agreement system in their own sections.

The stable independent forms include *kei* 'I / me', *nang* 'you.SG', *amah* 'he / she / it', *eite* 'we', *kote* 'we', *note* 'you.PL', and *amaute* 'they'. The treatment of first-person plural distinctions follows cautious grammar-facing practice: *kote* can be treated as an exclusive form in the controlled evidence, while *eite* shows inclusive uses but is not assigned one global label here (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

Current personal-pronoun inventory

Person	Singular	Plural	Note or caveat
First	kei	eite, kote	*eite* is often inclusive; *kote* is often exclusive in controlled examples
Second	nang	note	Number contrast is stable in the controlled examples
Third	amah	amaute	Third-person contrast is stable for independent forms

Independent personal pronouns Independent pronouns occur freely as noun-phrase heads. The third-person form *amah* 'he / she / it' and the second-person plural form *note* 'you.PL' illustrate ordinary clause-level use.

(2.13) *àmàh pèn mì-hìng khèmpeuh' nù àhì hì.*
3SG.PRO TOP person-kind all.POSS female be.3SG DECL
'She was the mother of all living people.' (Genesis 3:20)

Matthew 5:13 supplies a Gospel comparandum with second-person plural *note* 'you.PL'.

(2.14) *Nòtè pèn léi-tùng mì-tè à dìng-ìn cí tàwh nà kī-bàng ùh hì.*
2PL.PRO TOP land-on person-PL 3SG IRR-ERG say COM 2SG REFL-same 2/3PL DECL
'You are like salt for the people of the world.' (Matthew 5:13)

First-person plural forms and clusivity The controlled evidence supports a cautious contrast between *eite* 'we' and *kote* 'we.EXCL'. In these data, *kote* behaves like an exclusive first-person plural, while *eite* has inclusive uses but is not forced into a single global value for all contexts.

(2.15) *Bàng hàng hìam cìh lèh eite beh khàt ì-hí hì.*
like reason Q say.NOM and 1PL.PRO tribe one 1PL.INCL-be DECL
'Because we are one kin-group.' (Genesis 13:8)

Genesis 34:9 gives the complementary row with *kote* 'we.EXCL'.

(2.16) *Kòtè tàwh kī-ten-ná hòng bāwl ùn.*
1PL.PRO COM REFL-marry-NMLZ 3→1 make IMP.PL
'Arrange intermarriage with us.' (Genesis 34:9)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction because no Gospel token of *eite* or *kote* matches the same clusivity contrast at comparable quality.

Possessive prefixes as pronominal material Possessive prefixes are directly related to person marking and belong in a compact pronoun-facing treatment: *ka-* 'first-person singular possessive', *na-* 'second-person singular possessive', *a-* 'third-person possessive', and *i-* 'first-person plural possessive'. Full paradigm structure and verbal agreement behavior are handled in the separate agreement and NP-possession sections.

(2.17) *Nà pa' ínn-àh kòtè' giah nàdìng à áwng dìng hìam?*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC 1PL.PRO.POSS camp PURP 3SG open IRR Q
'Is there room in your father's house for us to stay?' (Genesis 24:23)

Luke 2:49 supplies a Gospel row with *ka-* 'first-person singular possessive' in a nominal host phrase.

(2.18) *Kà Pa' ínn sùng-àh kà ōm dìng lamtak théi lò nà hì ùh hìam?*
1SG male.POSS house inside-LOC 1SG exist IRR know know NEG 2SG DECL 2/3PL Q
'Did you not know that I should be in my Father's house?' (Luke 2:49)

Genesis 3:20 also gives a third-person possessive prefix with *a-* 'third-person possessive'.

(2.19) *Mipa ìn à zi' mīn pèn Eve, cí hì.*
man ERG 3SG wife.POSS name TOP EVE say DECL
'The man called his wife's name Eve.' (Genesis 3:20)

Emphatic pronouns in -mah An emphatic element *-mah* 'self / emphatic' combines with pronoun bases, including *keimah* 'I myself' and *nangmah* 'you yourself'. Forms such as *kuamah* 'nobody' and *bangmah* 'nothing' are treated primarily in quantifier and negative-indefinite domains.

(2.20) *Kèimah gìm hòng kī-pìak-ná, kà thùak zàwh dìng hì lò hì.*
1SG.PRO suffering 3→1 REFL-give.to-NMLZ 1SG suffer able IRR DECL NEG DECL
'My punishment is more than I can bear.' (Genesis 4:13)

Matthew 8:22 supplies a Gospel emphatic comparandum with *nangmah* 'you yourself'.

(2.21) *Nangmah ìn kèi hòng zúi ìn.*
2SG.PRO ERG NEG 3→1 follow ERG
'You yourself, follow me.' (Matthew 8:22)

Reflexive and reciprocal ki- boundary The prefix *ki-* 'reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like' is a boundary topic between pronoun-sensitive participant structure and broader valency behavior. A clear reciprocal predicate is *ki-gawm* 'join together'.

(2.22) *à zi tàwh kī-gawm à, àmau tegel pum khàt à bàng ùh hì.*
3SG wife COM REFL-seize 3SG 3PL.PRO both body one 3SG like 2/3PL DECL
'He is joined with his wife, and the two become one body.' (Genesis 2:24)

Matthew 19:5 supplies a Gospel row with the same reciprocal predicate.

(2.23)

à	*zi*	*tàwh*	*kī-gawm*	*dìng*	*à,*	*àmau*	*tegel*	*pumkhat*	*à*	*bàng*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì.*
3SG	wife	COM	REFL-seize	IRR	3SG	3PL.PRO	both	body	3SG	like	IRR	2/3PL	DECL

‘He will be joined with his wife, and the two will become one body.’ (Matthew 19:5)

Participant-oriented hong- and kong- boundary The prefixes *hong-* ‘participant-oriented venitive-like marker’ and *kong-* ‘participant-oriented directive-like marker’ are included here only as boundary material. Their full status in inverse, directionality, and agreement-related analyses is left for dedicated sections.

(2.24) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:hong-prefix: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa	*àw,*	*cí-kin*	*nà*	*gil-kial*	*hòng*	*mú-ìn*	*àn*	*hòng*	*pía*	*kà*	*hì*	*ùh*	*hìam?*
Lord	voice	say-half	2SG	bowels	3→1	see-ERG	3PL.POSS	3→1	give	1SG	DECL	2/3PL	Q

‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and give you food?’ (Matthew 25:37)

Genesis 41:41 supplies an Old Testament comparandum for *kong-* ‘participant-oriented directive-like marker’.

(2.25)

Egypt	*gàm*	*khèmpeuh*	*à*	*ùk*	*dìng-ìn*	*nàng*	*kòng*	*kòih*	*khin-zò*	*hì.*
EGYPT	land	all	3SG	rule	IRR-ERG	2SG.PRO	1SG→3	put	COMPL-COMPL	DECL

‘I have placed you over all the land of Egypt.’ (Genesis 41:41)

Boundary with demonstratives, interrogatives, quantifiers, and wider agreement This section does not treat demonstratives such as *hih* ‘this’ and *tua* ‘that’, interrogatives such as *kua* ‘who’, quantifier-like negatives such as *kuamah* ‘nobody’ and *bangmah* ‘nothing’, or the full prefixal agreement system.

Deferred material Several issues remain outside the present account. These include full clusivity-system stabilization, the full scope of *ki-* across valency domains, and full analysis of *hong-* and *kong-* across agreement and directional systems.

2.3 NP structure / possession

The current evidence supports demonstrative-before-noun order alongside noun-plus-postnominal numeral and quantifier patterns, with possession kept as a cautious boundary subsection.

2.3.1 Overview of noun phrase structure

The clearest current evidence supports a small but coherent set of NP-order observations. Demonstrative-related material is safest where a proximal form precedes the noun, as in *hih mite* ‘these people’, with *hih* ‘this’ introducing the phrase. Numerals and several quantifier-like forms follow the noun in the cleanest current examples, as seen in *mi khat* ‘one person / a person’, *ni li* ‘four days’, *mi khempeuh* ‘all people’, *mi pawlkhat* ‘some people’, and *mi tampi* ‘many people’. The present section therefore supports a modest contrast between demonstrative-before-noun structure and noun-plus-postnominal numeral or quantifier structure, while leaving broader NP templating for later review.

Possession is now visible enough to include as part of the same section, but it remains less normalized than the modifier-order material. The safest checked rows show possessor-before-possessed structure in compact noun phrases such as *na pa’ inn-ah* ‘in your father’s house’ and *a zi’ min* ‘his wife’s name’, while the analysis of possessive prefixes, apostrophe marking, genitive structure, and relator or case overlap still requires explicit caveats.

Gospel searches produced clean noun-plus-numeral and noun-plus-quantifier examples, which helps keep the section from becoming Genesis-only. Demonstratives and possession remain more OT-led in the current stage because the Gospel comparanda were less clean under present careful evidence control.

2.3.2 Current NP pattern inventory

Pattern	Example form	Rough function	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
demonstrative + noun	*hih mite*	proximal demonstrative before a plural noun	well-supported	Gospel demonstrative comparanda are less clean than the OT anchor
noun + numeral / indefinite boundary	*mi khat*	noun followed by *khat* as numeral or indefinite-like modifier	supported with caveat	overlaps with the numerals and indefinites boundary
noun + numeral	*ni li*	counted noun followed by a simple numeral	well-supported	numeral formation belongs to the numerals section
noun + numeral	*kum sawm le nih*	counted noun followed by a compound numeral	well-supported	compound-ten analysis belongs to the numerals section
noun + quantifier	*mi khempeuh*	noun followed by a total quantifier	well-supported	full quantifier semantics belong to the quantifiers section
noun + quantifier	*mi pawlkhat*	noun followed by an existential or partitive-like quantifier	supported with caveat	grouping semantics remain caveated
noun + quantifier	*mi tampi*	noun followed by a quantity modifier	supported with caveat	borders on broader degree or adjective-like modification
possessor + possessed NP	*na pa' inn-ah*	pronominal possessor with possessed noun phrase	supported with caveat	overlaps with possessive prefixes, apostrophe analysis, and case closure
possessed NP chain	*a zi' min*	possessor-marked noun phrase containing a possessed noun	supported with caveat	does not yet justify a full possession paradigm

2.3.3 Demonstratives and nouns

The clearest checked demonstrative-related anchor remains *hih mite*, which safely supports a demonstrative-before-noun description for the current evidence. That is a narrower and safer claim than a full theory of determiner position. The demonstratives section remains the right place for the broader deictic inventory; the present section only uses the NP row to show that demonstrative-related modification does not pattern like the postnominal numeral and quantifier rows.

(2.26) *híh* *mì-tè*
PROX person-PL
'these people' (Exodus 5:5)

Matthew 6:2 gives a Gospel comparandum in *a hih mite*, but that row is embedded in a larger relative-like phrase and is therefore less clean as a simple adnominal demonstrative anchor. For present purposes, the OT phrase above remains the better controlled example.

No equally clean Gospel demonstrative example is currently used here, so the subsection stays with the compact OT anchor while the embedded Gospel comparandum remains only a supporting note.

2.3.4 Numerals and nouns

The normalized numerals section already carries the fuller description of the numeral system, including compound tens and larger-number expressions. The current NP section uses numeral material only to support noun-plus-numeral order: the cleanest checked rows place the noun before the numeral rather than the numeral before the noun.

(2.27) *nì li*
day four
'four days' (John 11:39)

(2.28) *kúm sàwm lè nìh*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

These rows show that the pattern is not tied to a single lexical head. *Ni li* 'four days' and *kum sawm le nih* 'twelve years' both keep the noun before the numeral, even when the numeral itself is compound. At the same time, *mi khat* 'one person / a person' remains an explicit boundary row, since the present section uses it as NP-order evidence without resolving the full numeral versus indefinite analysis that belongs to the numerals and quantifier-adjacent discussion.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Gospel anchors.

2.3.5 Quantifiers and nouns

The quantifiers section already carries the fuller discussion of total, existential-like, and negative-licensed quantifier material. Here the relevant point is more limited: the cleanest checked quantifier rows also place the noun before the quantifier-like item.

(2.29) *mì khèmpeuh*
person all
'all people' (Luke 2:1)

(2.30) *mì pàwl-khàt*
person some-one
'some people' (Matthew 2:1)

Mi pawlkhat and *mi tampi* (Mark 6:34) support the same general noun-plus-quantifier profile, although each keeps its own semantic caveats from the normalized quantifiers section. The current section therefore uses them as modest NP-order evidence rather than as a reopened quantifier chapter.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Gospel anchors.

2.3.6 Possession

Possession is now printable in a cautious way, but it remains less normalized than the modifier-order material above. The safest current claim is that the checked possession rows show possessor-before-possessed order inside the noun phrase. They do not yet justify a full paradigm of possessive prefixes, a settled treatment of apostrophe marking, or a broad theory of alienable versus inalienable possession.

(2.31) *nà pa' ínn-àh*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC
'in thy father's house' (Genesis 24:23)

(2.32) *à zi' mīn*
3SG wife.POSS name
'his wife's name' (Genesis 3:20)

These rows are enough for a cautious description of possessor-before-possessed structure, especially when read together with the main anchors *ka pa*, *Topa' inn*, and *a pa' inn*. They are not enough for a full possession paradigm, because the current evidence still overlaps with pronouns and possessive prefixes, genitive or apostrophe analysis, relator and postposition structure, and broader questions about head-dependent order.

No equally clean Gospel possession row was found for here under current careful evidence control. The possession subsection therefore remains OT-led even though the section as a whole includes Gospel-balanced NP-order examples.

2.3.7 Deferred and boundary material

Several important possession and NP topics remain explicitly deferred.

- A full possession paradigm is still deferred: the present section does not normalize every possessive prefix or every nominal host.
- Kinship possession remains under-supported beyond a few controlled anchors such as *ka pa*.
- Pronominal possession and agreement overlap remains shared with the pronoun and prefix/agreement material rather than settled here.
- Apostrophe-marked relations such as *Topa' inn* remain promising, but their exact relation to genitive marking and title-like noun combinations still needs fuller normalization.
- *Topa' tungah* remains a relator or case-boundary row rather than a clean possession example.
- *ka suahna leitang* remains a nominalization boundary row rather than a core possession anchor.
- Demonstrative, numeral, and quantifier rows are used here for NP-order support only; their full systems remain in the demonstratives, numerals, and quantifiers sections.
- Analyzer-noisy or report-only material, including isolated prefix surfaces and broad recursive-possession claims, is not promoted into the present discussion here.

2.3.8 Summary

The NP structure / possession section can now support a modest description of noun phrase order: the cleanest current evidence points to demonstrative-before-noun structure alongside noun-plus-postnominal numeral and quantifier patterns. Possession is now visible enough to include with formal examples, but it remains a cautious subsection whose broader paradigm, marking analysis, and interface with pronouns, genitive structure, and relators are still explicitly deferred.

2.4 Noun domain

The noun-domain evidence is strongest for simple stems such as *gam* 'land / country' and *aksi* 'star', for plural *-te*, and for nouns that remain visible as heads inside larger phrases.

2.4.1 Overview of the noun domain

The clearest current evidence supports a modest but coherent noun-domain description. Simple lexical nouns such as *gam* 'land / country' and *aksi* 'star' are safely attested, and plural marking with *-te* is printable for controlled anchors such as *aksi-te* 'stars' and *mite* 'people'. Human noun *mi* 'person' is also a stable lexical head in larger noun phrases, as seen in rows such as *mi khat* 'one person / a person', *mi khempeuh* 'all people', *mi pawlkhat* 'some people', and *mi tampi* 'many people', while nonhuman nouns such as *ni* 'day' and *kum* 'year' behave similarly in counted phrases.

This is enough to describe a small noun inventory, to note a cautious *-te* plural pattern, and to show that lexical nouns remain visible as heads inside demonstrative, numeral, and quantifier phrases. It is not yet enough for a full noun-domain chapter, because compounds, proper names, classifier-like nouns, and nominalized nouns still require more boundary control.

Gospel searches produced usable noun-domain evidence for *aksi* 'star', *mi khempeuh* 'all people', *ni li* 'four days', and proper-name material such as *Abraham' suan David* 'David, descendant of Abraham', which helps keep the section from becoming Genesis-only. The cleanest *gam* 'land / country' and *-te* plural anchors, however, remain OT-led in the current stage, while compound material such as *minam* 'nation / people-group' still needs explicit caveats.

2.4.2 Current noun-domain inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
gam	simple common noun 'land / country'	*gam sung*	well-supported	semantic range varies across geographic and political contexts
aksi	simple common noun 'star'	*ama aksi*	supported with caveat	current Gospel anchor occurs inside a possessed phrase
aksi-te	noun with *-te* plural marking	*aksi-te*	well-supported	does not yet settle the full behavior of plural / collective marking
mi	human common noun 'person'	*mi khat*, *mi khempeuh*	well-supported	overlaps with quantified and counted NP structure discussed elsewhere
mi-te / *mite*	human plural noun	*hih mite*	well-supported	demonstrative and NP-order analysis belongs to other sections
ni	noun head in counted phrase	*ni li*	well-supported	numeral semantics belong to the numerals section
kum	noun head in counted phrase	*kum sawm le nih*	well-supported	compound numeral analysis belongs to the numerals section

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
mi-nam / *minam*	transparent compound noun	*minam khat*	supported with caveat	compound transparency and lexicalization remain under review
Abraham	proper name used inside a larger noun phrase	*Abraham' suan David*	supported with caveat	does not yet justify a full proper-noun system

2.4.3 Simple noun stems

The safest simple-stem anchors remain *gam* and *aksi*. *gam* is a robust nonhuman common noun in the noun reports, while *aksi* is visible both in older OT material and in a clean Gospel phrase that keeps the stem separate from plural marking. These rows are enough to show that the noun section is not limited to derived forms or larger noun phrases: basic lexical stems are directly attested.

At the same time, the current section keeps the claim narrow. It does not attempt to classify all noun semantics or all stem alternations; it only records that ordinary lexical nouns can be cited safely before the analysis moves on to plural marking and larger NP environments.

(2.33) *gàm sùng*
land inside
'in the land' (Genesis 2:5)

(2.34) *àmà aksi*
3SG.POSS star
'his star' (Matthew 2:2)

2.4.4 Plural marking with -te

Plural marking with *-te* is now safe to discuss in a limited way. The clearest noun-domain anchors are nonhuman *aksi-te* and human *mi-te* in the fused form *mite*. Taken together, they support a modest claim that *-te* marks plurality on nouns in examples.

The present section does not claim that every plural or collective pattern has been normalized. Broader questions about distributive readings, plurality outside simple noun stems, and the interaction of plural marking with quantification are still deferred.

(2.35) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:noun-aksi-te: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

aksi-tè
star-PL

'stars' (Genesis 1:16)

(2.36) *híh mì-tè*
PROX person-PL
'these people' (Exodus 5:5)

No equally clean Gospel plural example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchors.

2.4.5 Human nouns and common nouns

Human noun *mi* is now one of the clearest lexical noun anchors in the nominal domain. It appears as a simple noun stem and as the head of several already-normalized noun phrases, including *mi khat*, *mi khempeuh*, *mi pawlkhat*, and *mi tampi*. Its plural form *mite* is equally secure in the current evidence.

This matters for the noun domain because it shows that the normalized NP, numeral, and quantifier sections are reusing genuine noun heads rather than unanalyzed filler forms. The NP structure section remains the right place for broader ordering claims, but the noun domain can now safely say that *mi* and *mite* are stable human common nouns.

(2.37) *mì* *khàt*
person one
'a man / one person' (Genesis 32:24)

(2.38) *mì* *khèmpeuh*
person all
'all people' (Luke 2:1)

2.4.6 Nouns in larger phrases

The normalized numerals, quantifiers, and NP structure / possession sections already show that nouns remain visible as heads in larger phrases. In the current noun-domain pass, that point can be stated modestly: noun heads such as *mi*, *ni*, and *kum* stay lexically identifiable inside counted and quantified expressions rather than disappearing into unanalyzed templates.

Ni li 'four days' and *kum sawm le nih* 'twelve years' are the clearest counted anchors for this purpose. Together they show that lexical noun heads remain visible inside larger numeral phrases. The noun-domain claim is therefore limited to lexical headedness; it does not reopen the fuller NP-order or numeral/quantifier analyses.

(2.39) *nì* *li*
day four
'four days' (John 11:39)

(2.40) *kúm* *sàwm* *lè* *nìh*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Gospel anchors.

2.4.7 Compounds and proper nouns

Compounds and proper nouns are now visible enough for a cautious note, but they remain less normalized than simple stems and plural-marked nouns. The clearest compound-like anchor is *minam*, which is still transparent enough to support a controlled print comment about noun-noun composition. Proper names such as *Abraham* are also clearly nominal, but the current evidence is not yet strong enough to generalize over Bible names, place names, or analyzer-noisy multiword name strings.

The current section therefore treats compounds and proper nouns as boundary material with one safe compound example and one cautious proper-name example. *Abraham' suan David* is a useful comparandum, but it does not yet justify a full proper-name subsection or a complete account of name-internal structure.

(2.41) *mì-nam* *khàt*
person-kind one
'one nation' (Genesis 11:6)

(2.42) *Abraham'* *suan* *David*
ABRAHAM.POSS plant DAVID
'David, descendant of Abraham' (Matthew 1:1)

2.4.8 Nominalization boundary

Derived nouns and nominalized forms remain shared with the nominalization section. Items such as *kholhna* and broader *-na* material are important for the nominal domain, but the present section does not absorb them into the lexical noun inventory. It only notes that lexical nouns, plural-marked nouns, and larger noun phrases have now been normalized far enough that nominalized nouns can be kept as an explicit boundary rather than being mixed into the basic noun list.

2.4.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several noun-domain topics remain explicitly deferred.

- Transparent compounds remain only partially normalized: *minam* is useful, but broader compound classes still need more evidence.
- Lexicalized compounds remain deferred because current report evidence does not cleanly separate synchronically analyzable forms from frozen lexemes.
- Proper nouns remain boundary-heavy: *Abraham* is usable as a controlled anchor, but Bible person and place names are not yet normalized as a full subsystem.
- Classifier-like nouns and measure-like nominal heads remain shared with numeral and quantifier work rather than settled here.
- Kinship nouns remain partly shared with possession, especially where forms such as *pa*, *inn*, and *min* enter possessor constructions.
- Nominalized nouns in *-na* remain with the nominalization section rather than being promoted as basic noun stems here.
- Plural and number patterns beyond straightforward *-te* marking remain deferred.
- Analyzer-noisy noun labels and multiword proper-name strings are not promoted into the present discussion.
- Raw report-only noun lists are not treated as grammar facts without checked careful evidence control.

2.4.10 Summary

The noun domain can now support a fuller section than the earlier narrow section allowed. Current evidence safely identifies simple noun stems such as *gam* and *aksi*, a cautious *-te* plural pattern visible in *aksi-te* and *mite*, stable human noun heads such as *mi*, and lexical nouns that remain visible inside counted and quantified noun phrases. Compounds, proper nouns, and nominalized nouns are now better framed as explicit boundary material rather than being mixed into an under-controlled noun list (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.5 Case marking

The current case evidence centers on *-ah* 'locative / goal-like' and *-in* 'ergative / agentive', while *-pan* 'source / ablative', *-panin* 'source / departure', and *-tawh* 'with' remain more cautious oblique extensions.

2.5.1 Overview of case-like marking

The current evidence supports a modest but coherent picture of postnominal case-like marking in Tedim. The clearest claims concern locative or goal-like *-ah* 'locative / goal-like' and clause-level agentive or ergative *-in* 'ergative / agentive'. The same section also supports more cautious discussion of source marking with *-pan* 'source / ablative' and *-panin* 'source / departure', plus accompaniment or material-extension uses of *-tawh* 'with', but those markers remain more boundary-heavy because they overlap with relator nouns, postpositions, or broader semantic extension.

The safest current prose therefore treats case marking as an NP-final domain rather than as a fully settled paradigm of discrete suffixes. Plain noun-plus-case rows such as *khua-ah* ‘in the town’ and clause-level agent rows such as *Kain in* ‘Cain as agent’ are secure enough to print. Relator-hosted forms such as *lakpan* ‘from among’ and *David khuapi sungah* ‘in the city of David’ are also real, but they should not be collapsed into a bare suffix inventory. Apostrophe-marked possession can host the same NP-final marking, yet the apostrophe itself remains a boundary issue rather than a settled genitive case marker in this section.

The Gospel search was productive enough to keep the section from becoming OT-only. The current manually reviewed supplement adds usable Gospel support for *Herod in* ‘Herod as agent’, *keima inn-ah* ‘into my house’, *David khuapi sungah* ‘in the city of David’, and *lakpan* ‘from among’. The possessive-boundary example remains OT-led, because no equally compact Gospel row was as clean under the current control standard.

2.5.2 Current case-marking inventory

Marker or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
-ah	locative or goal-like NP-final marking	*khua-ah*, *inn-ah*	well-supported	must stay distinct from deferred tone-sensitive *-a* and from relator-hosted spatial phrases
-in	clause-level ergative or agentive marking	*Kain in*, *Herod in*	well-supported	raw *-in* extraction overgenerates forms such as *ciangin*
possessor phrase plus *-ah*	possessed NP closed by case-like marking	*na pa’ inn-ah*	supported with caveat	does not settle the apostrophe or genitive analysis
-pan	source marking, often on a relator host	*lakpan*	supported with caveat	current clean evidence is relator-hosted rather than a broad bare-suffix paradigm
-panin	source or departure marking	*inn panin*	supported with caveat	internal structure remains under review
-tawh	accompaniment, with material or instrumental extension	*kei tawh*, *leivui tawh*	supported with caveat	accompaniment should not be flattened together with material-extension use
relator noun plus case	spatial relational phrase closed by case-like marking	*David khuapi sungah*, *tungah*, *kiangah*	supported with caveat	belongs jointly with the relators / postpositions section rather than a suffix-only list

2.5.3 Locative and goal marking with -ah

The clearest present claim is that *-ah* is a locative or goal-like case marker at the right edge of the noun phrase. The primary checked control is plain noun-plus-locative *khua-ah*, while the new source-balance supplement adds a compact Gospel goal-like example with *keima inn-ah*. This is enough to describe *-ah* as marking location and destination-like relations without forcing a sharper split among locative, allative, and general oblique labels than the current evidence can support.

The section also keeps one important negative control explicit. The current evidence does **not** justify collapsing deferred *-a* material into *-ah*. The source inventory and case background notes both keep tone-sensitive or otherwise ambiguous *-a* questions unresolved, so the description remains narrower than a full locative or allative chapter.

(2.43) *khùa-àh*
town-LOC
'in the town' (Genesis 11:28)

(2.44) *kèima ínn-àh*
1SG.self house-LOC
'into my house' (Matthew 8:8)

These two rows together support the safest present wording. *khua-ah* keeps the simple noun-plus-case pattern visible, while *keima inn-ah* shows that the same marker naturally appears in a Gospel clause with motion toward a location. That is enough for cautious the present discussion, but not yet enough to decide whether every *-ah* token should be described as specifically locative, allative, or more generally oblique.

2.5.4 Agentive, ergative, or instrumental marking with -in

The present section supports an agentive or ergative analysis of *-in* more clearly than it supports any broader instrumental analysis. Genesis 4:3 remains the primary checked anchor because *Kain in* is the cleanest controlled row. The new supplement adds Matthew 2:4 *Herod in* as a manually reviewed Gospel support example, which helps show that the pattern is not confined to one OT narrative window.

At the same time, this section does not claim a complete ergative system. It also does not promote a general instrumental *-in* category. The most important control here is still the homograph problem: raw searches for *-in* overgenerate forms such as *ciangin* 'when', so only checked clause-level noun phrase rows are promoted into the grammar prose.

(2.45) *Kain ìn*
KAIN ERG
'Cain as transitive subject' (Genesis 4:3)

(2.46) *Herod ìn*
HEROD ERG
'Herod as transitive subject' (Matthew 2:4)

These examples are intentionally compact. They are not meant to reopen the full alignment chapter. They only show that a noun phrase can bear checked *-in* marking in a clause with a transitive predicate, and that this is stronger evidence than any uncontrolled *-in* string would be.

2.5.5 Other controlled oblique markers

The section still retains a small set of other controlled case-like markers, but they are best treated more cautiously than *-ah* and *-in*. Source marking with *-pan* and *-panin* is real enough to describe, especially in rows such as *lakpan* 'from among' and *inn panin* 'from the house', yet the cleanest *-pan* example is relator-hosted and the internal structure of *-panin* remains under review. Likewise, *-tawh* remains part of the section because *kei tawh* 'with me' is a clean accompaniment row and *leivui tawh* 'with dust' shows a material or instrument-like extension, but that semantic split needs to stay explicit.

This means the section can already mention *-pan*, *-panin*, and *-tawh* in the current inventory, but it should not yet present them as a fully normalized oblique subsystem. For the present pass, they remain controlled supporting material rather than the center of the case-marking chapter.

(2.47) *ínn pàn-ìn*
house ABL-ERG
'from the house' (Genesis 12:1)

(2.48) *kèi tàwh*
1SG.PRO COM
'with me' (Genesis 14:24)

(2.49) *leivui tàwh*
dust COM
'with dust' (Genesis 2:7)

These rows keep the oblique material concrete. *Inn panin* 'from the house' shows source marking without a relator host, while *kei tawh* 'with me' and *leivui tawh* 'with dust' show that *-tawh* covers both accompaniment and material-extension uses.

No equally clean Gospel source or accompaniment row is currently used here, so the subsection stays OT-led while the broader oblique inventory remains cautiously delimited.

2.5.6 Genitive / possessive boundary

The clearest way to discuss genitive or possessive boundary material at present is to show that an already possessed noun phrase can host case-like marking at its right edge. Genesis 24:23 gives the compact row *na pa' inn-ah* 'in your father's house', which is already reused in the normalized NP structure / possession section. Here it serves a narrower purpose: it shows that case-like marking closes the larger noun phrase rather than attaching only to a simple underived noun stem.

(2.50) *nà pa' ínn-àh*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC
'in thy father's house' (Genesis 24:23)

This is enough to justify a boundary note, but not enough to settle the apostrophe analysis. The present section therefore does not settle whether the apostrophe material should be treated as a genitive suffix, a possessive linker, or an orthographic boundary convention. It only records that possessed noun phrases can participate in the same case-closing pattern that appears elsewhere in the nominal domain. The fuller discussion of possessive structure remains with the normalized NP structure / possession section.

No equally good Gospel example of a possessed noun phrase with case-like closure is currently used here, so the subsection stays with the compact OT example while the wider possession discussion remains elsewhere.

2.5.7 Case marking and relators/postpositions

The boundary with relators and postpositions is now one of the main editorial points of the section. Forms such as *sungah* 'inside / in', *tungah* 'on / upon', *kiangah* 'beside / near', and *lakpan* 'from among' are not noise, but neither are they simple proof that Tedim can be described by a suffix-only case list. The relational host matters: *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on top', *kiang* 'side / vicinity', and *lak* 'among' contribute spatial content before locative or source marking is added.

(2.51) *David khùa-pì sùng-àh*
DAVID village-big inside-LOC
'in the city of David' (Luke 2:11)

(2.52) *lak-pàn*
midst-ABL
'from among' (Matthew 5:19)

These rows belong here because they are case-like and NP-final. They also belong with the relators / postpositions section because the relational noun is part of the grammar, not just a carrier for a suffix. That is why forms such as *tungah* or *lakpan* should not be collapsed into case marking without careful evidence control. The best current solution is to let the two sections meet at the boundary rather than pretending the boundary does not exist.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Gospel anchors.

2.5.8 Case marking and argument structure

The normalized case section can now say one modest thing about argument structure: checked *-in* rows such as *Kain in* 'Cain as agent' and *Herod in* 'Herod as agent' show case-marked noun phrases functioning as clause-level agents, while locative or goal-like rows such as *inn-ah* 'in / into the house' show noun phrases entering the clause as spatial arguments or adjuncts. That is enough to connect the nominal domain to clause structure without reopening the full alignment or valency chapter.

The present section therefore cross-references the transitivity section rather than replacing it. The transitivity section remains the place for fuller discussion of argument frames, lexical valency, and broader alignment questions. Case marking only contributes the controlled NP-final marking side of that picture here.

2.5.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several important topics remain explicitly deferred.

- A full case paradigm is still deferred; the present evidence is not yet enough for a full case paradigm.
- The ergative versus instrumental distinction for *-in* is not settled here.
- The finer split among locative, dative, allative, and general oblique functions is still under review.
- Tone-sensitive *-a* material remains blocked rather than being collapsed into *-ah*.
- Apostrophe or genitive analysis remains unresolved and stays shared with the NP structure / possession section.
- Possessive noun phrase overlap remains explicit, especially where possessed NPs then take *-ah*.
- Relator-noun and postposition structure remains shared with the relators / postpositions section.
- Full alignment and argument-structure claims remain shared with the transitivity section.
- *-panin* remains a controlled source-marking row without a fully settled internal analysis.
- *-tawh* remains split between accompaniment and material or instrumental extension.
- Analyzer-noisy or raw report-only marker rows are not promoted into the present discussion.
- Raw generated-report counts and broad analyzer output are not treated as grammar facts in this section.

2.5.10 Summary

The case-marking section can now support a fuller description than the earlier narrow section allowed. Current evidence safely supports clause-level *-in*, locative or goal-like *-ah*, a boundary note on possessed noun phrases such as *na pa' inn-ah*, and a controlled interface with relator-hosted forms such as *David khuapi sungah* and *lakpan*. Source marking with *-pan* and *-panin*, along with *-tawh*, remains usable but secondary and caveated. The result is a real grammar section with explicit limits, not a claim that the full Tedim case system has already been finished (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.6 Relators / postpositions

The current evidence supports relational nouns such as *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', and *lak* 'among / midst', together with postpositional source patterns that close the larger phrase.

2.6.1 Overview of relators and postpositions

Tedim uses relational nouns and postpositional expressions to encode spatial and other relations, and case-like marking often appears at the right edge of the resulting phrase. The clearest current relator stems are *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', *lak* 'among / midst', and the more cautious *pualam* 'outside'. Related forms such as *laizang* 'middle / midst' point to the same semantic field, but the present section keeps its main discussion on the better-controlled relator stems (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

The main descriptive point is therefore structural rather than terminological. A form such as *sung* 'inside' or *kiang* 'beside / near' contributes spatial content of its own, while the phrase may still close with case-like material such as *-ah* 'locative / goal-like' or with source-marking *pan* 'from' and *panin* 'from'. This is why the relator section and the case-marking section overlap without collapsing into each other.

2.6.2 Current relator / postposition inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
sung	interior relation	*David khuapi sungah*	well supported	most often appears with phrase-edge marking
tung	surface or superposed relation	*tua tui tungah*	supported with caveat	some uses remain close to broader oblique or abstract extensions
kiang	side, vicinity, or adjacency	*mipa kiangah*	supported with caveat	also overlaps with recipient-like and source-like uses
lak	among or amidst	*numeite lak panin*	well supported	source marking may be written as a separate form or a tighter unit
pualam	exterior or outside space	*kongkhak pualam*	cautious support	more lexical-nominal than the core four relator anchors
sungah	interior phrase closed by *-ah*	*David khuapi sungah*	well supported	shared with the case-marking discussion of phrase-edge *-ah*
tungah	surface relation closed by *-ah*	*tua tui tungah*	well supported	the relator stem and the edge marker both contribute meaning
kiangah	adjacency relation closed by *-ah*	*mipa kiangah*	supported with caveat	also touches recipient-like use in larger clause structure
lakpan / lak panin	source from an interior set	*lakpan*, *numeite lak panin*	well supported	fused and separated spellings both belong at the relator or case boundary

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
NP + tawh	accompaniment or associative postposition	*kei tawh*	supporting boundary pattern	shared with accompaniment and material-extension uses discussed under case marking

2.6.3 Spatial relator nouns

The clearest first point is that Tedim has spatial relator nouns, not only bare suffixes. In the current evidence, bare spatial use is especially easy to see with *pualam* 'outside', while the other stems frequently occur with additional edge marking. That asymmetry is itself informative: the relational noun remains visible even when another marker closes the phrase.

(2.53) *kòng-khàk pualam*
1SG→3-limit outside
'outside the door' (Mark 2:2)

(2.54) *khùa-pì pualam*
village-big outside
'outside the city' (Genesis 24:11)

These examples keep the relator stem visible without forcing a larger claim about every spatial noun in the language. The same evidence domain also supports discussion of *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', and *lak* 'among / midst', but those stems are most naturally illustrated below in phrases where a case-like or source-marking element closes the larger expression.

2.6.4 Relator plus case-like marking

When case-like marking is added, forms such as *sungah* 'inside / in', *tungah* 'on / upon', *kiangah* 'beside / near', and *lakpan* 'from among' show that the relational noun and the final marker both contribute to the construction. The resulting forms are real grammatical units, but the present evidence does not support treating them as if the relator had disappeared and only a suffix remained.

(2.55) *David khùa-pì sùng-àh*
DAVID village-big inside-LOC
'in the city of David' (Luke 2:11)

(2.56) *túa tùi tùngàh*
DIST water on-LOC
'upon the water' (Genesis 1:2)

(2.57) *mipa kìang-àh*
man beside-LOC
'to the man / beside the man' (Genesis 2:19)

(2.58) *lak-pàn*
midst-ABL
'from among' (Matthew 5:19)

The examples are deliberately compact, because the descriptive issue is compact as well. *David khuapi sungah* and *tua tui tungah* show interior and surface relations closed by *-ah*, while *mipa kiangah* shows that adjacency expressions behave in the same way. *Lakpan* then shows that source marking can be hosted by the relator itself rather than by a simple noun stem.

2.6.5 Postpositional phrase structure

The current evidence also supports a modest structural claim about postpositional phrases. A relator or postposition follows the noun phrase that supplies its semantic anchor, and the whole sequence can then carry the source-like meaning of *pan* 'from' or *panin* 'from'. This is clearest when the noun phrase before the relator is larger than a single bare noun.

(2.59) *Pà kìang pàn-ìn*
father beside ABL-ERG
'from the Father' (John 6:45)

(2.60) *numei-tè lāk pàn-ìn*
woman-PL among ABL-ERG
'from among the women' (Exodus 2:7)

These examples keep the structural claim modest. The section does not claim a single uniform analysis for every spelling alternation or every source-marking form. It only shows that the relational element is phrase-medial rather than invisible, because the noun phrase comes first and the postpositional or case-like material closes the expression afterward.

2.6.6 Case-marking boundary

The boundary with case marking remains explicit. Forms such as *sungah*, *tungah*, *kiangah*, and *lakpan* are shared with the case-marking section because both pieces of the construction matter: the relator contributes the spatial relation, and the final marker contributes locative or source-like closure. The case-marking section therefore remains responsible for the edge-marking side of the analysis, while the present section explains why the relational host is still grammatically visible.

This division of labor matters especially for *-ah*, *pan*, and *panin*. A phrase like *David khuapi sungah* is not just a bare locative suffix attached to *khuapi*, and *lakpan* is not just a bare ablative suffix detached from *lak*. The relator and the phrase-edge marker work together.

2.6.7 Possession and NP-structure boundary

The relator or postposition can follow a larger noun phrase rather than a simple stem. This is already visible in *David khuapi sungah* 'in the city of David', in kin-based phrases such as *Pa kiang panin* 'from the Father', and in possessed noun phrases such as *Faro' inn sungah* 'in Pharaoh's house'. The structure is therefore phrase-closing rather than stem-bound.

The present section stops there. Fuller discussion of possessive marking and noun-phrase architecture remains with the NP structure / possession section, but that section and the present one now meet at a clear grammatical boundary.

2.6.8 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *nuai* and *mai* remain possible spatial nouns, but the current section does not promote them as core relator anchors.
- *tawhin* is still too sparse and too instrument-like to stand beside *pan*, *panin*, or *tawh* in the present account.
- The exact relation between tighter spellings such as *lakpan* and separated spellings such as *lak panin* remains open.

- Wider recipient-like uses around *kiang* still belong partly with clause structure and partly with case marking.
- Compound spatial nouns such as *laizang* remain relevant background, but they are not the center of the present section.

2.6.9 Summary

The current evidence supports a grammar-facing account of Tedim relators and postpositions. Spatial relations are carried by visible relational nouns such as *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', *lak* 'among / midst', and cautiously *pualam* 'outside', while postpositional and case-like material closes the larger phrase. The result is a relational system whose structure is clearer once the relator and the phrase-edge marker are described together rather than forced into a suffix-only inventory (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.7 Numerals

The current numeral evidence supports a decimal system with basic cardinals, counted noun phrases, and *-na* ordinals, while larger-number and classifier-like material remain explicit boundary notes.

2.7.1 Overview of the numeral system

The current evidence supports a cautious but fuller overview of the Tedim numeral system. Tedim is described in the literature as a decimal system, with *sawm* 'ten' as the decimal base and *za* 'hundred' as the next larger base above the first two-digit range (Cing, 2017; Henderson, 1965). The Bible-backed review section confirms that basic cardinals, compound tens, larger-number expressions, *-na* ordinals such as *nihna* 'second', and at least one occurrence-counting expression such as *sawmvei* 'ten times' are all securely part of the current section.

This section therefore includes:

- decimal structure and the most useful cardinal bases;
- basic cardinal numerals and noun-plus-numeral counting phrases;
- compound tens and one Gospel teen expression;
- hundreds, thousands, and larger units only where the evidence is safe;
- ordinals with *-na*, anchored by *nihna*;
- counting expressions and classifier-like material, but only cautiously;
- occurrence-counting *sawmvei*;
- explicit ambiguity controls for numeral-side *kua* 'nine' and boundary *khat* 'one';
- distributive reduplication only as deferred material.

What it does **not** do is claim that the whole numeral chapter is finished. It does not promote raw generated-report counts as grammar facts, it does not normalize a full classifier system from thin evidence, and it does not import quantifier prose or dubious analyzer output without careful evidence control.

2.7.2 Cardinal numerals

The table below gives the core numeral inventory needed for the present section. It is orientation rather than a raw frequency table: the point is to show the basic system, while the formal examples below remain restricted to checked or newly checked normalization rows.

Value	Form	Current status in this section
1	*khat*	basic numeral; keep numeral/indefinite overlap explicit
2	*nih*	clean basic cardinal
3	*thum*	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
4	*li*	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer

Value	Form	Current status in this section
5	*nga*	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
6	*guk*	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
7	*sagih*	clean basic cardinal in current examples
8	*giat*	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
9	*kua*	numeral *nine* only in constructionally numeral contexts
10	*sawm*	ten base
100	*za*	hundred base
1,000	*sing*	thousand base; not fully normalized in here
10,000	*tul*	larger unit recognized in the report/literature layer; not fully normalized in here

The table does not by itself authorize every form for immediate print-heavy exposition. It gives the section a visible inventory, while the examples below keep the actual printed claims small and checked.

2.7.3 Decimal composition

The safest current descriptive claim is that Tedim builds higher numerals through decimal composition, but the section should phrase that conservatively. The report and literature support a decimal structure (Cing, 2017; Henderson, 1965), while the current evidence gives two especially useful checked examples: one Old Testament compound-ten anchor and one Gospel counted-noun expression with a compound numeral.

Genesis 5:9 remains the best controlled compound-ten anchor:

(2.61) *kúm sàwm-kua*
year ten-nine
'ninety years' (Genesis 5:9)

Matthew 9:20 gives a good Gospel counted-noun expression with a compound numeral:

(2.62) *kúm sàwm lè nìh*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

These two rows are enough to support a modest decimal-composition claim. *Sawmkua* shows a clean compound-ten pattern and keeps numeral-side *kua* = *nine* visible in a securely numeral context. *Kum sawm le nih* 'twelve years' shows that a counted noun can also host a larger compound numeral in Gospel material, which helps the section avoid becoming a grammar of Genesis.

The section should still stop short of a full typology of every higher numeral pattern. The report mentions wider two-digit and larger-number combinations, but the present section only promotes the best checked examples.

Hundreds, thousands, and larger-number expressions are real parts of the system, but they need more caution than the simple and compound-ten rows. The current large-number anchor remains useful because it shows real biblical number style, not because every detail of the analyzer export is already polished:

(2.63)

kúm	*zā-kua*	*lè*	*kúm*	*sàwm-gùk*	*lè*	*kua*
year	hundred-nine	and	year	ten-six	and	who

'nine hundred sixty and nine years' (Genesis 5:27)

This is still a print-usable-with-caveat example. The wider construction is clearly numeral, but the export compresses *za-kua*, and the final *kua* is glossed as *who* in the current export layer. The section therefore keeps the row with its analyzer caveat visible instead of pretending that the export is already perfect.

2.7.4 Ordinals

The safest current ordinal claim is that Tedim has *-na* ordinal formation, with *nihna* as the best controlled anchor. This is consistent with the report and literature (Cing, 2017).

(2.64) *nìh-ná*
two-NMLZ
'second' (Genesis 7:11)

Nihna is the current well-supported ordinal row. The background notes already notes that *pos_span = N* in the export; that is a label caveat, not a reason to reject the ordinal analysis.

Masa remains visible but deferred. Gospel material such as Matthew 10:2 confirms that *masa* is a live background form for 'first', but the present section does not yet promote it as the normalized ordinal anchor because the current checked section is still built around *nihna*, not around a full ordinal paradigm or a full contrast between *masa* and *khatna*-type forms.

No equally good Gospel ordinal example is currently used here, so the subsection stays anchored in the compact OT row while the broader ordinal evidence remains backgrounded.

2.7.5 Counting phrases and word order

The clearest current word-order claim is still modest: noun-plus-numeral patterns are securely attested. Counted nouns such as *kum* 'year' and *ni* 'day' clearly precede the numeral in the best current examples, and the section now keeps both Old Testament and Gospel evidence visible for that pattern.

(2.65)

kúm	*nìh*
year	two

'two years' (Genesis 11:10)

(2.66)

nì	*sagih*
day	seven

'seven days' (Genesis 7:10)

(2.67)

nì	*li*
day	four

'four days' (John 11:39)

These are clean counted-noun examples, and they justify a real statement that noun-plus-numeral order is well supported. The section should still avoid overclaiming a complete typology of numeral placement. The broader report layer contains more patterns, and the literature discusses wider numeral syntax, but the checked section should stop at what the current examples support directly.

The Gospel search for this pilot found good counted-noun examples such as *ni li* 'four days' and *kum sawm le nih* 'twelve years'. That is enough to improve source balance. It does **not** mean that every numeral construction in the section now has an equally good Gospel counterpart.

2.7.6 Classifier-like and counting expressions

The report and literature mention classifier-like material and counting expressions, but the current section should stay selective. Only the rows that are checked or newly checked for this pilot should be promoted.

The safest current occurrence-counting row is still *sawmvei*:

(2.68) *sàwm-véi*
ten-times
'ten times' (Genesis 31:7)

The generated report paraphrases this as *vei sawm*, but the current analyzer export preserves the fused form *sawmvei*. That export-backed *sawmvei* form means the fused form should control the present slice.

Mi khat 'one person / a person' remains valuable boundary evidence:

(2.69) *mì* *khàt*
person one
'a man' / 'one person' (Genesis 32:24)

This is why the section discusses *mi khat* here but does not treat it as an uncomplicated bare numeral *one* example. It should not be treated as an uncomplicated bare numeral *one* example. It sits exactly on the numeral/indefinite boundary.

The classifier-like material can therefore be summarized cautiously:

Expression or form	Current treatment	Reason
mi khat	supported with caveat	numeral/indefinite boundary, not a simple classifier row
sawmvei	supported with caveat	clear occurrence-counting expression
pa, *nu*, *zat*, *tei*	deferred	promising report/literature material, but not normalized in here

This means the section can talk about classifier-like and counting expressions without pretending that the full classifier system has already been normalized. It also means the section does not start a quantifiers retrofit here.

No equally clean Gospel classifier-like example is currently used here, so the subsection keeps the compact OT anchors while the broader classifier-like inventory remains explicitly delimited.

2.7.7 Distributive numerals

Distributive numerals remain deferred in this pilot. The previous generated-report claim for distributive *sagih sagih* is not well-supported because the current analyzer/checked evidence still does not support the repeated span in the key Genesis 7:2 row. The generated report is useful background orientation, but it should not outrun the current checked evidence.

This is exactly the kind of place where normalization must stay disciplined. The section can say that distributive reduplication is a promising area in the report and literature, but it should still defer *sagih sagih* until the analyzer-backed evidence is clean enough to promote.

2.7.8 Ambiguity controls

Two ambiguity controls remain central to the section: *kua* 'nine' must stay in clearly numeral contexts so that it is not confused with the interrogative form *kua* 'who', and *khat* 'one' still needs explicit boundary notes where numeral and indefinite-like uses overlap.

Form	Numeral-side use	Competing use	Current treatment
kua	*sawmkua*; Genesis 5:27 large-number phrase	interrogative *who*	print only in constructionally numeral contexts
khat	basic cardinal 'one'	indefinite-like readings such as *mi khat*	keep explicit boundary notes; do not overgeneralize article-like use

The blocked *kua* control remains Genesis 48:8:

> Hihte kua ahi hiam?

That row belongs to the interrogatives section, not to numerals. Future numerals prose must therefore not use raw *kua* hits as numeral evidence.

The *khat* side of the control is different. *Khat* is unquestionably part of the numeral inventory, but not every *khat* example is equally good as a bare numeral illustration. The best currently controlled boundary row is still *mi khat*, and no cleaner Gospel *khat* boundary example was strong enough to replace it in this pilot.

2.7.9 Summary

The normalized numerals section now supports a genuine description. Tedim has a decimal numeral system with basic cardinals, compound tens, larger bases such as *za*, *sing*, and *tul*, *-na* ordinals, noun-plus-numeral counting phrases, and at least one compact occurrence-counting expression. The section now includes multiple formal examples, a visible inventory table, and both Old Testament and Gospel evidence where the checked material allows it.

At the same time, the section keeps the important boundaries explicit. *Sawmvei* remains tied to its fused-export caveat; the Genesis 5:27 large-number phrase remains usable only with analyzer caveats; *mi khat* remains boundary evidence; *kua* must stay constructionally controlled; and distributive *sagih sagih* remains deferred until the repeated span is genuinely analyzer-backed.

2.8 Quantifiers

The current quantifier evidence centers on *khempeuh* 'all', *pawlkhat* 'some people', *kuamah* 'nobody', *bangmah* 'nothing', and noun-plus-quantifier phrases such as *mi tampi* 'many people'.

2.8.1 Overview of quantification in Tedim

The current evidence supports a modest but real account of quantification in Tedim. The safest core anchor is universal or total *khempeuh* 'all'. Existential or indefinite-like quantification is visible through *pawlkhat* 'some people' or more cautiously 'some', but that material still carries a partitive or alternative-grouping caveat. *khat* 'one' remains boundary evidence shared with numerals rather than an uncomplicated quantifier anchor. Negative-quantifier work is currently safest with *kuamah* 'nobody' and *bangmah* 'nothing' or 'anything' only where clear clause-level negation licenses them. Quantity-related material is also visible through *tampi* 'many', especially in *tampi tak* 'very many / much' and noun-phrase *mi tampi* 'many people', but those rows still border on broader degree or modification work rather than constituting a full independent quantifier subsystem.

This is also where the current evidence meets broader descriptive literature most clearly: quantification in Tedim overlaps with noun-phrase structure, indefiniteness, and negation rather than forming a neatly isolated paradigm (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

The present section therefore keeps five safe claims in view. First, *khempeuh* supports a modest universal or total-quantifier generalization. Second, *pawlkhat* supports existential or indefinite-like readings with an explicit grouping caveat. Third, *kuamah* and *bangmah* remain usable only in negative-licensed clauses. Fourth, noun phrases such as *mi khempeuh* 'all people', *mi pawlkhat* 'some people', and *mi tampi* 'many people' support only a modest noun-plus-quantifier discussion. Fifth, *peuhpeuh* 'each~each / every, each', *tawm* 'few', *zaw* 'more', and *mahmah* 'very, truly' remain visible as boundary material without broadening the section into a full free-choice, low-quantity, comparative, or intensifier chapter.

2.8.2 Quantifier inventory

The table below summarizes the forms that are currently safe enough to discuss in the section.

Form	Rough function	Constructional status	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
khempeuh	universal / total quantifier	safe in checked noun phrases and scoped nominal expressions	well-supported	does not yet justify a full universal/distributive system
pawlkhat	existential / indefinite-like quantifier	usable in partitive or group-indefinite contexts	supported with caveat	grouping / alternative-set nuance remains explicit
khat in *mi khat*	numeral / indefinite boundary material	usable only as boundary evidence	supported with caveat	overlaps directly with numerals and indefinites
kuamah	negative-licensed human quantifier	safe in checked negative clauses	supported with caveat	depends on explicit negation
bangmah	negative-licensed nonhuman quantifier	safe in checked negative clauses	supported with caveat	overlaps with broader bang-family material outside negation
tampi tak	quantity / degree expression	compact quantity-related anchor	supported with caveat	borders on broader degree-modification work
tampi in *mi tampi*	quantity in noun phrase structure	usable as noun-plus-quantity row	supported with caveat	must not be widened into a full adjective/adverb chapter
peuhpeuh	free-choice / distributive-looking material	visible but not stabilized as core quantifier evidence	deferred	current rows lean toward free-choice or discourse readings
tawm	low-quantity edge material	report-visible but export-noisy	deferred	current analyzer gloss is too noisy for discussion here
zaw	comparative edge row	visible only as boundary material	boundary item	comparison is not normalized as part of the core quantifier chapter
mahmah	intensifier edge row	visible only as boundary material	boundary item	intensification belongs to broader modification work, not the core quantifier chapter

2.8.3 Universal / total quantifiers

Khempeuh remains the clearest current universal or total-quantifier anchor. The original main anchor is still Genesis 2:1, which gives a well-scoped nominal expression and keeps the printed claim conservative.

(2.70) *vàn-tùng léi-tùng lè à sùng-à ōm-tè khèmpeuh*
sky-on land-on and 3SG inside-3SG exist-PL all
'the heavens and the earth, and all that was in them' (Genesis 2:1)

The section also adds a clean Gospel counterpart so that the section does not become another Genesis-heavy chapter.

(2.71) *mì khèmpeuh*
person all
'all people' / 'everyone' (Luke 2:1)

Together these rows support a modest claim: total quantification is safely visible in noun-phrase-like structures, and *khempeuh* is currently the best anchor. Matthew 2:3 *Jerusalem khuami khempeuh* points in the same direction and supports the same noun-plus-quantifier pattern, but the printed section does not need to turn that into a broad universal/distributive system or a report-driven frequency claim.

2.8.4 Existential / indefinite-like quantifiers

Existential or indefinite-like quantification is currently safest around *pawlkhat*, but the section's original Genesis 32:8 control still has to be read as partitive or alternative-grouping evidence rather than as an uncomplicated bare *some*.

For the section, a checked Gospel noun-phrase example helps show the construction more clearly in print:

(2.72) *mì pàwl-khàt*
person some-one
'some people' (Matthew 2:1)

This Gospel row is useful because it makes the noun-phrase behavior clearer, but the Genesis 32:8 main anchor still controls the interpretation. *Pawlkhat* therefore remains grouped, partitive, or alternative-set material rather than a fully normalized article-like determiner.

The existential or indefinite-like subsection also has to keep *khat* on the boundary with numerals.

(2.73) *mì khàt*
person one
'a man' / 'one person' (Genesis 32:24)

Mi khat 'one person / a person' is reused from the numerals section as boundary evidence. The present section does not treat *khat* 'one' as an uncomplicated quantifier anchor. Instead, it keeps the numeral/indefinite overlap explicit and lets the numerals section carry the fuller discussion of *one*.

2.8.5 Quantifiers and negation

The section still handles negative quantifier material conservatively. *Kuamah* and *bangmah* are safe only in clearly negative-licensed clauses, so the section should cross-reference, not reopen, the stabilized negation section.

(2.74) *kuamah mú lò*
nobody see.I NEG
'he saw nobody' / 'he saw no man' (Exodus 2:12)

(2.75)	*kuamah*	*ìn*	*bangmah*	*híh*	*théi*	*lò*	*hì*
	nobody	ERG	nothing	PROX	know	NEG	DECL

‘nobody can do anything’ (John 3:27)

These two rows show the safest current pattern. Human-domain *kuamah* and nonhuman-domain *bangmah* are usable in print only where the negative licensing is explicit. The original Genesis 39:9 row *bangmah om lo hi* remains the compact checked nonhuman anchor behind this subsection, but John 3:27 gives the section a good Gospel example without loosening the negation caveat.

The section must also keep blocked bang-family material visible. *Tua bangmah hi-in* from Exodus 27:11 remains a blocked control rather than ordinary negative-quantifier evidence. That control prevents the quantifiers section from absorbing every *bangmah* token outside clear negative licensing.

2.8.6 Quantifiers and noun phrase structure

The safest noun-phrase claim is still modest. The checked examples support noun-plus-quantifier combinations such as *mi khempeuh*, *mi pawlkhat*, and *mi tampi*, but they do not yet justify a full noun-phrase ordering chapter covering demonstratives, numerals, and all quantifier types.

(2.76)	*mì*	*tampi*
	person	many

‘many people’ (Mark 6:34)

This is where the section can integrate quantity material without broadening uncontrollably. The original section’s *tampi tak* row is still the main quantity/degree anchor, but *mi tampi* gives the section a cleaner noun-phrase example. The printed claim should therefore stay narrow: Tedim clearly allows noun-plus-quantifier or noun-plus-quantity combinations in at least some checked rows, but the present section does not yet settle a full NP-ordering typology.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Gospel anchor. This construction is rare in the controlled evidence, so one example is used here and broader source balancing remains outside the present account.

2.8.7 Deferred and boundary material

Several quantifier-looking domains still need to stay visibly non-normalized.

Topic	Current treatment	Reason for caution
numeral overlap with *khat*	supported with caveat	*mi khat* is shared boundary evidence and should not be detached from the numerals discussion
negative quantifier overlap	supported with caveat	*kuamah* and *bangmah* are safe only with explicit negation
pronoun / determiner overlap	deferred beyond modest NP discussion	current examples support only local noun-phrase claims, not a full determiner system
discourse-range readings with *peuhpeuh*	deferred	current rows lean toward free-choice or broad-indefinite readings rather than settled universal quantification
low-quantity *tawm*	deferred	current export gloss remains too noisy for print promotion

Topic	Current treatment	Reason for caution
tampi tak versus broader degree work	supported with caveat	useful quantity evidence, but not the start of a broad adjective/adverb chapter
zaw and *mahmah*	edge rows only	keep comparison and intensification visible without widening the section into a full comparison or intensifier chapter
bang-family false friends such as *tua bangmah hi-in*	blocked control	prevents overgeneration from raw bang-family report material

This is also the right place to keep the source-balance search honest. Gospel searches produced useful rows for *khempeuh*, *pawlkhat*, *tampi*, and negative-licensed *kuamah* / *bangmah*, so the section now has genuine Old Testament and Gospel coverage. The same search did not yield a cleaner Gospel replacement for the classic *mi khat* boundary row, and Gospel *peuhpeuh* material remained too free-choice or discourse-heavy to promote as settled core quantifier evidence.

2.8.8 Summary

The quantifiers section now reads as a real grammar section rather than a narrow section note. *Khempeuh* remains the clearest universal anchor; *pawlkhat* remains useful existential or indefinite-like evidence with a grouping caveat; *khat* remains explicit numeral/indefinite boundary material; *kuamah* and *bangmah* remain tied to clear negative licensing; and *tampi* material now supports a modest noun-phrase discussion without widening into a broad modification chapter.

What remains deferred is equally important. The section still does not claim a full universal/distributive system, a full determiner system, a full negative-quantifier chapter, or a full degree/intensifier/comparative chapter. It keeps checked evidence and explicit caveats in front of the reader, uses Gospel examples where they genuinely help, and leaves *peuhpeuh*, *tawm*, and other boundary-heavy material clearly marked for later review.

3 Predicate structure and verbal morphology

3.1 Stem alternation

The current stem-alternation evidence supports a controlled Form I / Form II contrast around *mu / muh* 'see', *ne / nek* 'eat', and *nei / neih* 'have', while promoted caveated pairs, one-sided controls, and blocked rows remain explicit boundaries.

3.1.1 Overview of Form I / Form II stem alternation

Tedim has a two-form stem alternation system. Henderson describes this contrast as Form I and Form II, while Zam Ngaih Cing uses Stem 1 and Stem 2 terminology (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). The same descriptive pattern is visible in present corpus-backed examples.

This section keeps to a controlled grammar-facing account. It shows stable contrasts first, then keeps difficult, one-sided, and noisy material visible without turning this chapter into a complete monograph on verbal stem alternation.

3.1.2 Current stem alternation overview

Form	Typical distribution	Strongest examples	Caveat
Form I	especially common in finite and main-clause predication	*mu* ‘see’, *ne* ‘eat’, *nei* ‘have’	Form II can also occur in matrix clauses for some lexemes
Form II	especially common in dependent and constructionally bound contexts	*muh* ‘see.II’, *nek* ‘eat.II’, *neih* ‘have-NOM’	Form II is not restricted to one context such as negation or nominalization

3.1.3 Distribution by syntactic context

The strongest distributional pattern is construction-sensitive rather than mechanical. *Ciangin* ‘when’ and *ni-in* ‘on the day / when’ are productive temporal frames that often favor Form II in dependent clauses. *Kipan* ‘from / since’ also hosts clause-linking evidence, while purposive *nadingin* ‘in order to’ favors non-final forms in several promoted pairs.

Nominalized *-na* ‘nominalizer’ contexts and attributive *mi* ‘person / one who’ contexts add further evidence, but they require careful filtering so lexicalized compounds and category-mixed tokens are not overpromoted as simple stem alternants.

The practical distribution can therefore be summarized as follows:

Syntactic context	Form tendency in current evidence	Representative pairs	Caution
finite and main-clause predication	Form I most transparent	*mu / muh*, *ne / nek*, *nei / neih*	some Form II matrix tokens remain real
imperatives and directives	Form I usually clearest	*za / zak*, *bia / biak*	directive evidence does not define the whole system
negative clauses	mixed but informative	*ne / nek*, *nei / neih*, *thei / theih*	Form II does not simply equal negation
dependent temporal clauses (*ciangin*, *ni-in*)	Form II often strongest	*muh*, *zak*, *theih*, *nek*	temporal contexts are strong but not exclusive diagnostics
clause-linking with *kipan* and purposive *nadingin*	Form II often constructionally prominent	*nusia / nusiat*, *pia / piak*, *bia / biak*	many rows stay caveated
nominalized *-na* and attributive/relative *mi* contexts	Form II frequently visible	*neih*, *muhna*, *theihna*	lexicalized nouns must be filtered
modal and ability uses	pair-specific behavior	*thei / theih*	modal pairs should not be forced into a simple finite/non-finite slogan
quotative and complement contexts	mixed and often functional	*ci / cih* boundary	functional predicates can obscure lexical pair behavior

3.1.4 Core showcase pairs

The core showcase remains *mu / muh* ‘see’, *ne / nek* ‘eat’, and *nei / neih* ‘have’. These pairs still give the clearest first pass through Form I and Form II contrasts.

(3.77)	*Pasian*	*ìn*	*túa*	*khuavak*	*hòih*	*hì,*	*cí-ìn*	*à*	*mú*	*hì.*
	God	ERG	DIST	light	good	DECL	say-QUOT	3SG	see.I	DECL

‘God saw the light, that it was good’ (Genesis 1:4)

(3.78) *Lot ìn àmaute à mùh ciàng-ìn, àmaute à dawn dìng-ìn dìng à.*
LOT ERG 3PL.PRO 3SG see.II then-ERG 3PL.PRO 3SG top IRR-ERG IRR 3SG
‘when Lot saw them, he rose to meet them’ (Genesis 19:1)

(3.79) *Àhìh hàng-ìn à phà lè à sía thèih-ná sing-kung gah pèn nà*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG 3SG branch and 3SG evil know.II-NMLZ tree branch TOP 2SG
né kèi dìng hì.
eat NEG IRR DECL
‘but you shall not eat of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil’ (Genesis 2:17)

(3.80) *Bàng hàng hìam cìh lèh túa nà nèk nì-ìn nà sí dìng hì.*
like reason Q say.NOM and DIST 2SG eat.II day-ERG 2SG die IRR DECL
‘for in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die’ (Genesis 2:17)

(3.81) *Tù-ìn Sarai ciing à, tá néi lò hì.*
now-ERG SARAI barren 3SG child have NEG DECL
‘now Sarai was barren; she had no child’ (Genesis 11:30)

(3.82) *David’ nèih mì thahatte’ mīn-tè.*
DAVID.POSS have-NOM person strong-PL.POSS name-PL
‘the names of David’s mighty men’ (2 Samuel 23:8)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for these exact core-pair contrasts, so Gospel comparanda remain prose-only at this stage for the core showcase.

3.1.5 Promoted caveated pairs

Beyond the core, the strongest promoted caveated rows include *za / zak* ‘hear / listen’, *pia / piak* ‘give’, *nusia / nusiat* ‘leave’, *bia / biak* ‘speak / worship / address’, *thei / theih* ‘can / be able’, *piang / pian* ‘be born / arise’, *zui / zuih* ‘follow’, *khial / khialh* ‘err / sin’, *kia / kiak* ‘fall’, and *sawlkhia / sawlkhiat* ‘send out’.

Pair	What current evidence positively shows	Caveat
za / zak	directive Form I plus dependent Form II evidence is real	Form I citation quality is weaker because of clause-initial punctuation and discourse packaging
pia / piak	both sides are robustly attested in transfer predicates	many rows are context-crowded and not ideal for first teaching examples
nusia / nusiat	Form II appears in clause-linking structure with *kipan*	best Form II row is still descriptive and category-sensitive
bia / biak	both forms are real in worship and purposive frames	distribution is strongly domain-specific
thei / theih	modal and dependent uses show genuine alternation	this pair is constructionally special and not a simple finite contrast
piang / pian	eventive and dependent rows survive with good signal	derived *piangsak* family requires explicit filtering
zui / zuih	conditional and non-final Form II evidence is visible	Form II quotations still need conservative selection

Pair	What current evidence positively shows	Caveat
khial / khialh	clean dependent Form II evidence survives	derivational families remain nearby
kia / kiak	exact *kiak* rows survive and should remain visible	Form II lemma stability still needs philological checking
sawlkhia / sawlkhiat	both forms are attested, including a usable Gospel Form II row	Form II evidence remains sparse

(3.83) *Nà khuavak lè nà thù-màn hòng sawlkhia ìnlà.*
2SG light and 2SG word-reason 3→1 send.forth and.then
‘send out your light and your truth’ (Psalms 43:3)

(3.84) *Nòtè ìn sum-bawm, ip, lè khedap keng lò-ìn kòng sawlkhiat lái-ìn*
2PL.PRO ERG money-bag cover and shoe only NEG-ERG 1SG→3 send.forth midst-ERG
kī-tāng-sap-ná nà néi ùh hìam?
REFL-force-call-NMLZ 2SG have 2/3PL Q
‘when I sent you without purse, bag, or sandals, did you lack anything’ (Luke 22:35)

3.1.6 Difficult but grammatically important pairs

The difficult set remains central: *ngai / ngaih* ‘need / love / listen’, *pua / puak* ‘carry.on.back / spill’, *pai / paih* ‘go’, *tua / tuah* ‘do’, and *tua / tuak* ‘meet / receive’. These pairs matter because they reveal lexical-family contamination, one-sided evidence, shared-base competition, and analyzer overgeneration.

Ngai / ngaih ‘need / love / listen’ is especially important. Exact verbal rows exist, but the *ngaihsun* and *ngaihsutna* family can still contaminate the argument unless it is filtered explicitly.

3.1.7 One-sided and same-form controls

The current one-sided or constructionally skewed controls include *bawl / bawlh*, *dipkua / dipkuat*, *gen / genh*, *hawlkhia / hawlkhiat*, *husia / husiat*, *kho / khoh*, *kido / kidot*, *lua / luah*, *tu / tuh*, *tuahpha / tuahphat*, and *vial / vialh*.

Same-form controls are also important: *dawn / dawn*, *hong / hong*, *om / om*, *ci / ci*, *hi / hi*, *bawl / bawl*, *zui / zui*, and *pai / pai*. These controls stay visible because they test questionnaire and corpus alignment, but they are not overt alternating pairs in the present Bible layer.

3.1.8 Blocked or noisy material

Representative blocked rows include *keu / keuh*, *khai / khaih*, *sia / siah*, *tan / tanh*, *mual / mualh*, *sum / sumh*, *thu / thuh*, *lampi / lampih*, *khua / khuat*, and *gamla / gamlat*.

These rows remain blocked for clear grammatical reasons: nominal compounds, lexicalized families, derivational *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’ overlap, homophone and shared-base contamination, category mismatch, and analyzer overgeneration. Keeping them visible matters, but promoting them as ordinary stem alternation evidence would overstate the data.

3.1.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- Core pairs such as *mu / muh* ‘see’, *ne / nek* ‘eat’, and *nei / neih* ‘have’ are strong enough for grammar-facing use, but they do not exhaust the alternation system.
- Promoted caveated pairs remain uneven in evidence quality, especially where Form II is sparse or constructionally restricted.

- Difficult pairs such as *ngai / ngaih* 'need / love / listen' and *pua / puak* 'carry.on.back / spill' remain grammatically important without being fully settled.
- One-sided and same-form controls remain necessary for coverage, even when they are not overt alternating pairs.
- Blocked rows remain visible as explicit exclusions so nominal, lexicalized, or analyzer-noisy material is not converted into grammar facts.

3.1.10 Summary

Tedim stem alternation can now be stated in controlled grammar-facing prose: Form I and Form II contrasts are real, the core showcase pairs remain stable, and distribution by syntactic context is stronger than any one-line slogan. At the same time, promoted caveated rows, difficult pairs, one-sided controls, and blocked material remain explicit so the section stays accurate without overclaiming.

3.2 Verb paradigms

The current verb-paradigm evidence is strongest for finite predicate frames such as *kanei* 'I have', *na si ding hi* '2SG die IRR DECL', and *a en uh hi* '3SG look.at PL DECL', while negation-heavy, TAM-heavy, stem-alternation, and object-prefix rows remain boundary material.

3.2.1 Overview of basic finite verb paradigms in Tedim

This section is a finite-predicate-frame and person-marked-predicate first slice within the broader verb-paradigm domain. It focuses on the safest finite clause anchors and keeps adjacent domains explicit as boundaries.

The strongest starting anchors are *ka nei hi* '1SG-have DECL', *na si ding hi* '2SG die IRR DECL', *a suak hi* '3SG become DECL', and *a en uh hi* '3SG look.at PL DECL'. These support finite-frame analysis without expanding into chapter-scale verbal morphology.

Surface orthography is kept in prose and inventory forms (for example *ka nei hi*), while segmented analysis is kept in segmentation tiers and parse-oriented discussion (for example *ka-nei* '1SG-have').

This section is not a complete verbal paradigm system, not a full TAM chapter, not a full negation chapter, not a full stem-alternation chapter, not a full agreement chapter, not a full object-prefix chapter, not a full transitivity chapter, and not a full voice chapter.

3.2.2 Basic finite paradigm inventory

Category	Anchor forms	Current status	Why kept narrow
finite-frame anchors	*ka nei hi*, *a en uh hi*	promoted core	clearest clause-level finite frames
person-marking anchors	*na si ding hi*, *a suak hi*, *ka nei kei hi*	promoted core	safest person-marked finite predicates
supporting paradigm rows	*nei / neih*	supporting	useful lexeme-family support, but not a full stem table
negation boundary material	*ta nei lo hi*	boundary	belongs mainly with negation analysis
TAM boundary material	*lutthei ding uh hi*	boundary	belongs mainly with TAM/modal stacking analysis
stem-alternation boundary material	*mu / muh*	boundary	belongs mainly with Form I/Form II analysis
object-prefix boundary material	*hong bia*, *kong koih*	boundary	belongs mainly with participant-prefix analysis

Category	Anchor forms	Current status	Why kept narrow
analyzer-gap or blocked material	*i pai*; `-pah / -pak / -lawh`; report-table *ka pai* artifacts	blocked or deferred	not yet safe for finite-paradigm claims

3.2.3 Safest finite predicate frame

The most stable frame in this first slice is a person-marked predicate followed by clause-final *hi* in declarative contexts. In this section, *hi* is treated as a clause-final element in selected finite frames, not as an independent account of the full sentence-final system.

(3.85) *Àhì zòng-ìn à teek khit-ìn àmàh tàwh tá-pà khàt kà néi hì.*
be.3SG although-ERG 3SG master COMPL-ERG 3SG.PRO COM child-male one 1SG have DECL
'Yet when she was old, I have a son by him.' (Genesis 21:7)

Matthew 27:36 provides the Gospel comparandum for the same finite frame.

(3.86) *Jesuh à ēn ùh hì.*
JESUH 3SG look 2/3PL DECL
'They watched Jesus.' (Matthew 27:36)

Together these rows show a finite frame that is useful for grammar-facing description even before a full paradigm grid is attempted.

3.2.4 Safest person-marked finite predicates

The clearest person-marked finite examples currently available show second-, third-, and first-person subject-marking patterns in controlled clauses.

(3.87) *Bàng hàng hìam cìh lèh túa nà nèk nì-ìn nà sí dìng hì.*
like reason Q say.NOM and DIST 2SG eat.II day-ERG 2SG die IRR DECL
'For in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die.' (Genesis 2:17)

Genesis 26:13 adds a third-person finite predicate row.

(3.88) *à hau màhmàh khàt à sùak hì.*
3SG rich very one 3SG wither DECL
'He became very rich.' (Genesis 26:13)

John 4:17 supplies the Gospel first-person row.

(3.89) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:vp-person-john4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nu-méi ìn, pasal kà néi kèi hì" à cí hì.
woman ERG husband 1SG have NEG DECL 3SG say DECL

'The woman said, "I have no husband."' (John 4:17)

These rows are enough for a narrow person-marked finite-predicate claim, while still leaving larger person-prefix architecture to dedicated sections.

3.2.5 A small set of paradigm-friendly verb anchors

For this first slice, the safest lexical anchors are *nei* ‘have’ and *suak* ‘become’, with *en* ‘look at’ as supporting finite-frame evidence. This keeps the section finite-frame oriented instead of trying to normalize every verb class at once.

3.2.6 Boundary with negation and TAM

Finite-frame evidence intersects negation and TAM quickly. Rows such as *ta nei lo hi* and *lutthei ding uh hi* remain visible, but they are treated as boundary material here so the established negation and TAM sections remain authoritative for those analyses. The promoted rows *na si ding hi* and *ka nei kei hi* are kept because their finite-frame and person-marking value is clear, while TAM/negation interpretation remains boundary-routed.

3.2.7 Boundary with stem alternation

The *mu / muh* ‘see’ family remains a key boundary. It is important for paradigms, but the Form I/Form II distribution and caveats are handled in the dedicated stem-alternation section.

3.2.8 Boundary with object-prefix / inverse-like material

Participant-oriented object-prefix material remains outside the core finite table in this section. The person-sensitive prefix contrasts are already treated in the dedicated hong/kong section and stay boundary-controlled here.

3.2.9 Boundary with analyzer-gap and report-table-only material

Analyzer-gap material and report-table-only artifacts remain blocked or deferred in this first slice. Inclusive report paradigms (*i pai*) and artifact-prone rows such as report-table *ka pai* (*kap-ai* segmentation) are kept visible as limits rather than promoted as settled grammar facts.

Clause-final *hi* alignment is likewise kept narrow here: this section uses *hi* only for the selected finite frames above, while broader treatment remains in the sentence-final particles section and in TAM/negation overlap discussions.

3.2.10 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- Full person-prefix paradigms, including clusivity and plural routing, remain for dedicated sections.
- Full TAM and modal stacking remains outside this finite-frame slice.
- Full negation architecture remains outside this finite-frame slice.
- Full stem alternation, voice-like behavior, and object-prefix selection remain outside this finite-frame slice.
- Raw report counts or report-table templates are not used as grammar facts by themselves.

3.2.11 Summary

The strongest defensible claim remains modest: Tedim has stable finite predicate frames and a small set of clear person-marked finite anchors that can already be described in grammar-facing prose. This section is therefore a finite-predicate-frame/person-marked first slice, and it keeps TAM, negation, stem alternation, object-prefix, and analyzer-gap issues explicit as boundaries rather than treating them as solved paradigm coverage.

3.3 Prefix / agreement

The current prefix-routing evidence is strongest for host-sensitive contrast between *kanei* ‘I have’ and *kainn* ‘my house’, where *ka-nei* ‘1SG-have’ patterns as verbal agreement and *ka-inn* ‘1SG.POSS-house’ patterns as nominal possession, while *hongmu* ‘see me / come-see’ and *kongmu* ‘I see you / 1SG-see.2’ remain boundary material.

3.3.1 Overview of prefix and agreement routing in this section

This section treats a controlled routing contrast in Tedim pronominal prefixes. The forms *kanei* 'I have' and *kainn* 'my house' show that the same prefixal material can be analyzed as agreement before a verbal host and as possession before a nominal host. The segmented forms *ka-nei* '1SG-have' and *ka-inn* '1SG.POSS-house' make that host-sensitive contrast explicit.

3.3.2 Current prefix and agreement inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
kanei	agreement before a verbal host	*ka nei* clauses	well supported	broader person-prefix paradigm remains open
ka-nei	segmented agreement form	*1SG-have* parsing	well supported	does not settle all verbal prefix routing
kainn	possession before a nominal host	*ka inn* clauses	well supported	broader possessor syntax remains open
ka-inn	segmented possessive form	*1SG.POSS-house* parsing	well supported	does not settle apostrophe possession
ainn	third-person nominal prefix row	*a inn* phrases	boundary material	shared *a-* family overlaps other domains
ipai	independent pronoun/clusivity boundary row	*i pai* patterns	boundary material	belongs mainly with pronoun and clusivity analysis
hongmu / *kongmu*	object-prefix or inverse-like boundary row	*hong mu* / *kong mu* patterns	boundary material	selection conditions remain unsettled
kipan	*ki-* boundary row	*hong kipan* clauses	boundary material	overlaps reflexive/middle and derivational analysis
apostrophe possession	NP possessor marking boundary	*Topa' inn*	boundary material	belongs mainly with broader possession analysis
a bawl mi / *ahih*	relative-clause boundary rows	relative or clause-linkage contexts	boundary material	overlaps relative-clause and clause-linkage structure

3.3.3 Agreement before verbal hosts

The prefix *ka-* 'first-person prefix' is treated as agreement when it attaches to a verbal host. In this controlled contrast, *kanei* 'I have' is the clearest anchor, and the segmentation *ka-nei* '1SG-have' expresses the agreement-side analysis.

(3.90)	*Àhì*	*zòng-ìn*	*à*	*teek*	*khit-ìn*	*àmàh*	*tàwh*	*tá-pà*	*khàt*	*kà*	*néi*	*hì.*
	be.3SG	although-ERG	3SG	master	COMPL-ERG	3SG.PRO	COM	child-male	one	1SG	have	DECL

‘Yet when she was old, I have a son by him.’ (Genesis 21:7)

A Gospel counterpart appears in John 4:17.

(3.91) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:pref-kanei-john4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nu-méi ìn, pasal kà néi kèi hì” à cí hì.
woman ERG husband 1SG have NEG DECL 3SG say DECL

‘The woman said, ”I have no husband.”’ (John 4:17)

3.3.4 Possession before nominal hosts

Before a nominal host, the same prefixal material is analyzed as possession. The form *kainn* ‘my house’ and segmentation *ka-inn* ‘1SG.POSS-house’ provide the clearest possessive-routing anchor.

(3.92) *Tá nong pía kèi à, kà ínn sùng-à à sùak sila ìn kèima gàmh à*
child 2→1 give NEG 3SG 1SG house inside-3SG 3SG wither servant ERG 1SG.self land.II 3SG
lùah dìng hì tá hì.
carry IRR DECL child DECL
‘You gave me no child, and a male servant from my house will inherit me.’ (Genesis 15:3)

A Gospel counterpart appears in Luke 7:6.

(3.93) *Topa àw, kà ínn-àh nong pái nàdìngìn kèi kī-lawm zò lò kà híh*
Lord voice 1SG house-LOC 2→1 go PURP.ERG NEG REFL-worthy south NEG 1SG PROX
màn-ìn hòng pái dah hoh ìn.
reason-ERG 3→1 go put today ERG
‘Lord, I am not worthy for you to come under my roof.’ (Luke 7:6)

3.3.5 Agreement versus possession routing

Agreement versus possession routing is therefore host-sensitive. Verbal-host *ka-nei* supports agreement routing, while nominal-host *ka-inn* supports possessive routing. This controlled contrast does not yet settle the whole prefixal person system.

3.3.6 Boundary with independent pronouns and clusivity

Independent pronoun and clusivity material remains secondary here. The form *ipai* ‘we go / inclusive go’ is kept as boundary material, because clusivity contrasts are handled primarily in the pronoun section rather than in this host-routing contrast.

3.3.7 Boundary with relative clauses and a- material

The form *ainn* ‘his/her house’ and prefix *a-* ‘third-person prefix’ are important boundary material because they overlap possession, agreement, and relative-clause analysis. Relative-clause forms such as *a bawl mi* ‘one who made’ and clause-linkage material with *ahih* ‘it is / which is’ confirm that the *a-* family cannot yet be reduced to one finished account.

(3.94) *Túa tàwh à kibang-ìn pāk-nam-tui à bāwl mì peuhmah àmà*
DIST COM 3SG be.alike-CVB ointment 3SG make person whosoever 3SG.POSS
mite’ kìang pàn-ìn kī-khen-khìa dìng hì.
person-PL.POSS beside ABL-ERG REFL-divide-AWAY IRR DECL
‘Whoever makes perfume like it shall be cut off from his people.’ (Exodus 30:38)

A Gospel counterpart appears in Matthew 13:41.

(3.95) *Mì-hìng Tá-pà ìn à vàn-tùng mì-tè hòng sawl dìng à, àmà ukna*
person-kind child-male ERG 3SG sky-on person-PL 3→1 send IRR 3SG 3SG.POSS rule.NMLZ
sùng-àh à ōm migilo-tè lè mì à màwh nàdìngìn à bāwl mì khèmpeuh
inside-LOC 3SG exist enemy-PL and person 3SG sin PURP.ERG 3SG make person all
kai-khàwm-ìn.
gather-together-ERG
'The Son of Man will send his angels, and they will gather all who cause sin.' (Matthew 13:41)

3.3.8 Boundary with object-prefix or inverse-like material

Object-prefix or inverse-like material is kept as boundary evidence. *hongmu* 'SAP-oriented see / venitive support' and *kongmu* 'I see you / 1→2' remain visible because they are part of the same prefixal domain, but they are not promoted here to a full object-prefix or inverse chapter.

(3.96) *Kèimah ìn nòtè' híh khèmpeuh kòng mú khín hì, Topa ìn kòng cí*
1SG.PRO ERG 2PL.PRO.POSS PROX all 1SG→3 see.I IMM DECL Lord ERG 1SG→3 say
hì.
DECL
'I have seen all these things, says the Lord.' (Jeremiah 7:11)

A Gospel counterpart appears in Matthew 25:37.

(3.97) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:pref-hongmu-matt25: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa àw, cí-kin nà gil-kial hòng mú-ìn àn hòng pía kà hì ùh hìam?
Lord voice say-half 2SG bowels 3→1 see-ERG 3PL.POSS 3→1 give 1SG DECL 2/3PL Q

'Lord, when did we see you hungry and give you food?' (Matthew 25:37)

3.3.9 Boundary with ki-

The form *kipan* 'from / begin / REFLEXIVE-boundary' remains boundary-only material. It overlaps reflexive/middle analysis and wider derivational behavior, so it is not treated here as a settled agreement prefix.

(3.98) *Túa hùn à ki-pan-ìn mì-tè ìn Topa bía-ìn à mīn làwh dìng kī-pan*
DIST time 3SG from person-PL ERG Lord worship-ERG 3SG name PERF IRR REFL-begin
tá ùh hì.
child 2/3PL DECL
'From that time people began to call on the name of the Lord.' (Genesis 4:26)

A Gospel counterpart appears in Matthew 4:17.

(3.99) *Túa hùn à kī-pan Jesuh ìn thù-hìlh dìng kī-pan à.*
DIST time 3SG REFL-begin JESUH ERG word-teach IRR REFL-begin 3SG
'From that time Jesus began to preach.' (Matthew 4:17)

3.3.10 Boundary with apostrophe possession

Apostrophe possession is also treated as boundary material. Forms such as *Topa' inn* 'the Lord's house' belong primarily with the broader possession discussion and are not reopened here as a full possession analysis.

3.3.11 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *ka-nei* and *ka-inn* support a controlled host-sensitive routing contrast, but they do not settle the full person-prefix paradigm.
- *ainn* and the wider *a-* family remain boundary material shared with possession, agreement, and relative-clause structure.
- *ipai*, *ko*, and *ei* remain boundary material shared with independent pronoun and clusivity analysis.
- *hongmu* and *kongmu* remain boundary material until object-prefix and inverse-like selection conditions are treated directly.
- *kipan* remains boundary material shared with reflexive, middle, and derivational analysis.
- *Topa' inn* remains boundary material shared with apostrophe possession and possessor syntax.
- Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.3.12 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is a controlled routing contrast: verbal-host *ka-nei* supports agreement routing, and nominal-host *ka-inn* supports possessive routing. Boundary forms such as *ainn*, *ipai*, *hongmu*, *kongmu*, *kipan*, *a bawl mi*, *ahih*, and *Topa' inn* remain explicit so the section stays narrow and constructionally controlled.

3.4 Hong / kong object-prefix or inverse-like

The current *hong* 'come / venitive' and *kong* '1→2 / direct-like' evidence is strongest for a narrow participant-oriented prefix contrast: *hongbia* 'worship me' and *kongpia* 'give to you' are the cleanest paired Gospel rows, *kongkoih* 'place you' adds an OT anchor, and *hongmu* 'see me' / *kongmu* 'I see you' remain supportive but not diagnostic.

3.4.1 Overview of hong and kong object-prefix or inverse-like marking

hong 'come / venitive' remains mixed: some rows look inverse-like, while others are clearly deictic, motion, or formulaic. *kong* '1→2 / direct-like' is the cleaner side of the contrast. The section keeps the clearest rows separate from deictic motion, speech-formula rows, and lexicalized or unclear material.

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is narrow: Tedim has a small participant-oriented prefix domain, but this is not a full agreement chapter and not a full inverse-system chapter. The core comparison comes from a paired Gospel row, supported by a second OT *kong* anchor and by cautious *hongmu* 'SAP-oriented see' / *kongmu* 'I see you' support rows.

3.4.2 Current hong and kong inventory

Form	Proposed parse	Source	Current grammar-facing status	Diagnostic status	Boundary issue
hongbia	*hong-bia*	Matthew 4:9	promoted core	object-prefix_diagnostic	clearest hong-side row
kongpia	*kong-pia*	Matthew 4:9	promoted core	object-prefix_diagnostic	clearest kong-side row
kongkoih	*kong-koih*	Genesis 41:41	promoted core	object-prefix_diagnostic	OT kong anchor
hongmu	*hong-mu*	Matthew 25:37	supporting	compatible_not_diagnostic	useful but mixed
kongmu	*kong-mu*	Jeremiah 7:11	supporting	compatible_not_diagnostic	speech-formula overlap nearby

Form	Proposed parse	Source	Current grammar-facing status	Diagnostic status	Boundary issue
hongzui	*hong-zui*	Matthew 8:22	supporting	compatible_not_diagnostic	imperative / directive support
hongsawl	*hong-sawl*	Matthew 13:41	boundary material	deictic_venitive_boundary	sending / deictic overlap
hongpai	*hong-pai*	Exodus 1:1	boundary material	deictic_venitive_boundary	motion / venitive
hongbei	*hong-bei*	Genesis 1:5	boundary material	deictic_venitive_boundary	temporal motion
hongsuahna	*hong-suah-na*	Matthew 1:18	boundary material	lexicalized_or_unclear	nominalized / formulaic
kongci	*kong-ci*	Jeremiah 7:11	boundary material	lexicalized_or_unclear	speech formula
konggenkik	*kong-gen-kik*	Matthew 2:13	boundary material	lexicalized_or_unclear	speech sequencing
hong-an-huan-sak	*hong-an huan-sak*	Otsuka 2009:23	blocked	blocked	analyzer-gap row
kong-bawl-sak	*kong-bawl-sak*	Otsuka 2009:30	blocked	blocked	analyzer-gap row

3.4.3 Safest hong and kong rows

(3.100)

Kà	*mái-àh*	*kun-ìn*	*kèi*	*hòng*	*bía*	*lecin*	*híh-tè*	*khèmpeuh*	*nàngmà*	*tùngàh*
1SG	face-LOC	bow-ERG	NEG	3→1	worship	offend	PROX-PL	all	2SG.self	on-LOC
kòng	*pía*	*dìng*	*hì,*	*à*	*cí*	*hì.*				
1SG→3	give	IRR	DECL	3SG	say	DECL				

‘If you worship me, I will give you all these things.’ (Matthew 4:9)

The cleanest paired Gospel comparison is *hongbia* ‘worship me’ versus *kongpia* ‘give to you’ in Matthew 4:9. That same verse makes the contrast visible in one clause: *hongbia* is the clearest hong-side diagnostic, and *kongpia* is the clearest kong-side diagnostic.

Genesis 41:41 adds *kongkoih* ‘place you’ as a second OT anchor.

(3.101)

Egypt	*gàm*	*khèmpeuh*	*à*	*ùk*	*dìng-ìn*	*nàng*	*kòng*	*kòih*	*khin-zò*	*hì.*
EGYPT	land	all	3SG	rule	IRR-ERG	2SG.PRO	1SG→3	put	COMPL-COMPL	DECL

‘I have placed you over all the land of Egypt.’ (Genesis 41:41)

Together, these rows are enough to support a narrow participant-oriented prefix pocket without claiming a full system.

3.4.4 Support but not diagnostic rows

The familiar *hongmu* ‘see you (SAP-oriented)’ and *kongmu* ‘I see you’ rows remain useful but not decisive. They show that participant orientation is real, but they do not by themselves settle whether every *hong* token is object-prefixal rather than venitive/deictic.

Matthew 25:37 support row

(3.102) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:hk-support-matt25: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa	*àw,*	*cí-kin*	*nà*	*gil-kial*	*hòng*	*mú-ìn*	*àn*	*hòng*	*pía*	*kà*	*hì*	*ùh*	*hìam?*
Lord	voice	say-half	2SG	bowels	3→1	see-ERG	3PL.POSS	3→1	give	1SG	DECL	2/3PL	Q

‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and give you food?’ (Matthew 25:37)

In this quoted clause, the speaker group is first-person plural and the addressee is second person. The clause-level participant configuration is therefore 1PL→2SG, but the two *hong* tokens are better treated here as SAP-oriented/venitive support rather than as clean person-prefix diagnostics. Both tokens are glossed the same way.

Jeremiah 7:11 support row

(3.103)

Kèimah	*ìn*	*nòtè’*	*híh*	*khèmpeuh*	*kòng*	*mú*	*khín*	*hì,*	*Topa*	*ìn*	*kòng*	*cí*	*hì.*
1SG.PRO	ERG	2PL.PRO.POSS	PROX	all	1SG→3	see.I	IMM	DECL	Lord	ERG	1SG→3	say	DECL

‘I have seen all these things, says the Lord.’ (Jeremiah 7:11)

Matthew 8:22 (*Nangmah in kei hong zui in*) remains a useful supporting row for inverse-like *hong* with explicit *nangmah* and *kei*, but imperative venitive overlap keeps it below the promoted diagnostic tier.

3.4.5 Boundary with deictic / venitive hong

Motion-heavy rows such as *hongpai* and *hongbei* stay boundary material and should not be promoted as object-prefix diagnostics. Overlap rows such as *hongsawl* also remain on this boundary side.

3.4.6 Boundary with lexicalized or unclear rows

Formulaic, nominalized, and speech-formula rows stay boundary-controlled rather than being promoted as object-prefix diagnostics.

3.4.7 Boundary with transitivity, valency, and pronoun/agreement overlap

Rows that mainly expose clause type, verb class, or person-marking overlap stay boundary-controlled. This slice does not widen into a full agreement chapter or a full inverse chapter.

3.4.8 Deferred material

The literature-backed inverse claims remain visible in the background sources, but this slice keeps the domain narrow and leaves the broader system for later review.

3.4.9 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim has a narrow participant-oriented prefix pocket. *hong* remains mixed between venitive/deictic and inverse-like uses, while *kong* is the cleaner direct-like / 1→2 side. Keep the paired diagnostics (*hongbia*, *kongpia*) and the OT *kongkoih* anchor central, treat *hongmu*, *kongmu*, and *hongzui* as supporting, and leave deictic, lexicalized, and speech-formula rows boundary-only.

Raw report counts do not decide the analysis.

3.5 Transitivity

The current transitivity evidence is strongest for simple intransitive anchors such as *sih* ‘die’ and *suak* ‘become’, and for transitive anchors such as *hawl* ‘seek / steer’ and *en* ‘look at / see’, while stem families, derivational predicates, and case- or prefix-heavy rows remain boundary material.

3.5.1 Overview of transitivity contrasts

This section treats a controlled part of Tedim transitivity: simple intransitive and transitive predicate anchors plus selected boundary material. The clearest present anchors are *sih* 'die', *suak* 'become', *hawl* 'seek / steer', and *en* 'look at / see', while stem families such as *mu / muh* 'see', derivation-heavy forms such as *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create', and case- or prefix-heavy rows remain explicit boundaries.

That is enough for a narrow grammar-facing claim. It does not yet establish a full verb-class inventory or a complete argument-structure chapter.

3.5.2 Current transitivity inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
sih	simple intransitive predicate	*Haran si hi*, *a numei zong a si hi*	supported	cleanest death-predicate anchor
suak	change-of-state intransitive predicate	*a hau mahmah khat a suak hi*, *tua gam a sia suak ding hi*	supported with caution	broader lexical range remains open
hawl	transitive predicate with a direct object	*a leeng a hawl uh hi*	supported with caution	printable example range is narrower than the report gloss
en	perception verb with a transitive profile	*a bawlsate khempeuh en a*, *Jesuh a en uh hi*	supported	clearer OT/Gospel support than *hawl*
mu / muh	perception family at the stem-alternation boundary	*Topa' maipha mu hi*, *aksi a muh uh ciangin*	boundary material	overlaps Form I / Form II alternation
za / zak, *nei / neih*, *ngai / ngaih*	stem-family or labile-looking material	report-level verb-family rows	boundary material	belongs with stem alternation and labile behavior
piangsak, *pia(k)sak*	derivation-heavy transitivity	*piangsak*, *pia(k)sak*	boundary material	overlaps derivation / valency
pia, *gen*, *tom*	argument-structure-sensitive predicates	ditransitive or comitative rows	boundary material	depends strongly on case and complement structure
hong, *ki-*	prefix-heavy or voice-like material	intransitive and prefixal report rows	boundary material	overlaps prefix/agreement and voice-like analysis

The table keeps the first contrast compact. A grammar-facing section should show the clearest predicate types now, while leaving the larger problems of stem alternation, derivation, case, and prefixal structure visible as boundaries rather than flattening them into one verb-class system.

3.5.3 Intransitive predicates

The cleanest intransitive anchor is *sih* 'die'. It supports a simple one-participant predicate without immediately forcing broader case, derivational, or prefixal analysis into the section. *Suak* 'become' adds a second intransitive line and shows that the section is not limited to death predicates alone.

(3.104) *Haran sí hì*
HARAN die DECL
'Haran died' (Genesis 11:28)

(3.105) *à nu-méi zòng à sí hì*
3SG woman also 3SG die DECL
'the woman also died' (Matthew 22:27)

(3.106) *à hau màhmàh khàt à sùak hì*
3SG rich very one 3SG wither DECL
'he became very rich' (Genesis 26:13)

(3.107) *túa gàm à sía sùak dìng hì*
DIST land 3SG evil wither IRR DECL
'that kingdom will become ruined' (Matthew 12:25)

These examples support a narrow intransitive side: *sih* gives a plain intransitive event predicate, while *suak* gives a change-of-state predicate. They do not by themselves define the whole intransitive inventory, but they are strong enough for a controlled first contrast.

3.5.4 Transitive predicates

The transitive side stays equally narrow. Among the report-backed simple rows, *hawl* 'seek / steer' remains the least theory-heavy anchor, but its currently printable evidence is not as balanced as the rest of the section. *En* 'look at / see' therefore serves as the clearer supporting transitive row with matched Old Testament and Gospel examples.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this exact *hawl* row, so the section keeps a single Old Testament example here and lets *en* 'look at / see' carry the balanced transitive support.

(3.108) *Uzza lè Ahio ìn à leeng à hawl ùh hì*
UZZA and AHIO ERG 3SG chariot 3SG seek 2/3PL DECL
'Uzza and Ahio drove the cart' (1 Chronicles 13:7)

(3.109) *Pasian ìn à bāwl-sá-tè khèmpeuh ēn à*
God ERG 3SG make-flesh-PL all look 3SG
'God looked at all that he had made' (Genesis 1:31)

(3.110) *Jesuh à ēn ùh hì*
JESUH 3SG look 2/3PL DECL
'they watched Jesus' (Matthew 27:36)

Taken together, these rows support a practical transitive side without claiming that all Tedim transitives behave alike. *Hawl* remains useful because it keeps a simple object-taking predicate in view, while *en* supplies the better balanced formal support.

3.5.5 The narrow intransitive / transitive contrast

The practical contrast is therefore modest. *Sih* 'die' and *suak* 'become' support the intransitive side, while *hawl* 'seek / steer' and *en* 'look at / see' support the transitive side.

That is enough for a first grammar-facing contrast, but it is not yet a complete verb-class system. The section distinguishes a small set of stable anchors rather than claiming that every Tedim predicate can already be assigned to a single settled transitivity class.

3.5.6 Boundary with stem alternation and labile behavior

The clearest boundary beyond the core anchors is *mu / muh* 'see'. This family matters because it shows that transitivity quickly meets the Form I / Form II system, and it therefore cannot be treated as ordinary class evidence without reopening the stem-alternation chapter. The same caution applies to *za / zak* 'hear / listen', *nei / neih* 'have', and *ngai / ngaih* 'need / love / listen'.

(3.111) *Noah ìn Topa' mái-phà mú hì*
NOAH ERG Lord.POSS face-good see.I DECL
'Noah found favor with the Lord' (Genesis 6:8)

(3.112) *Túa aksi à mùh ùh cìang-ìn*
DIST star 3SG see.II 2/3PL then-ERG
'when they saw the star' (Matthew 2:10)

This pair is useful precisely because it stops short of a class claim. It shows why transitivity and stem alternation must be discussed together at the boundary, while still leaving the larger alternation system outside the present section.

3.5.7 Boundary with derivation / valency

The derivational boundary is represented most clearly by *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' and *pia(k)sak* 'give-CAUS / cause to give'. These forms are important, but they are poor core anchors for a first transitivity section because their argument profile cannot be separated cleanly from the causative and valency-changing uses of *-sak* 'causative / benefactive'.

That is why the present section keeps them visible only as adjacent evidence. They belong to transitivity, but they belong just as directly to the derivation / valency domain.

3.5.8 Boundary with case marking and argument structure

Predicates such as *pia* 'give', *gen* 'say', and *tom* 'meet / accompany' are likewise better treated as boundary material than as first-line transitivity anchors. Their interpretation depends heavily on recipient, complement, or comitative structure, so they quickly become questions about case marking and broader argument structure rather than about a simple intransitive/transitive contrast.

For the same reason, this section does not try to turn ditransitive and complement-taking predicates into a full argument-structure chapter. It keeps them visible, but not central.

3.5.9 Boundary with prefix/agreement and voice-like material

Some report rows also overlap with prefixal analysis. *Hong* 'come / venitive' remains mixed between lexical motion and prefix-heavy verbal structure, while *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like' belongs with the broader voice-like boundary rather than with a simple predicate-class list.

The section therefore leaves prefix/agreement-heavy material to its own domain. A narrow transitivity section should not absorb pronominal routing, venitive morphology, or reflexive and middle-like structure just because those issues touch verbal argument patterns.

3.5.10 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *hawl* 'seek / steer' remains useful, but the currently printable *hawl* evidence is not as Gospel-balanced as the rest of the section.
- *mu / muh* 'see', *za / zak* 'hear / listen', *nei / neih* 'have', and *ngai / ngaih* 'need / love / listen' remain stem-family and labile boundary material rather than core anchors.

- *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' and *pia(k)sak* 'give-CAUS / cause to give' remain derivation-heavy predicates.
- *pia* 'give', *gen* 'say', and *tom* 'meet / accompany' remain dominated by case and complement structure.
- *hong* 'come / venitive' and *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like' remain prefix-heavy or voice-like boundary material.
- The section therefore stays smaller than a full verb-class chapter or a full argument-structure account.

3.5.11 Summary

The safest current conclusion is that Tedim supports a narrow intransitive / transitive contrast that can already be stated in grammar-facing prose. *Sih* 'die' and *suak* 'become' anchor the intransitive side, while *hawl* 'seek / steer' and *en* 'look at / see' anchor the transitive side. At the same time, stem alternation, derivation / valency, case-sensitive predicates, and prefix-heavy material remain visible as boundaries, so the section stays controlled rather than expanding into a full verb-class chapter.

3.6 VP structure / suffix stacking

The current VP-structure evidence is strongest for a small checked set of suffix stacks such as *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR', directional-plus-irrealis sequences, modal-plus-irrealis strings, and derivational stacks whose ordering can be discussed without forcing a full verb-template chapter.

3.6.1 Overview of VP structure and suffix stacking

The safest current claim is that Tedim allows a small but real set of multi-suffix verbal complexes and clause-internal stacking patterns, without requiring a full verb-template chapter. The clearest checked anchors are *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR', attested *taisakzo ding* 'put to flight / flee-CAUS-COMPL-IRR', directional material such as *a kilaktoh ding hun* 'the time for him to be taken up', modal strings such as *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it', and derivational stacks such as *ciahsakkik* 'send back' and *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out'.

This section therefore keeps its descriptive scope controlled. It describes the clearest stack types that can already be stated in grammar-facing prose, while keeping the boundaries with TAM, directionals, negation, derivation, and clause linkage explicit.

3.6.2 Current VP stacking inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
bawlzoding	completive plus irrealis after a verbal stem	*bawlzoding*	supported with caveat	analyzer gloss remains noisier than the ordering evidence
V-*zo ding*	aspect before irrealis	*taisakzo ding*	supported with caveat	derivational material often enters the same string
DIR + *ding*	directional material before irrealis in a larger verbal complex	*a kilaktoh ding hun*	supported with caveat	quickly overlaps clause structure
khia-ta	directional plus completive boundary	*khia-ta*	boundary material	TAM and directional analysis remain intertwined

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
khiathei ding om lo	ability plus irrealis plus negation	*mang a khiathei ka hi kei hi, lutthei ding uh hi*	supported with caveat	already reaches clause-sized modal-negation material
ciahsakkik	causative plus iterative or return morphology	*hong ciahsakkik un, a guak ciahsakkik uh hi*	supported with caveat	derivational *-sak* remains central
paikhiatsak	directional plus causative morphology	*hong paikhiatsak ciangin*	boundary material	sits between directionals and derivation
dingin	clause-bound irrealis or purposive linker	*a khen dingin, maksim dingin*	boundary material	better treated with clause linkage than with a compact VP inventory

The table keeps *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' and *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' visible as boundary rows rather than as core stacking anchors. That matters because a grammar-facing section should show where VP-structure evidence stops being simple, not only where it begins.

3.6.3 Aspect plus irrealis stacking

Bawlzoding 'make-COMPL-IRR' is the central checked anchor because it keeps the ordering question in view without forcing a full paradigm. The best attested formal Old Testament example for this order is *taisakzo ding* 'put to flight / flee-CAUS-COMPL-IRR', where completive *-zo* 'already / completive' appears before *ding* 'prospective / irrealis'. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this exact construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchor and lets the later subsections show how the same right-edge order continues into Gospel material.

(3.113) *tái-sakzo* *dìng*
bright-CAUS.COMPL IRR
'put ten thousand to flight' (Deuteronomy 32:30)

This row does not settle every detail of the middle suffixes, and it does not replace the checked *bawlzoding* anchor. It is useful because it shows the same broad order in attested text: verbal stem material, then completive material, then irrealis.

3.6.4 Directional and TAM boundary in the verbal complex

Directional material can stand inside larger verbal complexes, but the present evidence does not collapse directionals and TAM into one solved suffix template. Genesis 20:13 gives *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out', where *-khia* 'outward' remains visible inside a causative stack. Luke 9:51 gives *a kilaktoh ding hun* 'the time for him to be taken up', where upward *-toh* 'upward' stands before *ding* 'irrealis / prospective'. The boundary clue *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' belongs in the same zone, but it remains safer here as prose evidence than as a core formal anchor.

(3.114) *hòng* *pái-khìa-sàk* *cìang-ìn*
3→1 go-out-CAUS then-ERG
'when he caused me to go out' (Genesis 20:13)

(3.115) *à* *kī-làk-tòh* *dìng* *hùn*
3SG REFL-take-UP IRR time
'the time for him to be taken up' (Luke 9:51)

These examples are not identical constructions, but together they show why VP structure has to remain boundary-aware: directional morphology can appear inside larger complexes, yet the surrounding ordering is still sensitive to TAM, derivation, and clause structure.

3.6.5 Ability, irrealis, and negation at the VP boundary

Ability material frequently participates in longer strings rather than standing alone. Genesis 41:16 uses *khiathei* 'interpret-ABIL' under negation, while Matthew 7:21 uses *lutthei ding* 'enter-ABIL-IRR' in a projected event. The stronger clause-sized boundary row *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it' shows why the section must stop short of a full account of negative modal syntax.

(3.116) *máng à khìat-thèi kà hì kèi hì*
dream 3SG interpret-ABIL 1SG DECL NEG DECL
'I cannot interpret a dream' (Genesis 41:16)

(3.117) *lút-thèi dìng ùh hì*
enter-ABIL IRR 2/3PL DECL
'they will be able to enter' (Matthew 7:21)

This pair shows a stable local point: *-thei* can be followed by further material such as negation or *-ding*, so ability belongs inside VP-structure discussion. It also shows why the present section should not be widened into a full modal chapter.

3.6.6 Derivational stacking and valency overlap

Derivational stacking is clearly real, but it is not reducible to suffix order alone. *Ciahsakkik* 'send back' provides the cleanest matched pair now available, with an Old Testament row and a Gospel row. The same area also keeps *bawlsakthei* 'make-CAUS-ABIL' and *paikhiatsak* 'go-out-CAUS' visible, which is why derivation and valency remain unavoidable boundaries for the present section.

(3.118) *hòng ciah-sàk-kík ùn*
3→1 return-CAUS-ITER IMP.PL
'send me back' (Genesis 24:54)

(3.119) *à guak ciah-sàk-kík ùh hì*
3SG back return-CAUS-ITER 2/3PL DECL
'they sent him back empty' (Mark 12:3)

Because *-sak* is central in both examples, this subsection is best read as a boundary zone between VP structure and derivation / valency. The examples are strong enough to show real stacking, but they do not by themselves justify a full derivational template.

3.6.7 Clause-linking boundary with *dingin*

Dingin 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' is important because it shows how quickly a stacking-looking form becomes clause linkage. Genesis 1:14 uses *a khen dingin* 'for dividing', and Matthew 1:19 uses *maksim dingin* 'to dismiss quietly'. Those rows are helpful because they keep right-edge irrealis material visible, but they are safer as clause-linking evidence than as core VP suffixes.

This is also why the present section does not treat every *ding*-plus-following-material sequence as the same construction. Some rows belong to local VP stacking, while others already belong to purposive or clause-linking structure.

3.6.8 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR' remains the central checked anchor, but its exact internal semantics are still noisier than its ordering value.
- *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' remains a TAM-directional boundary row rather than a core formal example here.
- *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it' and related strings reach clause-sized modal-negation structure too quickly.
- *bawlsakthei* 'make-CAUS-ABIL' and *paikhiatsak* 'go-out-CAUS' show why derivational stacks need separate treatment.
- *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' is kept at the clause-linkage boundary rather than inside a full VP template.
- The section does not attempt a full suffix slot template, a full derivation chapter, or a full account of sentence-final material.

3.6.9 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim permits a small but real set of multi-suffix verbal complexes. *Bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR' remains the central checked anchor, while *taisakzo ding*, *lutthei ding*, *ciahsakkik*, and *a kilaktoh ding hun* show how aspect, modality, directionals, and derivation can stack in attested material. At the same time, the boundaries with TAM, directionals, negation, derivation / valency, and clause linkage remain visible, so the section stays controlled rather than turning into a full verbal template chapter.

3.7 TAM / aspect / modal

The current TAM evidence is strongest for a small checked set of aspectual and modal anchors such as *-ta* 'completive / change-of-state', *-zo* 'already / completive', *-gige* 'habitually / always', *-ding* 'prospective / irrealis', *-thei* 'can / be able', and *-kik* 'again / back'.

3.7.1 Overview of TAM / aspect / modal marking

The safest current claim is that Tedim shows a controlled set of aspectual and modal anchors that can already be described in grammar-facing prose, without pretending that the whole verbal paradigm is settled. The present section therefore stays with compact suffixal or particle-like material rather than a full account of clause type, sentence-final particles, negation, or verb-phrase stacking.

The clearest anchors in this section are *-ta* 'completive / change-of-state', *-zo* 'already / completive', *-gige* 'habitually / always', *-zel* 'continuative / keep doing', *-ding* 'prospective / irrealis', *-thei* 'can / be able', *-kik* 'again / back', and *-ngei* 'ever / experiential'. Several wider questions remain visible around these forms, but they are kept explicit as boundaries rather than folded into a single large TAM chapter.

3.7.2 Current TAM inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-ta	completive or change-of-state aspect	*kihta uh hi*, *nungta zaw hi*	supported with caveat	clause-final *ta hi* remains separate
-zo	completive or endpoint reached	*ka bawlzo hi*, *a zuizo uh hi*	supported with caveat	bare *zo* still overlaps sentence-final material

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-gige	habitual or regularly repeated action	*en gige hi*, *vil gige uh a*	well supported	orthography may separate the habitual element
-zel	continuative or repeated continuation	*hopih zel hi*	supported with caveat	wider continuative and lexicalized uses remain open
-ngei	experiential or 'ever' aspect	*a paingei bangin*	supporting evidence	many other rows cluster with negation or *nawn*
-ding	prospective or irrealis marking	*na si ding hi*, *kiphuak ding hi*	well supported	clause-bound *dingin* remains separate
-thei	ability or possibility	*khiathei ka hi kei hi*, *lutthei ding uh hi*	supported with caveat	negation and irrealis often stack with it
-kik	repetition or return	*na ciahkik matengin*, *a ciahkik uh hi*	well supported	return and motion readings still need constructional care

The table keeps *-ngei* 'ever / experiential' visible even though its cleanest formal example is narrower than the habitual and irrealis pairs. That matters because a grammar-facing inventory should show both the secure anchors and the places where the evidence is still thinner.

3.7.3 Perfect, completive, and change-of-state material

-ta 'completive / change-of-state' is safest where a result state or completed change remains attached to a compact verbal host. *-zo* 'already / completive' likewise works best inside tight verbal material rather than as a clause-final particle. The section therefore starts from short verbal rows and keeps broader sentence-final issues for a later boundary discussion.

(3.120) *kih-tà* *ùh* *hì*
abhor-PFV 2/3PL DECL
'they were afraid' (Exodus 1:12)

(3.121) *nùng-tà* *zàw* *hì*
life-PFV more DECL
'lives rather' (Matthew 4:4)

(3.122) *kà* *bāwl-zò* *hì*
1SG make-COMPL DECL
'I have made it' (Exodus 34:27)

(3.123) *à* *zúi-zò* *ùh* *hì*
3SG follow-COMPL 2/3PL DECL
'they followed it' (Matthew 7:14)

Taken together, these rows support a modest aspectual claim: Tedim can mark completed or result-state readings in compact verbal material. They do not license every orthographic *ta* or *zo* token as settled TAM evidence, and they do not erase the clause-final boundary that remains visible elsewhere in the grammar.

3.7.4 Habitual, continuative, and experiential aspect

-gige 'habitually / always' is the most even habitual anchor in the current controlled evidence. *-zel* 'continuative / keep doing' is also visible, but its neatest checked row is still Old Testament-led. *-ngei* 'ever / experiential' belongs in the same zone, although the clearest compact formal row at present is the Gospel phrase *paingei* 'go-EXP'.

(3.124) *à pái-ngèi bàng-ìn*
3SG go-EXP like-ERG
'as was his custom' (Luke 4:16)

(3.125) *ēn gìgè hì*
look HAB DECL
'keeps watching' (Psalms 33:15)

(3.126) *vil gìgè ùh à*
watch HAB 2/3PL 3SG
'they kept watching' (Luke 20:20)

(3.127) *Topa ìn Moses ho-pìh zèl hì*
Lord ERG MOSES greet-APPL scatter DECL
'the Lord kept speaking with Moses' (Exodus 33:11)

The paired *-gige* rows show that habitual meaning is not confined to one testament. The *-zel* row is included because it keeps continuative aspect visible inside the same section, while *paingei* shows that experiential *-ngei* is real even though many other *ngei* examples sit closer to negated or "ever again" environments.

3.7.5 Prospective and irrealis marking

-ding 'prospective / irrealis' is productive enough to mark future-like or projected events in ordinary clauses. At the same time, many wider report hits are clause-bound forms such as *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis', so the section starts with simpler predicates and leaves purposive or clause-linking material for the boundary note below.

(3.128) *nà sí dìng hì*
2SG die IRR DECL
'you will die' (Genesis 2:17)

(3.129) *Emmanuel kī-phuak dìng hì*
EMMANUEL REFL-utter IRR DECL
'will be called Emmanuel' (Matthew 1:23)

These examples are enough for a controlled grammar-facing statement that *-ding* marks prospective or irrealis meaning in ordinary verbal or predicate structure. They are not enough to settle the full relation between *-ding*, purpose clauses, and broader clause linkage.

3.7.6 Ability and modal marking

-thei 'can / be able' often appears as a close verb-plus-modal sequence rather than as a fully separate lexical verb. The Gospel data provide the cleanest clause-level positive anchor, while Old Testament rows often show the same modal material under negation or inside quoted discourse.

(3.130) *máng à khìat-thèi kà hì kèi hì*
dream 3SG interpret-ABIL 1SG DECL NEG DECL
'I cannot interpret a dream' (Genesis 41:16)

(3.131) *lút-thèi* *dìng* *ùh* *hì*
enter-ABIL IRR 2/3PL DECL
'they will be able to enter' (Matthew 7:21)

The subsection therefore keeps two points in view at once. First, *-thei* really does mark ability or possibility. Second, the Old Testament row already shows how quickly the modal anchor meets negation, which is why the present section stays narrower than a full modal chapter.

3.7.7 Repetition and return marking

-kik 'again / back' regularly marks repeated or return-oriented events. The present section keeps that claim modest: the suffix is real and productive enough to discuss, but it is not expanded here into a full motion-verb chapter or a full discourse account of repetition.

(3.132) *nà* *ciah-kík* *matengin*
2SG return-ITER until
'until you return' (Genesis 3:19)

(3.133) *à* *ciah-kík* *ùh* *hì*
3SG return-ITER 2/3PL DECL
'they returned' (Matthew 2:12)

The Old Testament and Gospel rows line up closely enough to support a stable grammar-facing statement that *-kik* belongs in the repetitive or return-marking zone. Broader motion semantics still have to be handled construction by construction.

3.7.8 Boundary with negation and sentence-final particles

The present section does not reopen the negation or sentence-final chapters. That boundary matters most around *-thei* 'can / be able', which often appears in strings such as *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it', where ability, irrealis, and negation belong to one clause-sized complex rather than to a single neat suffix slot.

The same caution applies to *-ta* 'completive / change-of-state' and *-zo* 'already / completive'. Compact verbal rows are safe enough to discuss here, but clause-final *ta hi* and bare *zo* remain better treated as boundary material with sentence-final particles than as already-settled TAM categories.

3.7.9 Boundary with directionals and VP structure

Directional and TAM material can stack, but the present section keeps that interaction explicit rather than solved. The row *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' shows why a tidy aspect label can quickly become a directional-plus-TAM problem, while *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR' and *bawlsakthei* 'make-CAUS-ABIL' show why fuller suffix ordering belongs with verb-phrase structure rather than with the compact inventory above.

Clause-bound *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' belongs at the same boundary. It is important evidence for the wider system, but it turns prospective marking into clause linkage too quickly to serve as the core anchor for the present section.

3.7.10 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *pailai* 'go-midst / prospective form' still overlaps lexical *lai* too heavily for the present section.
- *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' and similar purpose-like rows remain clause-linkage material.
- *mangngilh ta hi* 'has forgotten' keeps clause-final *ta hi* visible without making it the model for completive aspect.

- *khiathei ding om lo* ‘there is no one who can interpret it’, *khia-ta* ‘out-PFV’, *bawlzoding* ‘make-COMPL-IRR’, and *bawlsakthei* ‘make-CAUS-ABIL’ remain overlap material rather than core anchors.
- *-nawn* ‘again / any longer’ and *-khin* ‘already / after completion’ are not expanded here.

3.7.11 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim already shows a small but real TAM, aspect, and modal profile through compact anchors. *-ta*, *-zo*, *-gige*, *-zel*, *-ngei*, *-ding*, *-thei*, and *-kik* can all be discussed now, but only if their boundaries with sentence-final particles, negation, directionals, and wider VP structure remain visible. That is why the section stays controlled: it offers a usable core inventory without pretending that the full verbal system has already been normalized.

3.8 Directionals

The current directional evidence is strongest for post-verbal forms such as *-khia* ‘outward’, *-khiat* ‘away’, *-toh* ‘upward’, *-sawn* ‘toward’, and *-suk* ‘downward’, while deictic prefixes remain separate.

3.8.1 Overview of directional expressions

The safest current claim is that this section treats a cautious subset of post-verbal directional morphology and directional-looking verbal derivatives, rather than the whole Tedim deictic system. The clearest anchors are *-khia* ‘outward’, *-khiat* ‘away’, *-toh* ‘upward’, *-sawn* ‘toward’, and *-suk* ‘downward’. Forms such as *hotkhiatna* ‘salvation’ and *kahtohna* ‘going up’ show that the same morphology also appears inside nominalized material, while pre-verbal deictic markers such as *va-* ‘away’ and *hong-* ‘toward the deictic center’ remain better handled as a separate subsystem (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017; Otsuka and Kurabe).

The section therefore keeps its descriptive scope modest. It focuses on forms that are transparent enough for grammar-facing prose now, while leaving broader motion-verb lexicon, deictic prefixing, and full verb-phrase stacking for later treatment.

3.8.2 Current directional inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-khia	outward or outward-result direction	*pokhia*	well supported	should not be generalized from every orthographic *khia* sequence
-khiat	away or out-of-domain direction	*nawhkhiat*	supported with caveat	analyzer-label caution remains relevant
-khiat-na	nominalized away morphology	*hotkhiatna*	boundary material	not equivalent to a simple finite directional verb
-toh	upward direction	*kilaktoh*, *a kilaktoh ding hun*	supported with caveat	blocked *paitoh* overlap prevents a blanket UP reading
-toh-na	nominalized upward morphology	*kahtohna*	boundary material	nominalization keeps the directional segment visible without yielding a simple finite predicate

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-sawn	toward or toward-directed transfer	*piasawn*, *nausawn*	cautious support	easy hits drift into kinship-heavy or lexicalized domains
-suk	downward direction	*paisuk*	supported with caveat	still represented by a narrow checked set
-lam	sideward or direction-side material	*tawplam*	boundary material	too noun-like for a clean verbal directional analysis
paitoh pattern	blocked overlap control	*paitoh*	excluded as a directional anchor	lexicalized accom-pany/comitative reading blocks a simple upward analysis

The table also keeps *-lam* 'sideward / toward a side' and *paitoh* 'go-accompany' visible as boundary material rather than as core anchors. That boundary work matters because a grammar-facing section should show where directional evidence stops being clean, not only where it starts.

3.8.3 Outward and away direction

The clearest outward and away examples stay conservative. *Pokhia* 'grow out' shows outward orientation, while *nawhkhiat* 'drive out / hurry away' keeps away-directed *-khiat* visible in a compact verbal form. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchors.

(3.134) *po-khìa*
grow-out
'grew out' (Genesis 2:5)

(3.135) *nawh-khìat*
hurry-away
'drove them out' (Deuteronomy 9:4)

The same away morphology also surfaces in *hotkhiatna* 'salvation', but that form is nominalized and therefore belongs at the boundary between directional morphology and deverbal nominalization rather than as a second finite anchor.

3.8.4 Upward direction and directionals in the verb phrase

Current evidence is strongest for *-toh* 'upward'. Numbers 9:17 gives the clearest compact Old Testament anchor.

(3.136) *kī-làk-tòh*
REFL-take-UP
'was taken up' (Numbers 9:17)

Luke 9:51 then shows the same upward material inside a larger verbal sequence:

(3.137) *à* *kī-làk-tòh* *dìng* *hùn*
3SG REFL-take-UP IRR time
'the time for him to be taken up' (Luke 9:51)

The Gospel row matters for more than source balance. It shows directional material after the verbal core and before *ding* 'irrealis / prospective', which supports a modest verb-phrase claim without turning this section into a full stacking analysis. At the same time, *paitoh* 'go-accompany' remains the necessary blocked control, and *kahtohna* 'going up' keeps upward morphology visible in nominalized form rather than in a simple finite predicate.

3.8.5 Toward direction with *-sawn*

Piasawn 'give toward' is the clearest checked Old Testament row.

(3.138) *pía-sàwn*
give-toward
'extend to us' (Ezra 9:9)

Luke 20:31 provides a Gospel comparandum in *nausawn* 'elder-sibling-toward':

(3.139) *nà-u-sàwn*
2SG-elder.sibling-toward
'took her in turn as an elder brother' (Luke 20:31)

The Luke example is still kinship-heavy, so it remains a supporting comparandum rather than the main anchor. Even so, it confirms that toward-oriented *-sawn* material belongs in the present section, while wider kinship and lexicalization issues still require caution.

3.8.6 Downward direction with *-suk*

Paisuk 'go down' gives the clearest checked downward row. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchor. This construction is rare in the controlled evidence, so one example is used here and broader source balancing remains outside the present account.

(3.140) *pái-sùk*
go-DOWN
'came down' (Genesis 11:5)

The row is compact, analyzable, and grammatically useful. It shows that downward *-suk* is part of the directional profile, but it does not justify a larger claim about every downward-looking verb in the language.

3.8.7 Deictic boundary

Several directional meanings in Tedim are better described from the deictic center than from post-verbal suffixes alone. The literature discusses pre-verbal *va-* 'away' and *hong-* or *ong-* 'toward the speaker / venitive' as a separate subsystem (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017; Otsuka and Kurabe). The present section does not merge those markers with the post-verbal forms above, because the checked examples here are strongest for post-verbal or post-stem material rather than for a full deictic paradigm.

This also keeps the present section distinct from the demonstrative system. Directional perspective is clearly relevant, but the forms treated here are verbal rather than demonstrative.

3.8.8 TAM and VP-structure boundary

The present section also stops short of a full account of TAM or serial-like verbal sequencing. The upward Gospel row *a kilaktoh ding hun* 'the time for him to be taken up' shows that a directional element can stand before *ding* 'irrealis / prospective', but that single pattern is not enough to settle the full order of aspect, direction, TAM, and clause linkage.

Likewise, noun-like forms such as *hotkhiatna* ‘salvation’ and *kahtohna* ‘going up’ show why some directional-looking material belongs with nominalization or broader verb-phrase structure rather than with a simple inventory of finite directional suffixes.

3.8.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *tawplam* ‘toward the side / at the edge’ keeps *-lam* visible, but the form is still too noun-like for a clean verbal directional claim.
- *paitoh* ‘go-accompany’ remains a blocked overlap row rather than upward evidence.
- *uilut*, *paiphei*, *cip*, and *tang* are still too noisy or too weakly supported for the present account.
- The section does not attempt a full lexicon of motion verbs, a full deictic paradigm, or a full suffix-order analysis.

3.8.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim directionals are currently best described through a small checked set of post-verbal forms. *-khia* ‘outward’, *-khiat* ‘away’, *-toh* ‘upward’, *-sawn* ‘toward’, and *-suk* ‘downward’ are all visible, but only *-toh* and *-sawn* currently show balanced Old Testament and Gospel formal examples in this section. The rest remains explicitly delimited by nominalization, deictic, or verb-phrase boundaries rather than expanded into a full directional chapter.

3.9 Derivation / valency

The current derivation and valency evidence is strongest around *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’, especially *paisak* ‘cause to go’ and *muhsak* ‘show / make see’, while *-pih* ‘with / accompanying’, *ki-* ‘reflexive / middle / passive-like’, and heavier suffix stacks remain boundary material.

3.9.1 Overview of derivation and valency change

This section treats a controlled part of Tedim derivation and valency-changing morphology rather than the whole derivational system. The clearest present anchors are *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’, especially *paisak* ‘cause to go’ and *muhsak* ‘show / make see’, while *-pih* ‘with / accompanying’, *ki-* ‘reflexive / middle / passive-like’, and heavier suffix stacks such as *ciahsakkik* ‘send back’, *bawlsakthei* ‘can cause to make’, and *paikhiatsak* ‘cause to go out’ remain explicit boundaries.

The goal is therefore modest. It is enough to show that Tedim has a productive causative use of *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’, a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use centered on *muhsak* ‘show / make see’, and several nearby constructions that should not yet be folded into the same account.

3.9.2 Current derivation / valency inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
Form I + *-sak*	productive causative	*paisak*	supported	safest core claim
Form II + *-sak*	benefactive or applicative-like extension	*muhsak*	supported with caution	higher-level suffix analysis remains open
paisak	cause to go	*Israel mite paisak in*, *ka kiangah hong paisak un*	supported	may interact with motion semantics

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
muhsak	show / make see	*ka hong muhsak thu khempeuh*, *na mit khua hong bangci muhsak ahi hiam*	supported with caution	exact benefactive versus applicative label remains open
paipih	go with / accompany	*paipih*	boundary material	*-pih* still overlaps comitative and benefactive readings
ki- forms	reflexive, middle, or passive-like material	*kisep*, *kigen*	boundary material	needs a separate account
ciahsakkik, *bawlsakthei*, *paikhiatsak*	derivation-heavy stacking	*hong ciahsakkik un*, *bawlsakthei*, *hong paikhiatsak ciangin*	boundary material	overlaps VP structure and suffix stacking
piangsak	lexicalized causative-looking verb	*piangsak*	boundary material	belongs with transitivity as well as derivation

The table keeps *paipih* ‘go with / accompany’, *kisep* ‘REFL-work / do by oneself’, *kigen* ‘be said / it is said’, and *piangsak* ‘cause to be born / create’ visible without turning them into solved core categories. A controlled section should show where the evidence is strongest and where it still shifts into neighboring domains.

3.9.3 Causative *-sak*

The form *paisak* ‘cause to go’ shows a productive causative use of *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’. The clearest current point is practical rather than maximal: Form I plus *-sak* regularly supports a straightforward causative reading, and *paisak* gives that pattern in a compact and transparent way.

The pair below keeps that point grounded in both Old Testament and Gospel material. In Exodus the form is an imperative meaning ‘let the people go’, while in Mark it again licenses motion toward the speaker.

(3.141) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:deriv-paisak-exod10: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Israel	*mì-tè*	*pái-sàk*	*ìn*
ISRAEL	person-PL	go-CAUS	ERG

‘let the people of Israel go’ (Exodus 10:7)

(3.142)

kà	*kìang-àh*	*hòng*	*pái-sàk*	*ùn*
1SG	beside-LOC	3→1	go-CAUS	IMP.PL

‘let them come to me’ (Mark 10:14)

These examples do not require a full derivational paradigm. They are enough to support the narrower point that *paisak* keeps a productive causative use clearly visible in ordinary discourse.

3.9.4 Benefactive and applicative-like *-sak*

The form *muhsak* ‘show / make see’ supports a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use of *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’. This subsection keeps the wording cautious on purpose: the evidence is strong enough to separate *muhsak* from the plain causative line, but it does not yet force a final theoretical choice about exactly how many suffix senses should be recognized.

The formal examples again show the same row across Old Testament and Gospel material. Habakkuk presents *muhsak* in a reporting context, while John uses it in a question about restored sight.

(3.143) *Nangmah kà hòng mùh-sak thù khèmpeuh*
2SG.PRO 1SG 3→1 see.II-BENF word all
'everything that I have shown you' (Habakkuk 2:2)

(3.144) *nà mìt khùa hòng bangci mùh-sak àhì hìam*
2SG eye town 3→1 how see.II-BENF be.3SG Q
'how did he open your eyes' (John 9:26)

This pair is best treated as a distinct *-sak* line rather than as a simple paraphrase of the causative examples above. At the same time, the section stays smaller than a full applicative chapter and avoids turning one well-supported row into a complete system claim.

3.9.5 The practical split within *-sak*

The practical descriptive split is therefore modest. Form I plus *-sak* supports causative use, while Form II plus *-sak* supports a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use.

That contrast is enough for a controlled grammar account, but the final theoretical status of the split remains open. It may prove best to describe these patterns as two readings within one suffixal domain, or as two tightly related derivational uses that should still be separated in description.

For the present account, the important point is simply that *paisak* 'cause to go' and *muhsak* 'show / make see' should not be flattened into the same gloss line. The contrast is real even if the larger suffix theory remains under discussion.

3.9.6 Boundary with *-pih*

The nearest boundary beyond *-sak* is *-pih* 'with / accompanying'. The form *paipih* 'go with / accompany' is transparent enough to keep in view, but its function still overlaps comitative, benefactive, and applicative readings too strongly for this section to promote it as a second core derivational anchor.

The same boundary also includes *mipihte* 'companions / associated people', which looks *pih*-based but is noun-centered rather than a clear verbal valency pattern. That is why the present section names *-pih* as an adjacent domain without turning it into a separate applicative chapter.

3.9.7 Boundary with *ki-*

The prefix *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like' likewise remains outside the present core account. The clearest future anchor is still *kisep* 'REFL-work / do by oneself', while *kigen* 'be said / it is said' shows the more agent-defocused or passive-like side of the same domain.

Both forms matter because they show that valency change in Tedim is not confined to suffixes alone. Even so, the present section does not absorb reflexive, middle, passive-like, or prefixal structure into a narrow *-sak* discussion.

3.9.8 Boundary with VP stacking

The overlap with VP structure is easiest to see in derivation-heavy stacks. *Ciahsakkik* 'send back' is the clearest matched pair, and it shows why derivational morphology and suffix ordering must sometimes be discussed together without being collapsed into one chapter. The same boundary keeps *bawlsakthei* 'can cause to make' and *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out' visible as nearby stacked forms.

(3.145) *hòng ciah-sàk-kík ùn*
3→1 return-CAUS-ITER IMP.PL
'send me back' (Genesis 24:54)

(3.146) *à* *guak* *ciah-sàk-kík* *ùh* *hì*
3SG back return-CAUS-ITER 2/3PL DECL
'they sent him back empty' (Mark 12:3)

These examples are useful precisely because they stop short of a larger template claim. They show that derivational material can participate in bigger suffix strings, while still leaving the full architecture of those strings to the VP section.

3.9.9 Boundary with transitivity

Some causative-looking verbs remain better treated as transitivity-adjacent lexical items than as first-line derivational evidence. *Piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' is the clearest current example: it is too important to ignore, but too lexicalized to carry the same descriptive weight as *paisak* 'cause to go'.

This is why the present section does not try to settle every transitivity question inside the *-sak* domain. Productive causative morphology and lexicalized transitive verbs meet here, but they should not yet be treated as one solved class.

3.9.10 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *paisak* 'cause to go' and *muhsak* 'show / make see' are the clearest current anchors, but they do not exhaust the derivational system.
- *paipih* 'go with / accompany' and *mipihte* 'companions / associated people' keep the *-pih* boundary visible without settling its broader function.
- *kisep* 'REFL-work / do by oneself' and *kigen* 'be said / it is said' show that *ki-* needs a separate reflexive, middle, and passive-like treatment.
- *ciahsakkik* 'send back', *bawlsakthei* 'can cause to make', and *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out' belong to the derivation-VP boundary rather than to a compact suffix list.
- *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' remains adjacent evidence at the edge of transitivity and lexicalization.
- The section therefore stays with a narrow *-sak* account instead of expanding into a full derivational morphology or valency-changing chapter.

3.9.11 Summary

The safest conclusion is that Tedim already shows a controlled derivation / valency contrast centered on *-sak* 'causative / benefactive'. *Paisak* 'cause to go' supports a productive causative use, *muhsak* 'show / make see' supports a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use, and derivation-heavy stacks such as *ciahsakkik* 'send back' show how quickly the same material meets VP structure. The broader systems of *-pih*, *ki-*, and lexicalized transitivity remain visible, but they remain outside the present account.

3.10 ki- reflexive / reciprocal / middle

The current *ki-* evidence is strongest for reciprocal *ki-gawm* 'join together' and subject-affected *ki-lak-toh* 'be taken up', while passive-like *kigen* 'be said / be told' and lexicalized forms such as *kipan* 'begin / from' remain explicit boundary material.

3.10.1 Overview of *ki-* reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like marking

This section isolates *ki-* 'reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like' so that voice-like evidence is no longer scattered across unrelated chapters. The first claim is deliberately narrow: reciprocal *ki-gawm* 'join together' and subject-affected *kilaktoh* 'be taken up' are the clearest currently promoted constructions.

The forms *kisep* 'REFL-work / do by oneself' and *kigen* 'be said / be told' remain useful but cautious support because lexicalization risk remains real. This section therefore does not claim a full voice chapter, a full transitivity chapter, a full prefix/agreement chapter, a full derivation chapter, or a full VP-slot template.

3.10.2 Current *ki-* inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
ki-gawm	reciprocal predicate	spouse-pair and dual-participant clauses	supported core	reciprocal evidence does not settle all *ki-* behavior
kilaktoh	middle or subject-affected predicate	"be taken up" rows	supported with caution	overlaps directionals and VP stacking
kigen	passive-like or agent-defocused reporting	"be told / cannot be told" rows	supported with caution	analyzer glossing is partly lexicalized
kisep	reflexive or self-directed support row	"work done" rows	supporting candidate	can be lexicalized in procedural discourse
kipan	lexicalized or frozen *ki-* form	begin/from sequences	boundary material	not a safe reflexive core claim
ki-phuak, *ki-piak-na*	*ki-* with derivational or VP layering	naming and nominalized-event rows	boundary material	overlaps TAM, nominalization, and valency
report-only *kibawl* counts	discovery-only inventory	count-heavy report tables	blocked	count totals are not constructional proof

3.10.3 Safest reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like evidence

Reciprocal *ki-gawm* 'join together' is the strongest starting point because participant structure is explicit and parallel across Old Testament and Gospel examples.

(3.147) *à zi tàwh kī-gawm à, àmau tegel pum khàt à bàng ùh hì.*
3SG wife COM REFL-seize 3SG 3PL.PRO both body one 3SG like 2/3PL DECL
'He is joined with his wife, and the two become one body.' (Genesis 2:24)

Matthew 19:5 provides the Gospel counterpart with the same reciprocal predicate.

(3.148) *à zi tàwh kī-gawm dìng à, àmau tegel pumkhat à bàng dìng ùh hì.*
3SG wife COM REFL-seize IRR 3SG 3PL.PRO both body 3SG like IRR 2/3PL DECL
'He will be joined with his wife, and the two will become one body.' (Matthew 19:5)

Subject-affected *kilaktoh* 'be taken up' supplies the cleanest middle-like support now available, while still keeping directional and VP overlap visible.

(3.149) *kī-làk-tòh*
REFL-take-UP
'was taken up' (Numbers 9:17)

Luke 9:51 gives the Gospel counterpart for the same subject-affected construction.

(3.150) *à kī-làk-tòh dìng hùn*
3SG REFL-take-UP IRR time
'the time for him to be taken up' (Luke 9:51)

3.10.4 Passive-like or agent-defocused evidence

Passive-like or agent-defocused *kigen* 'be said / be told' is useful, but it must remain cautious because lexicalized reporting uses are common.

(3.151) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:ki-pass-kigen-gen27: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Rebekah	*tùngàh*	*ki-gēn*	*hì.*
REBEKAH	on-LOC	conversation	DECL

'The words were told to Rebekah.' (Genesis 27:42)

Matthew 2:10 keeps the same *kigen* line in a Gospel clause with modal negation.

(3.152)

à	*lungdam-ná*	*ùh*	*ki-gēn*	*théi*	*lò*	*hì.*
3SG	rejoice-NMLZ	2/3PL	conversation	know	NEG	DECL

'their joy could not be told.' (Matthew 2:10)

3.10.5 Lexicalized or frozen *ki-* boundary

Forms such as *kipan* 'begin / from' remain boundary material in this section. They are important for coverage, but they do not justify promotion into the core reflexive/reciprocal/middle claim.

(3.153)

Túa	*hùn*	*à*	*ki-pan-ìn*	*mì-tè*	*ìn*	*Topa*	*bía-ìn*	*à*	*mīn*	*làwh*	*dìng*	*kī-pan*
DIST	time	3SG	from	person-PL	ERG	Lord	worship-ERG	3SG	name	PERF	IRR	REFL-begin

tá	*ùh*	*hì.*
child	2/3PL	DECL

'From that time people began to call on the name of the Lord.' (Genesis 4:26)

Matthew 4:17 gives the Gospel counterpart with the same lexicalized begin/from profile.

(3.154)

Túa	*hùn*	*à*	*kī-pan*	*Jesuh*	*ìn*	*thù-hìlh*	*dìng*	*kī-pan*	*à.*
DIST	time	3SG	REFL-begin	JESUH	ERG	word-teach	IRR	REFL-begin	3SG

'From that time Jesus began to preach.' (Matthew 4:17)

3.10.6 Boundary with derivation, VP stacking, transitivity, and prefix/agreement

The forms *ki-phuak* 'be called' and *ki-piak-na* 'REFL-give-NMLZ' show that *ki-* rapidly crosses into derivation, nominalization, TAM layering, and VP stacking. The same is true for overlap with transitivity and prefix/agreement boundaries. For that reason, these rows remain boundary material rather than new core evidence in this first section.

3.10.7 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *ki-gawm* and *kilaktoh* support a controlled first claim, but they do not settle the full voice system.
- *kisep* and *kigen* remain cautious support rows with lexicalization risk.
- *kipan* remains lexicalized or frozen boundary material.
- *ki-* plus derivational, TAM, and VP-heavy material remains boundary material.
- Raw report counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.10.8 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is a narrow one: reciprocal *ki-gawm* and subject-affected *kilaktoh* provide clear first anchors for a dedicated *ki-* section, while passive-like *kigen*, supporting *kisep*, lexicalized *kipan*, and derivation/VP overlaps remain explicit boundaries.

3.11 -pih comitative applicative

The current *-pih* evidence is strongest for verbal comitative applicative forms such as *paipih* 'go with / accompany', *nekpih* 'eat with', and *tunpih* 'arrive with / bring with', while nominal *-pih* forms such as *innkuanpihte* 'family members' remain explicit boundary material.

3.11.1 Overview of verbal *-pih* comitative applicative

This section isolates verbal *-pih* as a comitative applicative suffix so that its function is no longer treated only as a boundary note within the derivation/valency account. The first claim is deliberately narrow but now empirically stabilized: verbal *-pih* is best treated as a Stem 2 / Form II selecting suffix that introduces or indexes a comitative participant or comitative object.

Verbal *-pih* must be kept distinct from nominal *-pih* meaning 'member / group member', which is documented independently by Henderson (1965) and illustrated in forms such as *innkuanpihte* 'family members' and *mipihte* 'group members / companions'. This section does not claim a full applicative chapter, a full valency chapter, a full derivational morphology chapter, a full VP-slot template, or a complete comitative system. It also does not treat every frequent *-pih* form as equally diagnostic for stem alternation: *nekpih* is currently the clearest internal diagnostic, while *paipih* and *paikhiatpih* require morphophonological caution around *pai / paih*.

3.11.2 Current *-pih* inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
paipih	comitative motion applicative	*paipih* in bring/lead contexts	supported core with stem caveat	strong functional evidence, but *pai / paih* diagnostics remain unresolved
nekpih	comitative eating applicative	*nekpih* in eat-together contexts	supported	strongest current stem-diagnostic row (*ne / nek*)
tunpih	comitative arrival applicative	*tunpih* in arrive/bring contexts	supported with caution	compatible with Stem 2 claim but not independently diagnostic
hopih	comitative encounter applicative	*hopih* in meet/greet contexts	supporting boundary material	high-frequency but stem base is unclear (*ho*/*hop*)
ompih	comitative dwelling applicative	*ompih* in stay/dwell contexts	boundary material	stative semantics interact with TAM and possessive analysis
hehpih	favor/grace lexical family	*hehpih* and *hehpihna* grace/mercy contexts	boundary material	lexicalized grace-family semantics; not a clean stem diagnostic
innkuanpihte	household member (NOMINAL)	Noah's household-member plural	boundary material	nominal -pih "group member" (Henderson); must not be treated as verbal applicative

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
mipihte	group member / companion plural (NOMINAL)	“his group members” contexts	boundary material	nominal -pih “group member” (Henderson); boundary only
paikhiatpih	go-out-with directional stack	bring out with + directional	boundary material	directional -khiat stacked before -pih; VP-stacking boundary
nominal *-pih* forms generally	member / group-member suffix	*innkuanpih*, *mipihte*, *kho-pih*	boundary material	different origin or domain from verbal applicative; cannot be conflated

3.11.3 Verbal *-pih* as comitative applicative

The clearest current evidence for verbal *-pih* as a comitative applicative is *paipih* ‘go with / accompany / bring’. The form is transparent and highly productive across the corpus, and it is consistent with the Otsuka (2011) analysis of *-pih* as a comitative applicative that attaches to Form II / Stem 2 verbs and introduces a new core argument representing either a comitative participant or a comitative object.

In Genesis the form appears as God bringing the woman to the man, introducing the woman as the accompanying participant.

(3.155) *mipa kìang-àh túa nù à pái-pìh hì.*
man beside-LOC DIST female 3SG go-APPL DECL
‘[God] brought her to the man.’ (Genesis 2:22)

The same form *paipih* appears in the Gospels in a motion-to-wilderness context where the Holy Spirit leads Jesus.

(3.156) *Khá Sìangtho ìn gàm-lak-àh Jesuh à pái-pìh hì.*
NEG.PERF holy ERG land-midst-LOC JESUH 3SG go-APPL DECL
‘The Holy Spirit led Jesus into the wilderness.’ (Matthew 4:1)

These two examples are enough to establish *paipih* as a productive verbal comitative applicative form. They do not, by themselves, prove the full stem-selection rule, because the exact *pai / paih* stem relation remains morphophonologically difficult in current section evidence.

3.11.4 Form II / Stem 2 restriction

The Form II restriction is established primarily by literature evidence. Otsuka (2011) states that comitative *-pih* attaches only to Form II verbs, and ZNC (2017/2018) independently documents this with explicit grammaticality contrasts.

The current section uses a split diagnostic logic rather than one undifferentiated claim:

- **Diagnostic row:** *nekpih*, because *ne / nek* is independently stabilized as a Form I / Form II pair in the stem-alternation section.
- **Compatible but not independently diagnostic rows:** *tunpih* and *ompih*.
- **Morphophonological-boundary rows:** *paipih* and *paikhiatpih*, because *pai / paih* remains unresolved in current section evidence and may involve non-realization of stem-final *h* before *-pih*.

The safest statement is therefore strong but bounded: Stem 2 selection is the best-supported analysis, but the corpus alone does not prove that rule equally for every *-pih* form.

This note is not a claim to have verified the restriction exhaustively. A human reviewer should check whether any counter-example exists in the wider corpus.

3.11.5 Transitive verb contexts

The comitative applicative also attaches to transitive verbs, as shown by *nekpih* 'eat together with'. In a Proverbs context the form appears in a purposive, clause-bound irrealis construction where the speaker invites the addressee to share a meal.

(3.157) *Kà nèk-pìh dìng-ìn nàng kà hòng zòng à, tù-ìn kòng mú pet-màh hì.*
1SG eat-with IRR-ERG 2SG.PRO 1SG 3→1 also 3SG now-ERG 1SG→3 see.I find-exactly DECL
'I came looking for you, to eat together with me.' (Proverbs 7:15)

The Gospel counterpart shows the same *nekpih* in an invitation clause where Jesus is the comitative participant.

(3.158) *Farisi mì khàt ìn àn nèk-pìh dìng-ìn Jesuh à sam hì.*
FARISI person one ERG 3PL.POSS eat-with IRR-ERG JESUH 3SG open DECL
'A Pharisee invited Jesus to eat with him.' (Luke 11:37)

Both rows show *nekpih* in purposive or clause-bound irrealis environments (*ding-in*), matching the grammar-facing treatment already used in TAM, clause-linkage, and VP-structure boundary discussions.

3.11.6 Motion verbs and comitative objects

Otsuka (2011) distinguishes two types of comitative argument introduced by *-pih*: a comitative participant (a person who goes along) and a comitative object (a thing that is brought along). The form *tunpih* 'arrive with / bring with / come with' illustrates both types.

In Genesis 8 the dove arrives with a freshly plucked olive leaf as comitative object.

(3.159) *oliv teh à tukkhiat thàk khàt à mú-kàh pet-ìn hòng tun-pìh hì.*
olive measure 3SG pluck.off new one 3SG see-mouth pluck-leaf 3→1 arrive-APPL DECL
'[the dove] arrived with a freshly plucked olive leaf in its beak.' (Genesis 8:11)

In Matthew 9 the same form *tunpih* introduces a comitative participant (the paralytic brought to Jesus).

(3.160) *Mì pàwl-khàt ìn khùt-lè-khe-zàw mì khàt à lupna pheek tàwh hòng*
person some-one ERG hand-and-foot-more person one 3SG bed bed COM 3→1
pua-ìn Jesuh kìang à hòng tun-pìh ùh hì.
carry.on.back-ERG JESUH beside 3SG 3→1 arrive-APPL 2/3PL DECL
'Some people brought a paralytic to Jesus.' (Matthew 9:2)

The contrast between these two rows keeps both comitative object and comitative participant uses visible without forcing a single analysis of all *tunpih* occurrences.

3.11.7 Boundary with nominal *-pih*

Nominal *-pih* meaning 'member / group member' must remain a visible boundary in any grammar-facing account of verbal *-pih*. Henderson (1965) documents this suffix with examples such as *a inkuan-pih te* 'his family members', *ka kho-pih* 'my village-mate', and *na sang-pih* 'your school-mate'. The corpus contains over a hundred occurrences of *innkuanpihte* 'family members' and *mipihte* 'group members', all in clearly nominal contexts.

No rows from this nominal domain have been promoted as verbal applicative evidence. The homophony is real and the synchronic relationship between the two *-pih* forms remains an open question in the literature.

3.11.8 Boundary with directionals, VP stacking, and *-pih* interactions

The form *paikhiatpih* 'bring out with' shows *-pih* stacked after the directional suffix *-khiat* 'away / out'. ZNC (2017/2018) also documents *pai-pih-suk* 'walk down along with', and Otsuka (2011) notes that *-pih* and the relinquitive *-san* can co-occur. These stacked forms are important for completeness but they remain boundary material in this first account.

Similarly, the high-frequency forms *hopih*, *hehpih*, and *ompih* appear extensively in the corpus in contexts that may involve lexicalized interaction, grace/mercy vocabulary, or stative-comitative readings. These rows remain supporting or boundary material: they are useful for distribution and coverage, but they are not treated as primary stem diagnostics.

3.11.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several areas remain outside this account.

- *paipih*, *nekpih*, and *tunpih* are the clearest promoted forms, but they play different diagnostic roles for stem alternation.
- *hopih*, *hehpih*, *ompih*, *ciahpih*, and *tenpih* appear frequently but their precise applicative vs lexicalized status remains unresolved.
- Stem 2 selection remains the best-supported rule, but *paipih* and *paikhiatpih* remain morphophonological-boundary rows for that rule.
- Nominal *innkuanpihte* and *mipihte* remain boundary material and must not be promoted as verbal evidence.
- Stacked directional forms such as *paikhiatpih* remain boundary material pending VP-slot analysis.
- The potential benefactive reading of *-pih* (noted by Otsuka as a possible secondary sense) is not promoted and remains an open question.
- Raw report counts are not grammar facts without constructional and stem-diagnostic control.
- The comitative system as a whole — including *-khawm* 'together' and case-marked comitative strategies — lies outside the present narrow account.

3.11.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is a narrow but concrete one: Tedim has a verbal *-pih* comitative applicative suffix best analyzed as Stem 2 selecting. *Nekpih* provides the clearest section-internal diagnostic support for that stem claim; *paipih* and *tunpih* remain strong functional evidence, with *paipih* explicitly caveated as a morphophonological-boundary row around *pai / paih*. Nominal *-pih* 'member / group member' remains a separate boundary category, and stacked directional or VP-heavy forms remain outside the present core claim.

3.12 Nominalization

The current nominalization evidence is strongest for productive deverbal *-na* 'nominalizer', with *bawlna* 'making / creation' as a compact anchor, while *-pa* 'agentive / person' and *-mi* 'person / one who' material remains explicit boundary evidence.

3.12.1 Overview of nominalization in this section

This section treats a controlled part of Tedim nominalization centered on productive deverbal *-na* 'nominalizer'. It keeps agentive or person-head material and nominalized relative-clause material as boundaries so the discussion remains grammar-facing without turning into a full nominalization, relative-clause, or derivational chapter.

3.12.2 Current nominalization inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-na	deverbal nominalizer	*theihna*, *ciaptehna*	well supported	broader nominalization inventory remains open
bawlna	deverbal nominal from *bawl*	lexical anchor in running prose	supported with caveat	needs wider textual distribution work
bawl-na	segmented deverbal nominal	morpheme-level analysis	supported with caveat	segmentation is clearer than full paradigm scope
-pa	agentive or person-head nominalization	*lawmpa*, *bawlpa*	boundary material	overlaps lexicalized and title-like uses
-mi	person-head or relative-linked nominalization	*a hong pai mi*, *a bawl mi*	boundary material	overlaps relative-clause analysis
omna	nominalized clause-like form	*omna mun* patterns	boundary material	overlaps clause linkage and NP structure
muhna-ah	nominalization plus case-like marking	*Pasian' muhna-ah*	boundary material	overlaps case marking and clause linkage
kumpipa	lexicalized title-like form	royal title contexts	boundary material	not a transparent productive *-pa* pattern
Topa	title-like lexical form	reverential title contexts	boundary material	cannot be treated as a productive *-pa* derivation

3.12.3 Deverbal nominalization with *-na*

The suffix *-na* 'nominalizer' forms deverbal nouns and remains the safest productive anchor in the current evidence. The form *bawlna* 'making / creation' with segmentation *bawl-na* 'make-NMLZ' is the clearest compact anchor for this function, even though a full paradigm is still outside the present account.

The same morphology appears in stable textual examples such as *theihna* 'knowledge' and *ciaptehna* 'record / writing'. Together they support a grammar-facing claim for productive deverbal nominalization without forcing a full inventory of all nominal outcomes.

(3.161)

à	*phà*	*lè*	*à*	*sía*	*thèih-ná*	*sing-kung*	*gah*
3SG	branch	and	3SG	evil	know.II-NMLZ	tree	branch

'the fruit of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil' (Genesis 2:17)

(3.162)

Abraham'	*suan*	*David,*	*David'*	*suan*	*Jesuh*	*Khrih'*	*khang*	*ciapteh-ná*
ABRAHAM.POSS	plant	DAVID	DAVID.POSS	plant	JESUH	KHRIH.POSS	generation	receive-NMLZ
híh	*bàng*	*àhì*	*hì.*					
PROX	like	be.3SG	DECL					

'This is the record of the genealogy of Jesus Christ, son of David, son of Abraham.' (Matthew 1:1)

3.12.4 Nominalization and stem alternation

Nominalized contexts connect directly to Form II evidence in stem alternation, especially where forms such as *theihna* 'knowledge' keep a nominalizer on a stem family that also participates in Form I/Form II contrasts. This is useful as constructional evidence, but it does not reopen a full stem-alternation chapter here.

The key point is local: nominalized environments help explain why Form II-like material remains visible in nominalized stems, while broader stem-class claims still depend on the stem-alternation section.

(3.163) *à phà lè à sía thèih-ná sing-kung*
3SG branch and 3SG evil know.II-NMLZ tree
'the tree of the knowledge of good and evil' (Genesis 2:9)

(3.164) *nà lakkhiat thèih-ná dìng-ùn*
2SG snatch know.II-NMLZ IRR-PL.IMP
'so that you may be able to remove it' (Matthew 7:5)

3.12.5 Agentive or person-head nominalization boundary

Agentive and person-head material is visible through *-pa* 'agentive / person' and *-mi* 'person / one who', including forms such as *bawlpa* 'maker / doer' and *hong pai mi* 'one who came'. The current evidence supports discussing these forms as boundaries, but not promoting them to the core nominalization system yet.

This caution matters because *-pa* patterns are easily mixed with lexicalized titles, while *-mi* patterns are often indistinguishable from person-head relative constructions.

(3.165) *Túa ciang-ìn à lawm-pá ìn dawng-ìn.*
DIST then-ERG 3SG worthy-NMLZ.AG ERG receive-ERG
'Then his companion answered.' (Judges 7:14)

(3.166) *À lawm-pá Josef pèn à màn-ìn à gamta núam mì khàt*
3SG worthy-NMLZ.AG JOSEF TOP 3SG reason-ERG 3SG send.away want person one
àhìh màn-ìn
be.3SG.REL reason-ERG
'Because Joseph her husband was a righteous man' (Matthew 1:19)

3.12.6 Nominalized relatives and clause-derived nominalization boundary

Forms such as *omna* 'place / being / existence' and *a bawl mi* 'one who made' belong to the overlap between nominalization and relative-clause structure. They are important for analysis, but they remain boundary material in this section.

The same is true for *a hong pai mi* 'one who came': it is structurally informative, but it is safer to coordinate with clause linkage than to treat it as a settled nominalization subtype here.

(3.167) *bìak-ná à pía dìng-ìn à hòng pái mì khèmpeuh ìn túa beel-tè zang-ìn*
worship-NMLZ 3SG give IRR-ERG 3SG 3→1 go person all ERG DIST pan-PL side-CVB
'all who come to offer sacrifice will use those pots' (Zechariah 14:21)

(3.168) *kà kìang-àh à hòng pái mì peuhmah kà hawlkhia kèi dìng hì.*
1SG beside-LOC 3SG 3→1 go person whosoever 1SG drive.out NEG IRR DECL
'I will never cast out anyone who comes to me.' (John 6:37)

3.12.7 Nominalization plus case boundary

Nominalization-plus-case forms such as *muhna-ah* ‘in seeing / in the sight of’ are well attested but structurally mixed. They show nominalization and case-like morphology in the same form, so they belong partly with case marking and partly with clause linkage.

For that reason, this section treats them as boundary evidence rather than as a core nominalization subtype.

(3.169)

Tù-ìn	*Pasian’*	*mùh-ná-àh*	*léi-tùng*	*sía*	*à.*
now-ERG	God.POSS	see.II-NMLZ-LOC	land-on	evil	3SG

‘Now the earth was corrupt in the sight of God.’ (Genesis 6:11)

(3.170)

kèima	*mùh-ná-àh*	*thàt*	*ùn.*
1SG.self	see.II-NMLZ-LOC	kill	IMP.PL

‘kill them before me.’ (Luke 19:27)

3.12.8 Lexicalized and title-like boundary material

Title-like forms such as *kumpipa* ‘king’ and *Topa* ‘Lord’ are important to keep visible because they look segmentable but behave as lexicalized items in many contexts. Treating them as straightforward productive *-pa* nominalizations would overstate what the controlled evidence currently supports.

These rows therefore remain lexicalized boundary material in the present account.

(3.171)

Filistia	*mite’*	*kùmpì-pà*	*Abimelek’*	*ōm-ná*	*Gerar-àh*	*Isaac*	*pái*	*hì.*
FILISTIA	person-PL.POSS	king-male	ABIMELEK.POSS	exist-NMLZ	GERAR-LOC	ISAAC	go	DECL

‘Isaac went to Gerar, where Abimelech king of the Philistines lived.’ (Genesis 26:1)

(3.172)

Topa’	*mùh-ná-àh*	*àmàh*	*mì-lìan*	*khàt*	*hì*	*dìng*	*hì.*
Lord.POSS	see.II-NMLZ-LOC	3SG.PRO	person-great	one	DECL	IRR	DECL

‘He will be great in the sight of the Lord.’ (Luke 1:15)

3.12.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *bawlna* and *bawl-na* support a controlled deverbal core, but they do not by themselves settle the full nominalization paradigm.
- *-pa*, *bawlpa*, *-mi*, and *hong pai mi* remain boundary material until lexicalized-title and relative-clause overlap is clearer.
- *omna* and *a bawl mi* ‘person who’ remain boundary forms shared with clause linkage and relative structure.
- *muhna-ah* remains a boundary form shared with case marking and clause linkage.
- *kumpipa* and *Topa* remain lexicalized or title-like rows rather than transparent productive derivations.
- Bare *na* remains noisy and should not be promoted without stronger controlled evidence.
- Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.12.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim has productive deverbal nominalization with *-na* ‘nominalizer’, with *bawlna* ‘making / creation’ and *bawl-na* ‘make-NMLZ’ as compact anchors. Agentive and person-head material, nominalized relative patterns, nominalization-plus-case forms, and lexicalized title-like forms remain explicit boundaries so the section stays controlled.

3.13 Clause linkage

The current clause-linkage evidence is strongest for temporal subordination with *ciangin* 'when', marked clause-finally as *tua ciangin* 'then / when', while purposive material with *dingin* 'in order to', same-subject converb construction with *ngenin* 'pray-CVB', different-subject marking with *ahih ciangin* 'when', and relative clauses including *a bawl mi* 'person who' remain explicit boundary material.

3.13.1 Overview of clause linkage in this section

This section treats controlled temporal subordination with *ciangin* 'when' as the core clause-linkage anchor. Purposive marking with *dingin* 'in order to', same-subject converb construction with *ngenin* 'pray-CVB', different-subject temporal linkage with *ahih ciangin* 'when', prenominal relative clauses with *a bawl mi* 'person who', and nominalization-plus-case forms with *muhna-ah* 'in seeing / in the sight' remain explicit boundaries. The section stays narrow without attempting a full complex-sentence, switch-reference, relative-clause, or nominalized-clause chapter.

3.13.2 Core temporal subordination: ciangin

The suffix *ciangin* 'when' is the safest productive anchor for clause linkage and forms temporal subordinate clauses. The form *tua ciangin* 'then / when' with segmentation *tua ciang-in* 'that when-ERG' is the clearest compact anchor for temporal subordination, and it appears consistently across Bible texts.

The same morphology appears in patterns such as *ahih ciangin* 'when it was' where a relative marker *ahih* precedes the subordinator, showing how temporal linkage interacts with relative-clause structure. Together they support a grammar-facing claim for controlled temporal subordination without forcing a full inventory of all subordination outcomes.

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current status	Boundary issue
ciangin	temporal subordination	clause-final temporal marker	supported core	broader clause-linkage inventory remains open
tua ciangin	controlled temporal subordination	compact clause-linking anchor	supported core	same *-in* suffix appears in other contexts
ciang-in	segmented form	morpheme analysis	supported core	*-in* suffix has broader uses

The following example illustrates temporal subordination with the clearest Old Testament anchor:

(3.173) *Pasian ìn, khuavak ōm hèn" cí hì; túa ciàng-ìn khuavak ōm pah hì.*
God ERG light exist JUSS say DECL DIST then-ERG light exist do.so DECL
'And God said, "Let there be light:" and there was light.' (Genesis 1:3)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.13.3 Purposive or clause-bound irrealis boundary: dingin

Dingin 'in order to' is relevant to clause linkage because it marks purposive or clause-bound irrealis use, but it remains partly shared with the TAM system. At the current maturity level, *dingin* is visible only as a caveated boundary row: it helps show that clause linkage interacts with purposive and irrealis marking, but it does not yet justify a broader clause-linkage or TAM rewrite.

The grammar claim stays cautious on purpose. The form *dingin* with segmentation *ding-in* 'IRR-ERG' shows the same *-in* 'ergative / agentive' suffix as temporal *ciangin*, but the theoretical status of *-in* across these contexts remains open.

(3.174) *Pasian ìn, sun lè zān à khen dìng-ìn vantung-àh khuavak-tè ōm hèn;*
God ERG basket and break 3SG divide IRR-ERG heaven-LOC light-PL exist JUSS

‘And God said, ”Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night...”’ (Genesis 1:14)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.13.4 Same-subject converb linkage boundary: VERB-in and ngenin

Same-subject clause chaining is marked by the converb suffix *-in* ‘converbial / linking’ on the first verb. The pattern is notated as *VERB-in* ‘converb’ (e.g., *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’), indicating that the subject of the linked clause is identical to the subject of the following main clause. The form *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’ is the clearest anchor example.

This material remains boundary-only in the present account because the exact status of *-in* as converb, subordinator, or broader linker still needs clearer theoretical control. Treating same-subject chaining as a settled part of clause linkage would require closing the converb-versus-subordination question first.

(3.175) *Egypt gàm khèmpeuh à kial cìang-ìn, àn ngen-ìn mì-tè Faro’ tùngàh*
EGYPT land all 3SG hunger then-ERG 3PL.POSS net-IN person-PL FARO.POSS on-LOC
kiko ùh hì.
cry.out 2/3PL DECL

‘And when all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread...’ (Genesis 41:55)

No equally clean Gospel example of same-subject converb construction is currently used for this boundary row.

3.13.5 Different-subject temporal linkage boundary: ahih ciangin

Different-subject temporal linkage uses *ahih ciangin* ‘when / when it was’ where a relative marker *ahih* precedes the temporal subordinator *ciangin*. This construction marks temporal clauses with different subjects from the main clause.

The construction is important structurally, but it remains boundary material because different-subject linkage still overlaps with relative-marker use and pronominal material. The form *ahih* functions as a relative marker (glossed as a third-person plural or relative form) rather than as a dedicated different-subject marker.

(3.176) *Túa àhìh cìang-ìn Pasian ìn tùi-pì ganhing gol-pì-tè lè àmau*
DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG God ERG water-big animal creature-great-PL and 3PL.PRO
nām ciatin tùi-pì sùng-àh tampi.
nation each.kind.ERG water-big inside-LOC many

‘And God created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth...’ (Genesis 1:21)

No equally clean Gospel example of different-subject temporal linkage with *ahih ciangin* is currently used for this construction.

3.13.6 Prenominal relative-clause boundary: a bawl mi

The prenominal relative clause uses the relativizer prefix *a-* to mark a relative verb, with the head noun following. The form *a bawl mi* ‘person who makes’ is the clearest anchor, showing how relative clauses with human head nouns are formed.

This material remains boundary-only because relative clauses still interact with prefix/agreement and nominalization material. Settling relative-clause structure requires clearer boundary control with the prefix system.

(3.177) *pāk-nam-tui à bāwl mì peuhmah*
ointment 3SG make person whosoever
'whoever makes any like it' (Exodus 30:38)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.13.7 Nominalized relative and clause-like form boundary: omna

The form *omna* 'place / being / existence' is a nominalized relative or clause-derived form. It appears in patterns like *omna mun* where it marks a location or predication related to a nominalized clause.

This material belongs to the overlap between nominalization and relative-clause structure. Settling *omna* as a nominalized relative would require fuller boundary control with the nominalization section, which is why it remains explicitly boundary material here.

3.13.8 Nominalization-plus-case boundary: muhna-ah

Forms such as *muhna-ah* 'in seeing / in the sight of' combine nominalization with locative case-like morphology. The form shows nominalizer *-na* 'nominalizer' plus locative *-ah* 'locative / goal-like', creating sight-expressions used in temporal or spatial adjuncts.

This material is structurally mixed because it belongs partly with case marking and partly with clause linkage. For that reason, this section treats it as boundary evidence rather than as a core clause-linkage subtype.

(3.178) *Tù-ìn Pasian' mùh-ná-àh léi-tùng sía à.*
now-ERG God.POSS see.II-NMLZ-LOC land-on evil 3SG
'Now the earth was corrupt in the sight of God.' (Genesis 6:11)

A Gospel parallel shows the same nominalization-plus-case boundary in a different context:

(3.179) *kèima mùh-ná-àh thàt ùn.*
1SG.self see.II-NMLZ-LOC kill IMP.PL
'kill them before me.' (Luke 19:27)

3.13.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *ciangin* and *tua ciangin* support a controlled temporal subordination core, but they do not by themselves settle the full clause-linkage paradigm or resolve whether subordinators form a unified system.
- *dingin* remains a boundary row until the irrealis and purposive layers are clearer.
- *VERB-in* and *ngenin* remain boundary material until the converb-versus-subordination distinction is theoretically settled.
- *ahih ciangin* 'when / when it was' remains a boundary form shared with relative-marker and pronominal material.
- *a bawl mi* and *omna* remain boundary forms shared with relative-clause and nominalization structure.
- *muhna-ah* remains a boundary form shared with case marking and nominalization.
- *leh* 'if / when / conditional' remains outside because sentence-final-particle, coordinator, and subordinator analyses still overlap.
- *hangin* 'because / causal' and *bangin* 'like / as / comparative' remain broader report-inventory rows rather than the first safe clause-linkage anchors.
- full switch-reference system claims remain deferred.
- full relative-clause system claims remain deferred.
- broader discourse-level linkage remains outside this controlled sentence-level slice.
- Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.13.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim has controlled evidence for temporal subordination with *ciangin* ‘when’, with *tua ciangin* ‘then / when’ as a compact anchor showing clause-final temporal marking. Purposive material with *dingin*, same-subject converb construction with *ngenin*, different-subject marking with *ahih ciangin*, relative clauses with *a bawl mi*, nominalized relatives with *omna*, and nominalization-plus-case forms with *muhna-ah* remain explicit boundaries so the section stays controlled.

3.14 Same-subject and different-subject clause linkage

The current clause-linkage evidence is narrow: same-subject *bawlin* ‘make-CVB’ and *semin* ‘serve-CVB’ are secure, *bawlin* is printed as a trimmed excerpt because Genesis 11:4 is crowded with boundary *-in* tokens, *semin* is kept in full because the Deuteronomy chain is already compact, the report-level *VERB-in* ‘converb’ label is only a comparison term, *ahih ciangin* ‘when / when it was’ is support only, and ordinary *ciangin* ‘when’, *dingin* ‘in order to / clause-bound irrealis’, *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’, *a bawl mi* ‘person who’, *omna* ‘place / being / existence’, and *muhna-ah* ‘in seeing / in the sight’ stay boundary-controlled. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.14.1 Overview of the current evidence

The report calls this domain switch reference, but the safer grammar-facing label is same-subject and different-subject clause linkage. The secure core is same-subject converb-like linkage; *ahih ciangin* remains support only; ordinary *ciangin*, purposive *dingin*, blocked *ngenin*, and relative / nominalized material stay boundary-controlled. No full switch-reference system is claimed.

Current display inventory

Form or pattern	Bible source	Target token	Nearby *-in* control	Display status	Subject relation
bawlin	Genesis 11:4	*bawl-in*	*amaute in* = ERG; *nadingin* = PURP/ERG; *a dawn in* = ERG; *lamin* = directional; target converb isolated in the excerpt	promoted; trimmed excerpt	same
semin	Deuteronomy 10:20	*sem-in*	*beel-in* = boundary/unresolved; repeated *na* = 2SG agreement (not a target *-in*)	promoted; full verse justified	same
ahih ciangin	Genesis 1:21	*ciang-in*	*Pasian in* = ERG; *ahih* = relative marker; no dedicated DS *-in*	support only; table row only	ambiguous
ngenin	Genesis 41:55	*ngen-in*	*ciang-in* = temporal boundary; analyzer split *net-IN* / *pray-CVB*	blocked; table row only	unrecoverable

Form or pattern	Bible source	Target token	Nearby *-in* control	Display status	Subject relation
ciangin	Genesis 1:3	*ciang-in*	*Pasian in* = ERG	boundary row only	not diagnostic
dingin	Genesis 1:14	*ding-in*	*Pasian in* = ERG; *vantung-ah* = locative	boundary row only	not diagnostic
a bawl mi	Exodus 30:38	n/a	relative-marker *a-* and head noun boundary	boundary row only	not diagnostic
omna	Genesis 4:16	n/a	nominalized clause boundary	boundary row only	not diagnostic
muhna-ah	Genesis 6:11	n/a	nominalization-plus-case boundary	boundary row only	not diagnostic

Promoted same-subject evidence *bawlin* 'make-CVB' is the clearest same-subject anchor because the same *eite* 'we.INCL' controller continues into the following *bawl ni* clause. The verse is trimmed for display so the target *bawl-in* is not buried under other boundary *-in* tokens.

(3.180) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:sr-bawlin-gen11p4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

.	*khùa-pì*	*khàt*	*bāwl-ìn.*	*eite'*	*minthan*	*nàdìng*	*khàt*	*bāwl*	*nì.*
village-big	one	make-CVB	1PL.PRO.POSS	bless	PURP	one	make	day	

'... let us build us a city... and let us make us a name...' (Genesis 11:4)

The full verse contains nearby boundary *-in* tokens (*amaute in*, *nadingin*, *a dawn in*, *lamin*), but they are not the target converb.

semin 'serve-CVB' is the other secure same-subject anchor. The current verse keeps the same *note* controller across the clause chain, and *beel-in* is boundary material rather than a second converb anchor.

(3.181)

Topa	*nòtè'*	*Pasian*	*nà*	*zah-tàk*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*à,*	*àmà*	*nà*	*sèm-ìn,*	*àmàh*
Lord	2PL.PRO.POSS	God	2SG	fear-true	IRR	2/3PL	3SG	3SG.POSS	2SG	serve-CVB	3SG.PRO

beel-ìn,	*àmà*	*mīn*	*tàwh*	*nà*	*ki-ciam*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì.*
pan-ERG	3SG.POSS	name	COM	2SG	covenant	IRR	2/3PL	DECL

'Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God; him shalt thou serve, and to him shalt thou cleave, and swear by his name.' (Deuteronomy 10:20)

The person glossing stays *2SG* for *na* to match the prefix/agreement slice, and the verse is kept in full because the same-subject chain is already compact enough to read cleanly.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

Support-only and boundary material *ahih ciangin* stays support only. It is source-resolved, but the construction is temporally framed and does not independently prove a dedicated different-subject marker.

Ordinary *ciangin* remains the temporal subordinator; *dingin* remains purposive / clause-bound irrealis material; *ngenin* stays blocked because the analyzer export splits *net-IN* and *pray-CVB*. Relative-clause and nominalization material (*a bawl mi*, *omna*, *muhna-ah*) stays outside the core subject-tracking claim.

Deferred material This section does not claim a full switch-reference system, full subordination chapter, full relative-clause chapter, full converb chapter, or full discourse system.

4 Clause type, discourse-facing material, and expressive morphology

4.1 Negation

The current negation evidence supports a three-way core around *lo* 'NEG' for ordinary clause negation, *loh* 'dependent / derived NEG' in dependent environments, and *kei* 'NEG / prohibitive NEG' in prohibitives and irrealis-heavy negative contexts.

4.1.1 Overview of negation in Tedim

Tedim negation is not reducible to *lo* 'NEG' alone. The current controlled evidence supports at least three major zones: ordinary clause-level negation with *lo* 'NEG', dependent or derived negation with *loh* 'dependent / derived NEG', and *kei* 'NEG / prohibitive NEG' in prohibitives and other irrealis-heavy negative environments (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

4.1.2 Negation inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
lo	clause-level NEG	*thusim lo hi*	core	not the whole system
lo hi	NEG DECL	*kigen thei lo hi*	core	overlaps with sentence-final declarative material
loh	dependent / derived NEG	*zuih loh nadingin*	core	not a free alternant of ordinary *lo*
loh ding-a	NEG.DEP IRR-LOC/FUNC	*nek loh ding-a*	core	overlaps with TAM and purposive linkage
kei	NEG / prohibitive NEG	*su kei in*	core	also appears outside strict prohibitives
kei in	NEG IMP.SG	*pau kei in*	core	imperative-only shape
kei un	NEG IMP.PL	*kihta kei un*	core	imperative-only shape
om lo hi	not exist / be absent	*tui om lo hi*	core	existential boundary with possession
nei lo hi	not have	*aana nei lo hi*	core	possession boundary
nawn lo	no longer / not again	*om nawn lo hi*	core	constructional, not a new basic negator
thei lo	cannot / not know	*thei lo hi*	core	ability overlaps with modal subsystem
theih loh	dependent inability / not being able	*sep theih loh*	core	dependent form overlaps with linkage
kuamah	nobody	*kuamah mu lo*	core with filtering	needs licensing context

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
bangmah	nothing	*bangmah om lo hi*	core with filtering	has non-NPI uses such as *tua bangmah hi-in*

4.1.3 Clause-level negation with *lo*

Lo ‘NEG’ is the safest ordinary clause-level negator, and *lo hi* ‘NEG DECL’ is common in straightforward predicate negation.

Genesis 4:5 gives a compact clause-level OT anchor.

(4.182)

Kain	*lè*	*àmà*	*pìak-ná*	*thusim*	*lò*	*hì.*
KAIN	and	3SG.POSS	give.to-NMLZ	parable	NEG	DECL

‘he had not respect for Cain and his offering.’ (Genesis 4:5)

Matthew 2:10 gives a Gospel comparandum in the same clause-level zone.

(4.183)

Túa	*aksi*	*à*	*mùh*	*ùh*	*cìang-ìn*	*à*	*lungdam-ná*	*ùh*	*ki-gēn*	*théi*	*lò*	*hì.*
DIST	star	3SG	see.II	2/3PL	then-ERG	3SG	rejoice-NMLZ	2/3PL	conversation	know	NEG	DECL

‘their joy could not be told.’ (Matthew 2:10)

4.1.4 Dependent and derived negation with *loh*

Loh ‘dependent / derived NEG’ is distinct from ordinary *lo*, and the pattern *loh ding-a* ‘NEG.DEP IRR-LOC/FUNC’ and related purposive shapes are central in dependent negation.

Genesis 3:11 gives the OT dependent-negation anchor.

(4.184) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-loh: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nà	*nèk*	*lòh*	*dìng-à*	*kòng*	*thupiak*	*singgah*	*né*	*khá*	*nà*	*hì*	*hìam?*
2SG	eat.II	NEG-NOM	IRR-LOC	1SG→3	commandment	hang	eat	NEG.PERF	2SG	DECL	Q

‘that thou shouldest not eat?’ (Genesis 3:11)

Matthew 5:19 gives a Gospel dependent-negation comparandum.

(4.185) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-loh-matt5-19: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Midang-tè	*ìn*	*zòng*	*à*	*zùih*	*lòh*	*nàdìngìn*	*à*	*gēn*	*mì-tè*	*pèn*
other.person-PL	ERG	also	3SG	follow-NOM	NEG-NOM	PURP.ERG	3SG	speak	person-PL	TOP
mì	*néu-pèn*	*hì*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì.*					
person	small-TOP	DECL	IRR	2/3PL	DECL					

‘those who teach others not to keep them will be called least.’ (Matthew 5:19)

4.1.5 *kei* in prohibitives and irrealis-heavy negation

Kei 'NEG / prohibitive NEG' is central in prohibitives, especially *kei in* 'NEG IMP.SG' and *kei un* 'NEG IMP.PL', and it also appears in broader irrealis-heavy negative environments.

Genesis 22:12 gives the core OT prohibitive anchor.

(4.186) *Tangval-pà sù kèi ìn. Àmà tùngàh bangmah híh kèi ìn.*
youth-father tear NEG ERG 3SG.POSS on-LOC nothing PROX NEG ERG
'Do not strike the boy; do not do anything to him.' (Genesis 22:12)

Mark 1:25 gives a compact Gospel prohibitive comparandum.

(4.187) *Pau kèi ìn; híh mipa sùng pàn-ìn pái-khìa ìn.*
PAU NEG ERG PROX man inside ABL-ERG go-exit ERG
'Be silent, and come out of him.' (Mark 1:25)

4.1.6 Ordinary plural negative predicates are not automatically prohibitive

The pattern *V lo uh* is not automatically a prohibitive. Genesis 2:25 *maizum lo uh hi* 'they were not ashamed' is an ordinary declarative plural negative predicate, not a directive, and Gospel clauses such as Matthew 13:17 *mu lo uh* show the same non-prohibitive negative profile.

4.1.7 Negative existence and absence

Negative existence and absence are commonly expressed with *om lo hi* 'not exist / be absent' and *nei lo hi* 'not have'.

Genesis 37:24 gives an OT existential-negation anchor.

(4.188) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-om-lo-gen37-24: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Khu sùng-àh tùi ōm lò hì.
smoke inside-LOC water exist NEG DECL

'there was no water in the pit.' (Genesis 37:24)

John 14:30 gives a Gospel possession-negation comparandum.

(4.189) *Àmàh ìn kèima tùngàh à-ana néi lò hì.*
3SG.PRO ERG 1SG.self on-LOC 3SG-child.PL have NEG DECL
'he has no claim on me.' (John 14:30)

4.1.8 Cessative *nawn lo*

Nawn lo 'no longer / not again' is best treated as a constructional negation pattern, not as a separate basic negator.

Genesis 8:12 gives the OT cessative anchor.

(4.190) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-nawn-lo-gen8-12: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Túa vachuang hòng ciah-kík nàwn lò hì.
DIST ? 3→1 return-ITER CONT NEG DECL

'the dove did not return again.' (Genesis 8:12)

Matthew 28:6 gives a Gospel cessative comparandum.

(4.191) *Àmàh ōm nàwn lò hì.*
3SG.PRO exist CONT NEG DECL
'he is no longer here.' (Matthew 28:6)

4.1.9 Ability and inability

The ability pair *thei lo* 'cannot / not know' and *theih loh* 'not being able / dependent inability' is a productive part of negation, and the dependent form should not be collapsed into ordinary clause-level *thei lo*.

Genesis 27:23 gives a compact OT ability-negation anchor.

(4.192) *Àmàh ìn théi lò hì.*
3SG.PRO ERG know NEG DECL
'he did not recognize him.' (Genesis 27:23)

John 9:4 gives a Gospel dependent-ability comparandum.

(4.193) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-theih-loh-john9-4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Kuamah ìn nà à sep thèih lòh zān hùn hòng tùng dìng hì.
nobody ERG 2SG 3SG work know.II NEG-NOM break time 3→1 on IRR DECL

'night is coming when no one can work.' (John 9:4)

4.1.10 Negative polarity items

The forms *kuamah* 'nobody' and *bangmah* 'nothing' are included here only with filtered, manually checked negative-licensing contexts; raw exact-string counts overgenerate, and *bangmah* has non-NPI uses such as *tua bangmah hi-in* 'likewise / in that way'.

Exodus 2:12 gives a filtered OT *kuamah* example.

(4.194) *Kuamah mú lò àhìh màn-ìn Egypt mipa thàt-ìn sehnel sùng-àh à*
nobody see.I NEG be.3SG.REL reason-ERG EGYPT man kill-CVB wilderness inside-LOC 3SG
seel hì.
hide DECL
'he saw that there was no man, and hid the Egyptian in the sand.' (Exodus 2:12)

Matthew 22:46 gives a filtered Gospel *kuamah* comparandum.

(4.195) *Kuamah ìn àmà thù-dot-ná kam-khàt beek dawng théi lò ùh hì.*
nobody ERG 3SG.POSS word-ask-NMLZ word-one only receive know NEG 2/3PL DECL
'no one could answer him a word.' (Matthew 22:46)

4.1.11 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account. The present section does not reopen a full TAM chapter, a full clause-linkage chapter, a full imperative-mood chapter, or a full polarity-licensing typology; it only marks the boundaries needed to keep *lo*, *loh*, *kei*, negative existence, ability-negation, and filtered NPIs in a coherent grammar-facing description.

4.2 Interrogatives

The current interrogative evidence is strongest for clause-final *hiam* 'question particle' and WH + *hiam* content questions, with core *bang* 'what', *kua* 'who', *bangci* 'how', and *banghangin* 'why', while *bang hiam cih* 'what ... saying', *bangmah* 'nothing', *bangin* 'as / how', and the comparison-particle forms *maw* 'question/comparison particle', *ham* 'question/comparison particle', and *em* 'question/comparison particle' stay at the boundary.

4.2.1 Overview of interrogatives in Tedim

This section treats clause-final *hiam* 'question particle' and selected WH + *hiam* content questions. It keeps *bang* 'what', *kua* 'who', *bangci* 'how', and *banghangin* 'why' at the core, while *bang hiam cih* 'what... saying', *bangmah* 'nothing', *bangin* 'as / how', and the comparison-particle forms *maw* 'question/comparison particle', *ham* 'question/comparison particle', and *em* 'question/comparison particle' stay at the boundary.

The inventory below keeps the set compact. Raw counts are not treated as grammar facts here.

Interrogative inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hiam	question particle	Genesis 24:23; Matthew 6:25	stable	clause-final yes/no marker
bang	what	Exodus 16:15; Matthew 6:31	stable with caveat	overlaps with *bangmah* 'nothing' and *bangin* 'as / how'
kua	who	Genesis 48:8; Matthew 16:15	stable with caveat	analyzer sometimes tags *kua* as *NUM*
bangci	how	Genesis 3:13; Matthew 12:26	stable	should not be flattened into generic *bang*
banghangin	why	Genesis 4:6; Matthew 6:28	stable with caveat	should not be merged with formulaic *Bang hang hiam cih leh*
bang hiam cih	what… saying / embedded-question boundary	Exodus 16:15; Luke 23:34	boundary	complements under *thei lo* or speech frames
Bang hang hiam cih leh	because / for this reason	Genesis 3:20	blocked	formulaic reason frame, not ordinary question evidence
langnih a hiam namsau	two-edged sword	Revelation 1:16	blocked	lexical *hiam*, not interrogative *hiam*
a hiam ciat uh	each of them	2 Kings 11:11	blocked	lexical *hiam*, not interrogative *hiam*
bangmah	nothing	Genesis 9:21	boundary	negative-indefinite rather than interrogative *bang*
bangin	as / how	Genesis 1:7; Exodus 14:30	boundary	manner/comparison/clause-linkage use
maw	question/comparison particle	report-backed comparison material	deferred	comparison-particle analysis not yet set out

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
ham	question/comparison particle	report-backed comparison material	deferred	comparison-particle analysis not yet set out
em	question/comparison particle	report-backed comparison material	deferred	comparison-particle analysis not yet set out

Clause-final *hiam* 'question particle' Clause-final *hiam* is the safest yes/no question marker in the current evidence. It also appears with some WH questions, but the independent-clause pattern is the clearest place to start.

(4.196) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:int-hiam-gen24-23: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nà	*pà*	*ínn-àh*	*kòtè*	*giah*	*nàdìng*	*à*	*áwng*	*dìng*	*hìam*
2SG	father	house-LOC	1PL.PRO	camp	PURP	3SG	open	IRR	Q

'Is there room in your father's house for us to stay?' (Genesis 24:23)

Matthew 6:25 gives a Gospel yes/no question with the same clause-final *hiam* pattern, so the distribution is not confined to a single narrative window.

(4.197)

Nuntak-ná	*pèn*	*àn*	*sàng-ìn*	*thù-pì-zàw*	*à,*	*pumpi*	*pèn*	*pùan*	*sàng-ìn*
live-NMLZ	TOP	3PL.POSS	high-ERG	word-big-more	3SG	body	TOP	cloth	high-ERG
thù-pì-zàw	*hì*	*lò*	*àhì*	*hìam?*					
word-big-more	DECL	NEG	be.3SG	Q					

'Is not life more important than food, and the body more important than clothing?' (Matthew 6:25)

WH + *hiam* content questions The content-question pattern is WH + *hiam*. The forms below are the current core WH inventory in this section. *Bang* 'what' and *kua* 'who' are the simplest members of the set; *bangci* 'how' and *banghangin* 'why' show that the same question marker can attach to different semantic relations.

***bang* 'what'** *Bang* is the clearest what-question word. It can appear in a very short clause or inside a longer question frame.

(4.198)

Bàng	*àhì*	*hìam?*
like	be.3SG	Q

'What is it?' (Exodus 16:15)

Matthew 6:31 shows *bang* in a longer Gospel question frame.

(4.199)

Bàng	*né*	*dìng*	*à,*	*bàng*	*dawn*	*dìng*	*à,*	*bàng*	*silh*	*dìng*	*ì-hí*	*hìam?*
like	eat	IRR	3SG	like	top	IRR	3SG	like	clothe	IRR	1PL.INCL-be	Q

'What shall we eat, what shall we drink, and what shall we wear?' (Matthew 6:31)

***kua* 'who'** *Kua* is the core who-question word. The analyzer sometimes tags it as *NUM*, but that export label does not change the clause-level reading.

(4.200) *Híh-tè kua àhì hìam?*
PROX-PL who be.3SG Q
'Who are these?' (Genesis 48:8)

Matthew 16:15 gives a Gospel counterpart with the same question word.

(4.201) *Túa ahihleh nòtè ìn kèi kua hì hòng cí nà hì ùh hìam?*
DIST if 2PL.PRO ERG NEG who DECL 3→1 say 2SG DECL 2/3PL Q
'But who do you say that I am?' (Matthew 16:15)

***bangci* 'how'** *Bangci* stays visible as *bangci* rather than being flattened into generic *bang*. It is the clearest manner-question item in the current evidence.

(4.202) *Bangci à hi-cí gàm-tat nà hì hìam?*
how 3SG PROX-say land-rule 2SG DECL Q
'How have you acted thus?' (Genesis 3:13)

Matthew 12:26 keeps the same *bangci* pattern visible in Gospel material.

(4.203) *Túa màh bàng-ìn Satan lè Satan kī-hawlkhia lè-ùh à ukna bangci*
DIST EMPH like-ERG SATAN and SATAN REFL-drive.out and-PL.IMP 3SG rule.NMLZ how
kip thèih dìng àhì hìam?
firm know.II IRR be.3SG Q
'How then can Satan cast out Satan?' (Matthew 12:26)

***banghangin* 'why'** *Banghangin* remains a reason-question item. The segmented form is slightly noisy, but the clause-level reading is still clear.

(4.204) *bàng hàng-ìn nà mái sía àhì hìam*
like because-ERG 2SG face evil be.3SG Q
'Why is your countenance fallen?' (Genesis 4:6)

Matthew 6:28 is a Gospel counterpart with the same reason-question pattern.

(4.205) *Bàng hàng-ìn pùan-silh dìng lùng-himawh nà hì ùh hìam?*
like because-ERG cloth-wrap IRR heart-fear 2SG DECL 2/3PL Q
'Why are you anxious about clothing?' (Matthew 6:28)

Embedded-question boundary *Bang hiam cih* 'what... saying' belongs at the embedded-question boundary, not in the independent-clause pattern. The current evidence shows this most clearly where *thei lo* 'do not know' governs the embedded question.

(4.206) *bàng hìam cìh théi lò ùh hì*
like Q say.NOM know NEG 2/3PL DECL
'They did not know what it was.' (Exodus 16:15)

Luke 23:34 shows the same boundary in a Gospel frame.

(4.207) *Pà àw, àmaute ìn bàng híh ì-hí hìam cìh théi lò ùh*
father voice 3PL.PRO ERG like PROX 1PL.INCL-be Q say.NOM know NEG 2/3PL
àhìh màn-ìn à màwh-ná ùh nà mái-sàk ìn
be.3SG.REL reason-ERG 3SG err-NMLZ 2/3PL 2SG face-CAUS ERG
'Father, forgive them, for they know not what they are doing.' (Luke 23:34)

Blocked false friends and non-interrogative *hiam* *Bang hang hiam cih leh* ‘because / for this reason’ is a formulaic reason frame, not an ordinary question. *Langnih a hiam namsau* ‘two-edged sword’ (Revelation 1:16) and *a hiam ciat uh* ‘each of them’ (2 Kings 11:11) are lexical *hiam* controls. *Bangmah* ‘nothing’ (Genesis 9:21) and *bangin* ‘as / how’ (Genesis 1:7; Exodus 14:30) are boundary forms rather than core interrogatives.

Deferred comparison particles *Maw* ‘question/comparison particle’, *ham* ‘question/comparison particle’, and *em* ‘question/comparison particle’ remain deferred. The current evidence is enough to keep them visible, but not enough to build a separate comparison-particle account.

Deferred material Several issues remain outside the present account.

4.3 Sentence-final particles

The current sentence-final evidence is strongest for controlled clause-final uses of *ahi hi* ‘be.3SG DECL / it was’, *lo hi* ‘NEG DECL’, *hen* ‘jussive / optative’, *in* ‘imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary’, and *un* ‘plural imperative’, while *hiam* ‘question particle’, *aw* ‘vocative / exclamative boundary’, *tahen* ‘deferred jussive-looking form’, *ta* ‘perfective / change-of-state boundary’, and *zo* ‘completive boundary’ remain overlap or deferred material.

4.3.1 Overview of sentence-final particles in Tedim

This section treats a small controlled set of sentence-final or clause-final material: *hi* ‘declarative’, *ahi hi* ‘be.3SG DECL / it was’, *lo hi* ‘NEG DECL’, *hen* ‘jussive / optative’, *in* ‘imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary’, and *un* ‘plural imperative’. It keeps *hiam* ‘question particle’, *aw* ‘vocative / exclamative boundary’, *tahen* ‘deferred jussive-looking form’, *ta* ‘perfective / change-of-state boundary’, and *zo* ‘completive boundary’ as overlap or deferred material. The section does not present the whole mood, aspect, TAM, negation, or interrogative system.

4.3.2 Sentence-final particle inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hi	declarative	Genesis 1:13; Matthew 1:1	supported with caveat	discussed through *ahi hi*, not as unrestricted bare *hi*
ahi hi	be.3SG DECL / it was	Genesis 1:13; Matthew 1:1	stable with caveat	bundles copular *ahi* and clause-final *hi*
lo hi	NEG DECL	Genesis 4:5; Matthew 2:10	stable with caveat	overlaps with the negation system
hen	jussive / optative	Genesis 1:3; Matthew 6:9	stable with caveat	not expanded into a full mood chapter
in	imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary	Genesis 6:14; Luke 23:34	supported with caveat	analyzer export overlap with case-like `ERG/FUNC`
un	plural imperative	Psalms 100:1; Matthew 3:3	stable	imperative plural form, often near vocative material
hiam	question particle	Genesis 48:8	boundary	handled in interrogatives, not reanalyzed here

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
aw	vocative / exclamative boundary	Psalms 100:1; Matthew 1:20	boundary	vocative and lexical overlap
tahen	deferred jussive-looking form	Genesis 9:25; Luke 9:60	deferred	fused *tahen* vs split *ta hen* and export noise
ta	perfective / change-of-state boundary	Genesis 40:23; Matthew 14:15	deferred boundary	TAM overlap and noisy export
zo	completive boundary	Genesis 1:28	deferred boundary	lexical/export ambiguity remains visible

4.3.3 Declarative *hi* with copula overlap

Clause-final *hi* is safest here when discussed through *ahi hi* 'be.3SG DECL / it was'. The section therefore keeps copular overlap explicit and does not treat every *hi* token as a settled sentence-final declarative marker.

(4.208) *àhì* *hì*
be.3SG DECL
'it was' (Genesis 1:13)

Matthew 1:1 gives a Gospel counterpart in the same copula-plus-declarative frame.

(4.209) *híh* *bàng* *àhì* *hì*
PROX like be.3SG DECL
'it is thus / this is how it is' (Matthew 1:1)

4.3.4 Negative-plus-declarative *lo hi*

Lo hi 'NEG DECL' is treated as a negation-plus-declarative overlap point. This section keeps the overlap visible and does not reopen the full negation account.

(4.210) *thusim* *lò* *hì*
parable NEG DECL
'it was not accepted' (Genesis 4:5)

Matthew 2:10 gives a Gospel clause with the same *lo hi* pattern.

(4.211) *ki-gēn* *théi* *lò* *hì*
conversation know NEG DECL
'it cannot be fully told' (Matthew 2:10)

4.3.5 Optative or jussive *hen*

Hen 'jussive / optative' is included for controlled optative-like clause-final usage. The section keeps this narrow and does not widen it into a full mood system.

(4.212) *Khuavak* *ōm* *hèn*
light exist JUSS
'let there be light' (Genesis 1:3)

Matthew 6:9 gives a Gospel jussive prayer frame with the same clause-final *hen*.

(4.213) *nà mīn sìangtho kī-zahtak hèn*
2SG name holy REFL-honor JUSS
'hallowed be your name' (Matthew 6:9)

4.3.6 Imperative *in* and *un*

In 'imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary' and *un* 'plural imperative' are both visible in controlled clauses. For *in*, the case-like analyzer/export overlap remains explicit. For *un*, the clause-final imperative plural use is cleaner.

(4.214) *teembaw khàt bāwl ìn*
ark one make ERG
'make an ark' (Genesis 6:14)

Luke 23:34 keeps the same imperative boundary with *in* in Gospel speech.

(4.215) *à màwh-ná ùh nà mái-sàk ìn*
3SG err-NMLZ 2/3PL 2SG face-CAUS ERG
'forgive their sin' (Luke 23:34)

Psalms 100:1 provides the current controlled Old Testament plural-imperative *un* anchor.

(4.216) *ging-sàk ùn*
sound-CAUS IMP.PL
'make a joyful noise' (Psalms 100:1)

Matthew 3:3 gives a Gospel plural-imperative counterpart with clause-final *un*.

(4.217) *lam-pì tāng-sàk ùn*
road give-CAUS IMP.PL
'make his paths straight' (Matthew 3:3)

4.3.7 *Hiam* as interrogatives overlap

Hiam 'question particle' remains a cross-reference boundary with interrogatives. The clause *Hihte kua ahi hiam?* (Genesis 48:8) stays useful as overlap control, but this section does not reopen independent *hiam* analysis.

4.3.8 *Aw* as vocative or exclamative boundary

Aw 'vocative / exclamative' remains boundary material here. *Gam khempeuh aw* 'all lands!' (Psalms 100:1) and *David suan Josef aw* 'Joseph, son of David!' (Matthew 1:20) show vocative force, but they do not yet justify a broader sentence-final mood claim.

4.3.9 *Tahen*, *ta*, and *zo* as deferred TAM-overlap material

Tahen 'deferred jussive-looking form' remains unresolved because fused *tahen* and split *ta hen* material are still noisy in the current evidence. *Ta* 'perfective / change-of-state boundary' remains boundary material where clause-final *ta hi* overlaps TAM. *Zo* 'completive boundary' remains deferred where lexical/export ambiguity is still visible.

4.3.10 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- Broader interactions among sentence-final particles, clause type, and discourse structure remain outside this section.
- The present section does not settle the full relation between sentence-final material and TAM or negation.
- Further treatment of rare or noisy clause-final forms remains deferred until cleaner controlled evidence is available.

4.4 Coordinators

The current coordinators evidence is strongest for NP coordination with *le* 'and (NP coordinator)', while *leh* 'if / when', sequential *a* 'sequential linker with 3SG/FUNC overlap', and *mawh* 'deferred disjunction material' remain boundary or deferred material, and *Ahih hangin* 'but / however' plus *ahih kei leh* 'otherwise / if not' remain caveated connector patterns.

4.4.1 Overview of coordinators in Tedim

This section keeps coordination narrowly constructional. *le* 'and (NP coordinator)' is the clean noun-phrase anchor, while *leh* 'if / when' and sequential *a* 'sequential linker with 3SG/FUNC overlap' stay boundary-controlled. *mawh* 'deferred disjunction material' remains deferred. *Ahih hangin* 'but / however' and *ahih kei leh* 'otherwise / if not' are treated as caveated connector material (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). This section does not present a full coordination, subordination, converb, or discourse system.

4.4.2 Coordinator inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
le	NP coordination	*vantung le leitung*; *Van le lei*	core	limited to clean NP coordination claims
leh	conditional / boundary linker	*veilam na lak leh kei taklamah ka pai ding hi*	boundary	do not flatten conditional *leh* into simple clause conjunction
a	sequential linker	*luang a tua mun panin gun hong kikhenin*	boundary	export overlap with agreement/function *a*
mawh	disjunction / alternative-question row	*mawh*	deferred	current controlled row is lexical/analyzer-noise material
Ahih hangin	adversative connector	*Ahih hangin*; *Ahih hangin kuamah in dawng lo hi*	supported with caveat	internally analyzable as *ahih* + *hang-in*
ahih kei leh	conditional-adversative connector	*ahih kei leh*; *tua ahih kei leh*	supported with caveat	not a simple coordinator; overlaps conditional and negation material

4.4.3 NP coordination with *le*

The clearest NP coordination anchor is *vantung le leitung* 'heaven and earth', where *le* links two noun phrases without clause-linkage ambiguity.

Genesis 1:1 supplies the OT anchor.

(4.218) *vàn-tùng lè léi-tùng*
sky-on and land-on
'heaven and earth' (Genesis 1:1)

Matthew 24:35 gives a Gospel comparandum with the same NP-coordination profile.

(4.219) *Vàn lè léi*
sky and buy
'heaven and earth' (Matthew 24:35)

4.4.4 Conditional and boundary *leh*

Leh 'if / when' is kept as boundary material here rather than as a generalized simple clause coordinator.

Genesis 13:9 keeps a controlled conditional window visible.

(4.220) *véi-lam nà lāk lèh kèi taklam-àh kà pái dìng hì*
faint-direction 2SG among and NEG right-LOC 1SG go IRR DECL
'if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right' (Genesis 13:9)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

The same row keeps an export caution visible: *kei* is glossed as *NEG* in this selected span even though the wider context is first-person future movement.

4.4.5 Sequential *a* and agreement false friends

Sequential *a* 'sequential linker with 3SG/FUNC overlap' remains caveated boundary evidence only.

Genesis 2:10 keeps one sequential window visible.

(4.221) *luang à túa mùn pàn-ìn gun hòng kikhen-ìn*
flow 3SG DIST place ABL-ERG river 3→1 separate-CVB
'and from thence it was parted' (Genesis 2:10)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

The false-friend control *a piangsak* '3SG/FUNC + create' shows why raw *a* harvesting is unsafe in coordinator analysis.

4.4.6 Deferred *mawh* material

mawh 'disjunction material (currently deferred)' remains deferred in this section because the controlled row still exports lexical material (*sin / V*) rather than a clean disjunction or alternative-question construction.

Report-only schematic strings such as *mi mawh ganhing mawh* and *pai ding mawh om ding mawh* are not promoted as grammar evidence here.

4.4.7 Adversative *Ahih hangin*

Ahih hangin 'but / however' is the current adversative connector anchor, while still carrying an internal-analysis caution.

Genesis 3:4 supplies the OT anchor.

(4.222) *Àhìh* *hàng-ìn*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG
'but' (Genesis 3:4)

Mark 3:4 gives a Gospel comparandum with the same connector.

(4.223) *Àhìh* *hàng-ìn* *kuamah* *ìn* *dawng* *lò* *hì.*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG nobody ERG receive NEG DECL
'but no one answered.' (Mark 3:4)

4.4.8 Conditional-adversative *ahih kei leh*

ahih kei leh 'otherwise / if not' remains conditional-adversative boundary material and should not be flattened into simple coordination.

Exodus 12:3 gives the OT boundary anchor.

(4.224) *àhìh* *kèi* *lèh*
be.3SG.REL NEG and
'otherwise / if not' (Exodus 12:3)

Matthew 11:3 gives a Gospel comparandum in the same conditional-adversative frame.

(4.225) *túa* *àhìh* *kèi* *lèh*
DIST be.3SG.REL NEG and
'or else / if not' (Matthew 11:3)

4.4.9 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account. This section does not reopen *ciangin* 'when', broader *hangin* 'because', temporal or causal subordination, or full converb chaining. Sentence-final particles and broader discourse-organization domains likewise remain outside this account.

4.5 Reduplication

The current reduplication evidence is strongest for full-reduplication intensification with *mahmah* 'very, truly' and support from *taktak* 'truly, certainly', while distributive *peuhpeuh* 'each~each / every, each', syntactic *ni ni* 'day day / day by day', and forms such as *leuleu* 'ITER~ITER / gradually' remain secondary, boundary, or deferred material.

4.5.1 Overview of reduplication in Tedim

This section gives a narrow grammar-facing account of reduplication in Tedim. The core evidence is strongest for intensifier-like full reduplication with *mahmah* 'very, truly' and support from *taktak* 'truly, certainly'. Secondary distributive material with *peuhpeuh* 'each~each / every, each' is kept visible but does not lead the analysis.

The section keeps the analysis deliberately small. It distinguishes core evidence from boundary and deferred material, and it does not treat reduplication as a complete derivational, TAM/aspect, VP-structure, expressive-morphology, or dictionary-entry system.

Reduplication inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
mahmah / *mah~mah*	full-reduplication intensifier	*pha mahmah hi*	core anchor	none at the current evidence level
taktak / *tak~tak*	full-reduplication intensifier support	*Esau taktak na hi hiam?*	support	context-sensitive lexical contribution remains
peuhpeuh / *peuh~peuh*	distributive or free-choice-like reduplication	*khat peuhpeuh*	secondary evidence	quantifier-adjacent behavior remains explicit
ni ni	syntactic X X repetition	temporal adverbial sequencing	boundary material	syntactic/adverbial interpretation dominates current evidence
leuleu	iterative or continuative-looking repetition	*pai leuleu-in*	boundary material	overlaps TAM/aspect and VP-structure domains
gengen, *kawikawi*, *theithei*	verbal, expressive, or adverbial-modal-looking rows	report-visible forms with mixed behavior	deferred	lexicalized-looking or report-only behavior remains unresolved
bangbang, *bekbek*, *zenzen*, *tuamtuam*	report-only reduplicative-looking rows	table-only rows	deferred	no clean controlled examples are currently promoted

Full reduplication as intensification *mahmah* is the main full-reduplication intensifier anchor.

Its controlled segmentation is *mah~mah*, with gloss/function *EMPH~EMPH / very, truly*.

The worked example *pha mahmah hi* remains central in this section, with gloss ‘good very DECL’.

(4.226) *hòih sá màhmàh hì*
good flesh very DECL
‘it was very good’ (Genesis 1:31)

Matthew 2:3 gives a Gospel comparandum for the same intensifier pattern.

(4.227) *lamdang-sá màhmàh*
different-INTNS very
‘very alarmed / greatly troubled’ (Matthew 2:3)

Taktak is the closest support row for the same intensifying pattern.

Its controlled segmentation is *tak~tak*, with gloss/function *TRUE~TRUE / truly, certainly*.

(4.228) *Esau tak-tak nà hì hìam?*
ESAU great~REDUP 2SG DECL Q
‘Are you really Esau?’ (Genesis 27:24)

Matthew 27:54 gives a Gospel support row for the same *taktak* pattern.

(4.229) *Pasian' Tá-pà tak-tak màh àhì hì*
God.POSS child-male great~REDUP EMPH be.3SG DECL
'Truly this was the Son of God' (Matthew 27:54)

These rows support a narrow claim: full reduplication can mark intensification. They do not by themselves define the full reduplication system.

Secondary distributive reduplication *Peuhpeuh* remains secondary distributive evidence, with controlled segmentation *peuh~peuh* and gloss/function *EACH~EACH / every, each*.

(4.230) *Nà khàt peuhpeuh Topa à dìng-ìn hàk-sá lúa àhì hìam?*
2SG one every Lord 3SG IRR-ERG difficult-PAST exceed be.3SG Q
'Is anything too hard for the Lord?' (Genesis 18:14)

Matthew 10:11 supplies a Gospel comparandum for secondary distributive use.

(4.231) *khùa khàt peuhpeuh nà tun ùh cìang-ìn*
town one every 2SG arrive 2/3PL then-ERG
'whichever town you enter' (Matthew 10:11)

This construction remains secondary because it stays close to quantifier or free-choice behavior. It is relevant to reduplication but not promoted as the main anchor.

Boundary and deferred material *Ni ni* 'day day / day by day' remains syntactic or adverbial boundary material. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

Leuleu 'ITER~ITER / gradually' remains TAM/aspect or VP-boundary material; Acts 28:13 (*pai leuleu-in*) is retained as prose-only boundary evidence rather than as a core formal example.

Gengen 'speak~speak / saying repeatedly', *kawikawi* 'side~side / all around', *theithei* 'KNOW~KNOW / adverbial-modal boundary', *bangbang* 'kind~kind / various', *bekbek* 'only~only', *zenzen* 'completely', and *tuamtuam* 'various kinds' remain boundary-controlled or deferred. These rows are lexicalized-looking or report-only in the current evidence and are not promoted as core grammar evidence here.

Several issues remain outside the present account. This section does not present a full reduplication, derivation, TAM/aspect, VP-structure, expressive-morphology, or dictionary-entry system.

4.6 Broader discourse

A fuller treatment of discourse structure is not yet included in this draft.

4.7 Analyzer-gap caution

Several cross-cutting morphological issues remain unresolved and are not yet integrated into this draft.

References

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